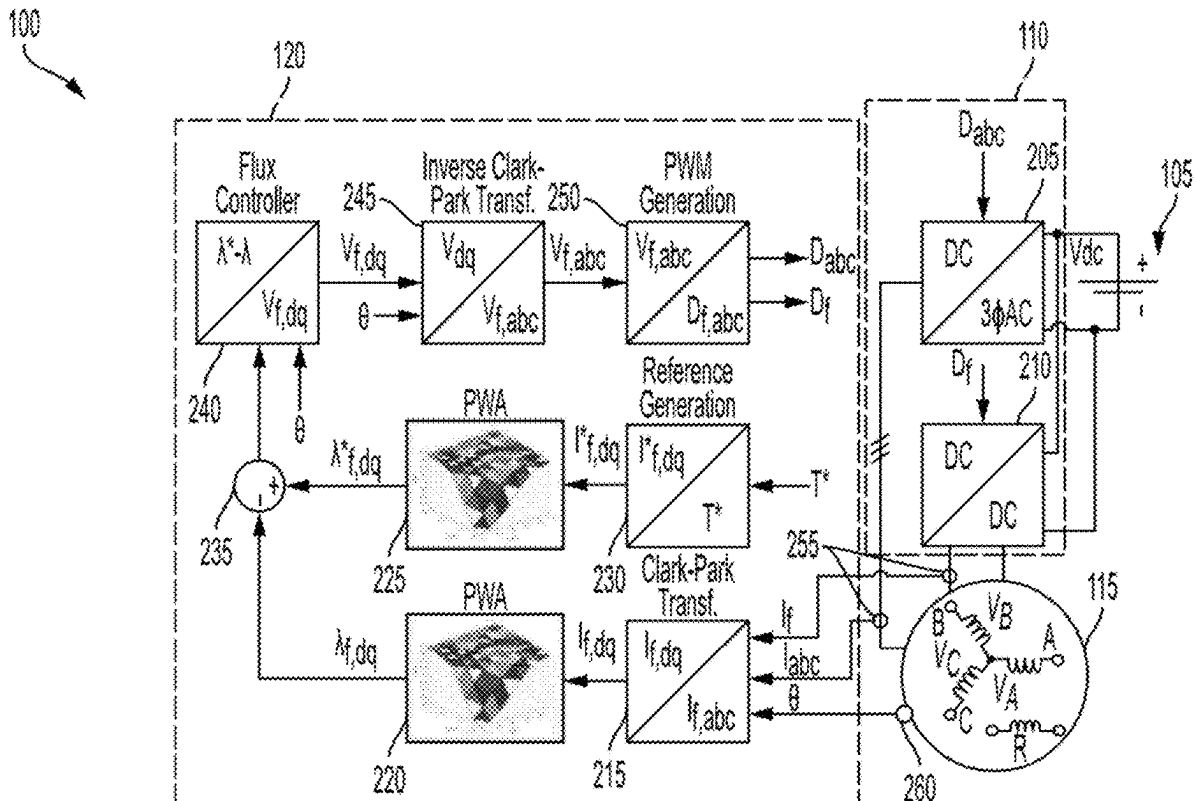




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(19) **United States**(12) **Patent Application Publication**
Preindl et al.(10) **Pub. No.: US 2025/0286487 A1**(43) **Pub. Date: Sep. 11, 2025**(54) **MOTOR CONTROL USING PIECEWISE
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(US); **Walter Wesley Pennington, III**,
Menlo Park, CA (US)(21) Appl. No.: **19/218,125**(22) Filed: **May 23, 2025****Related U.S. Application Data**(63) Continuation of application No. 18/730,268, filed on
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28, 2022, provisional application No. 63/345,879,
filed on May 25, 2022, provisional application No.63/409,418, filed on Sep. 23, 2022, provisional ap-
plication No. 63/420,360, filed on Oct. 28, 2022,
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(2013.01); **H02P 2207/05** (2013.01)(57) **ABSTRACT**

Disclosed are systems and methods for motor control using piecewise affine modelling. An electronic controller may determine current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame. Each current value may be associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. The electronic controller may further determine, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a piecewise affine map. The electronic controller may further determine a target flux linkage value for each of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. The electronic controller may then control a power switching network coupled between a power supply and the motor based on the flux linkage values and the target flux linkage values.



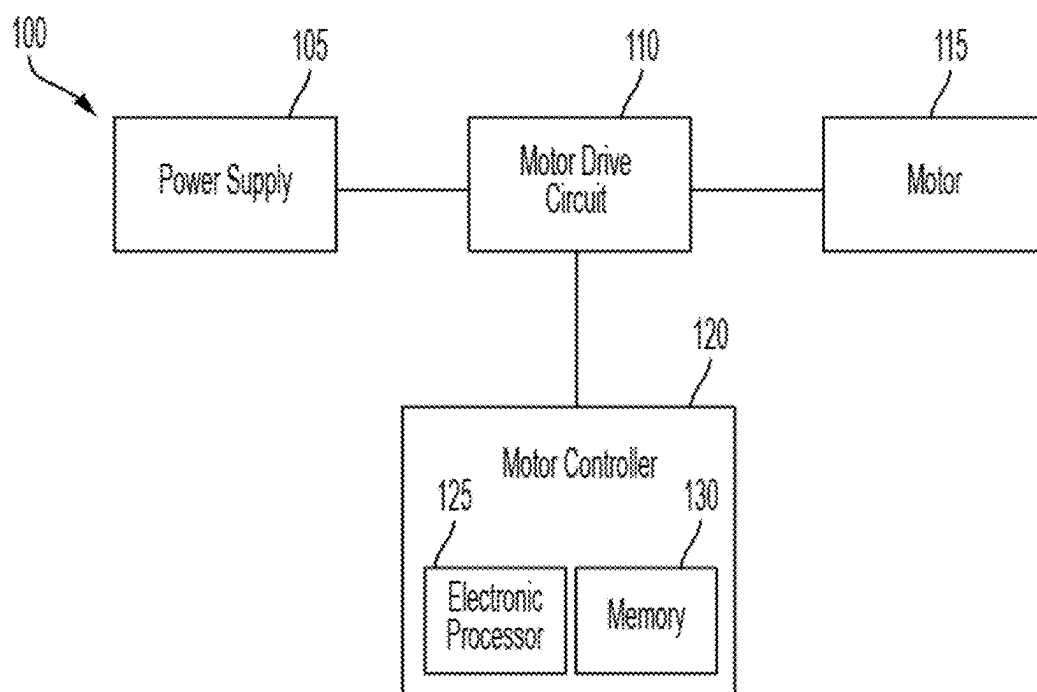


FIG. 1

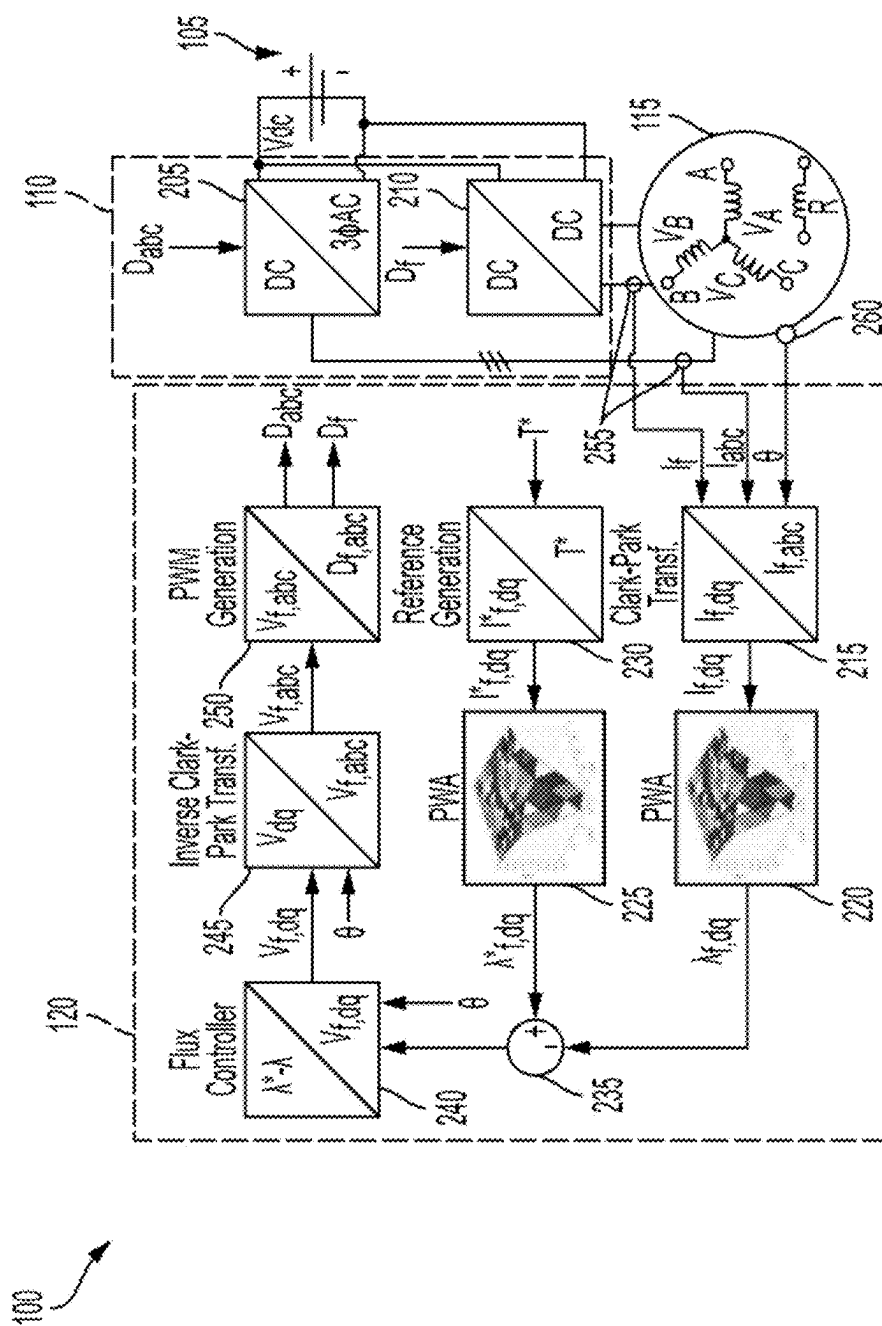


FIG. 2

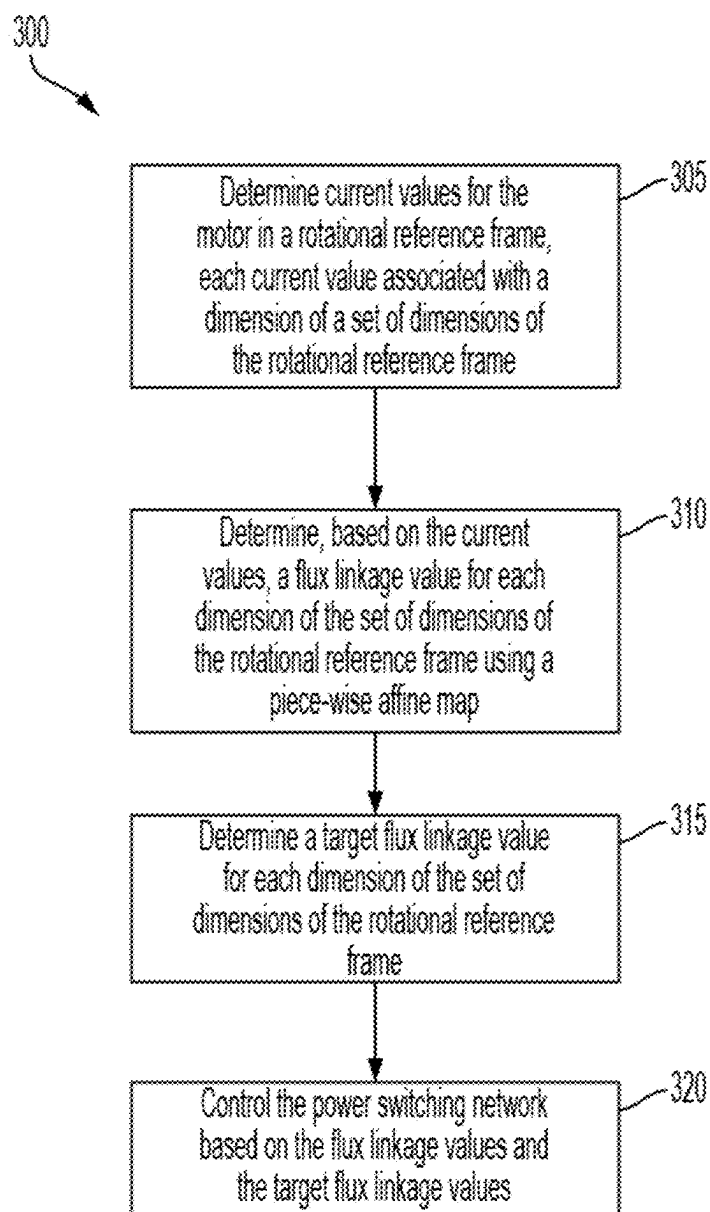


FIG. 3

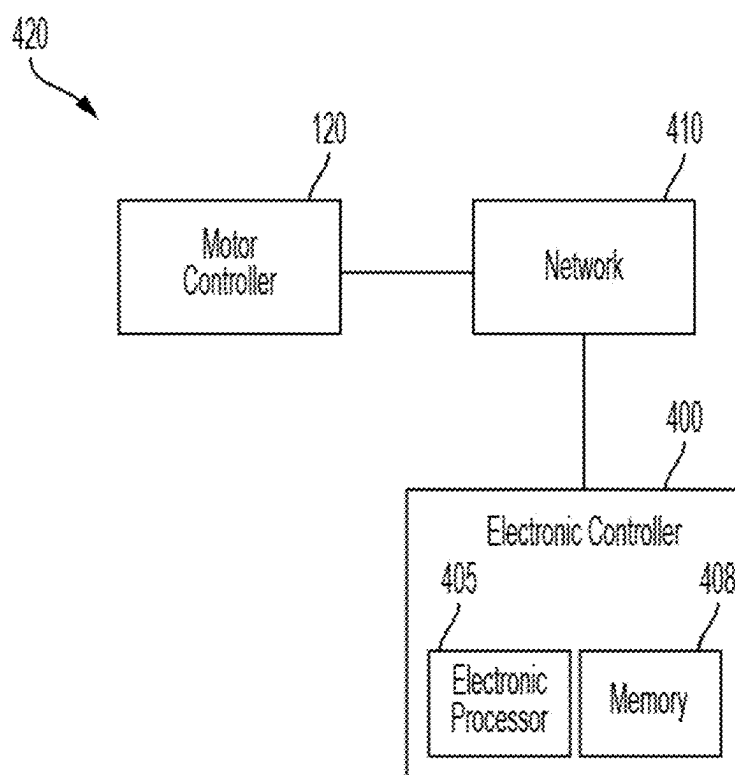
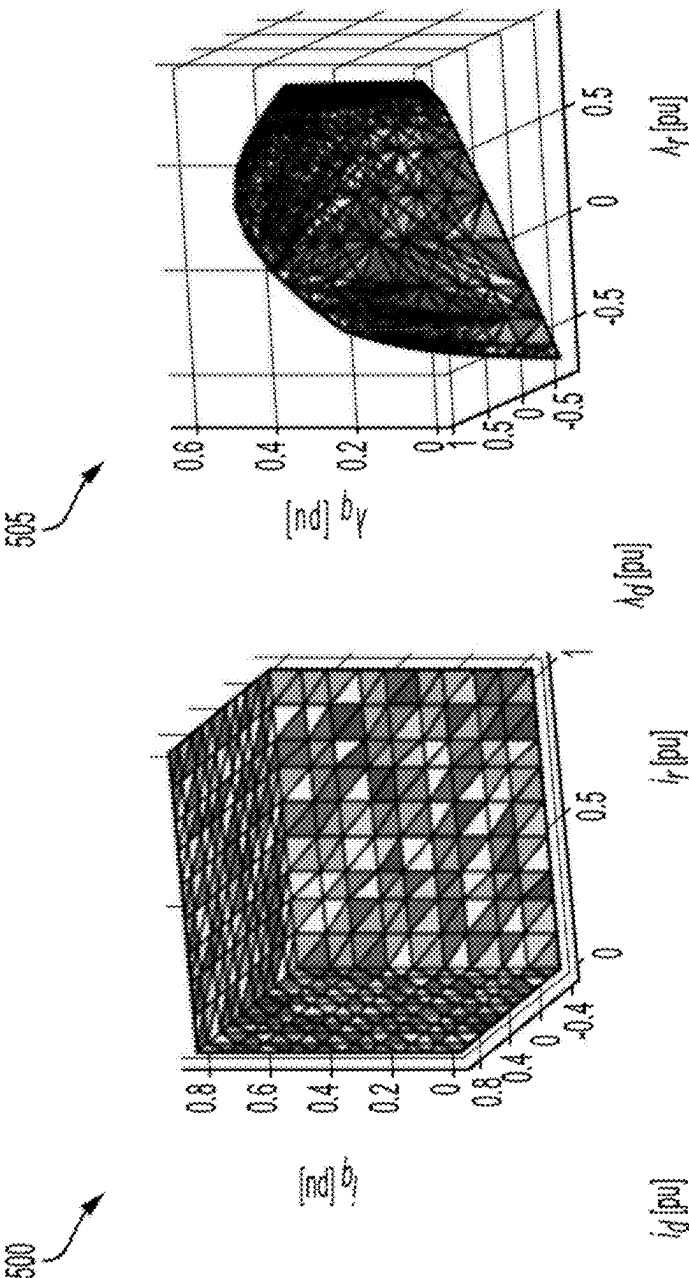


FIG. 4



Mesh of simplices $i_j \in i_M$ in current space (left), and mesh of simplices $\lambda_j \in \lambda_M$ (right) in flux space

FIG. 5

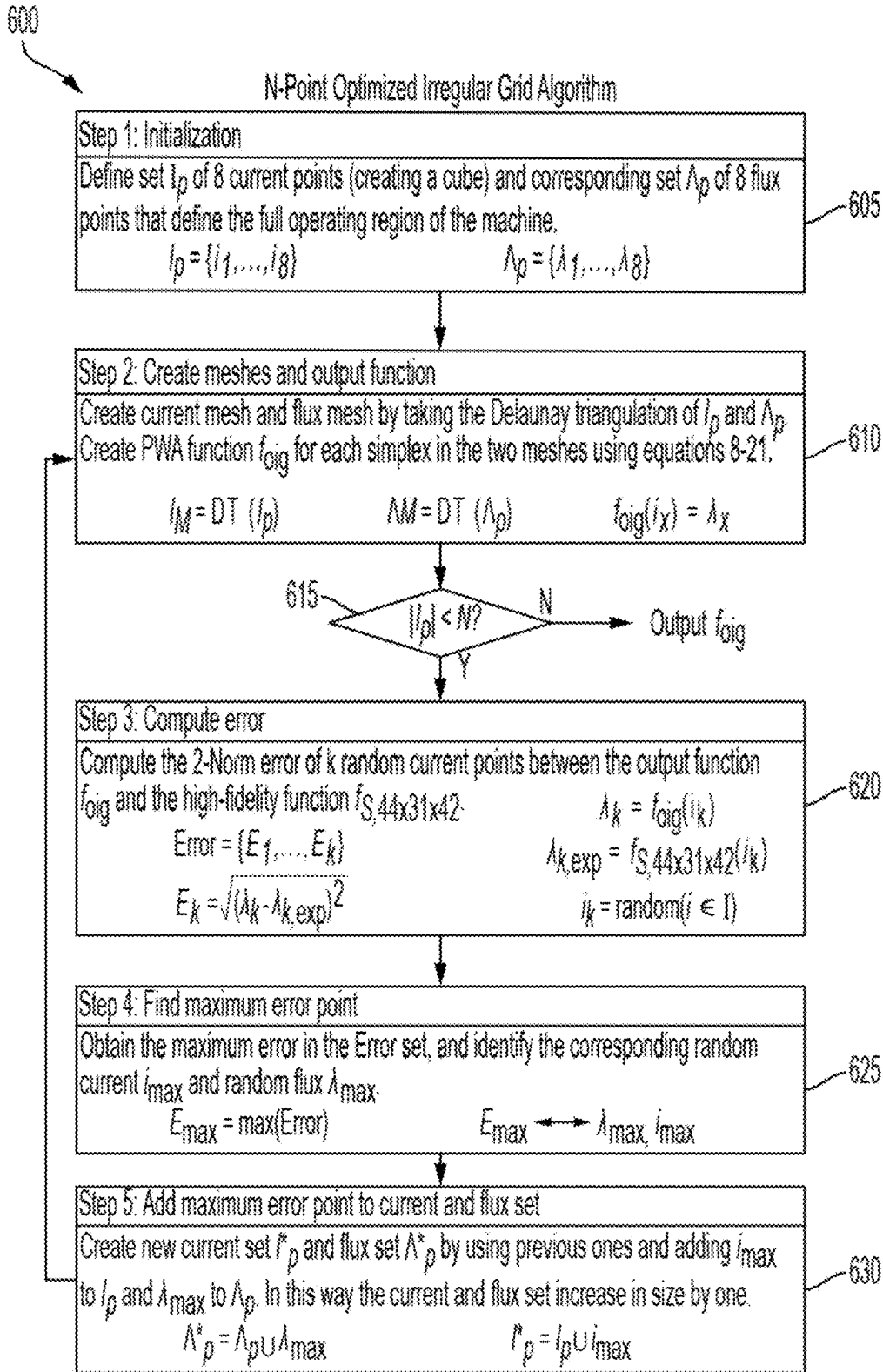
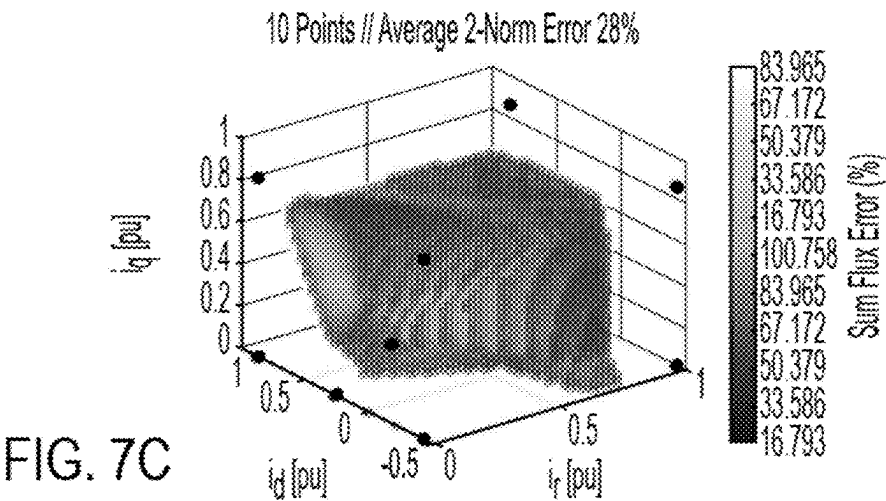
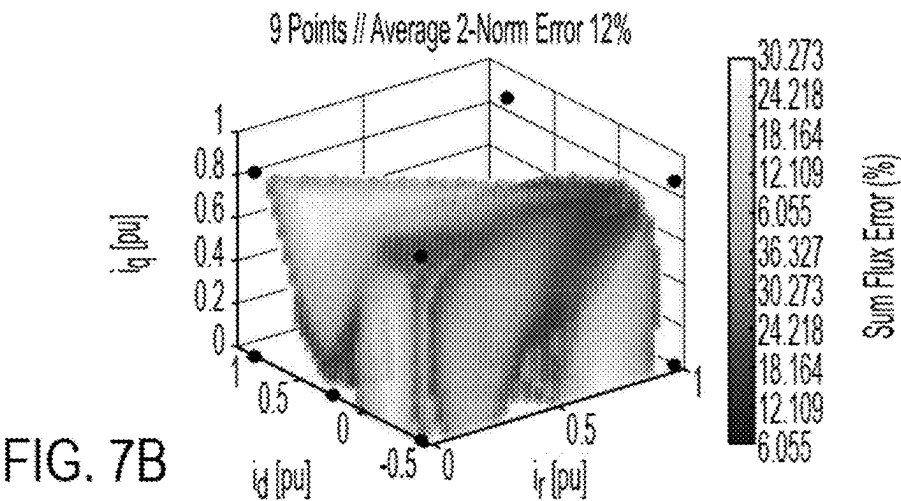
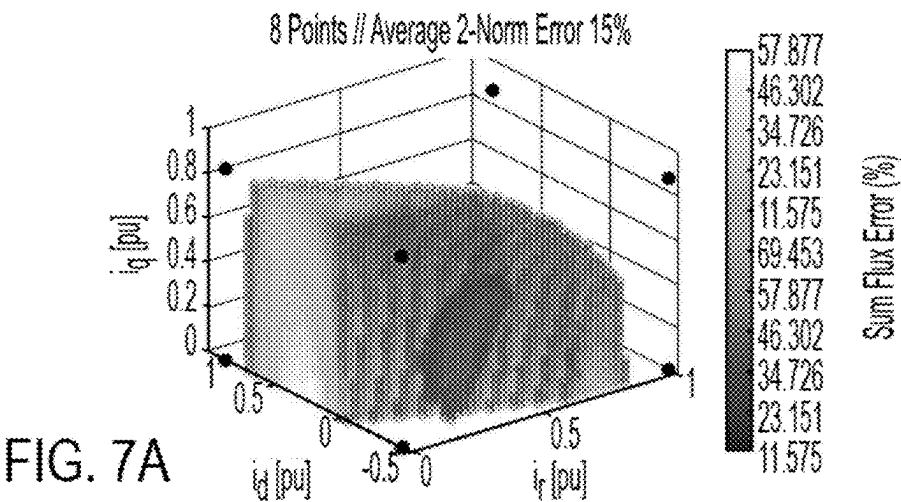
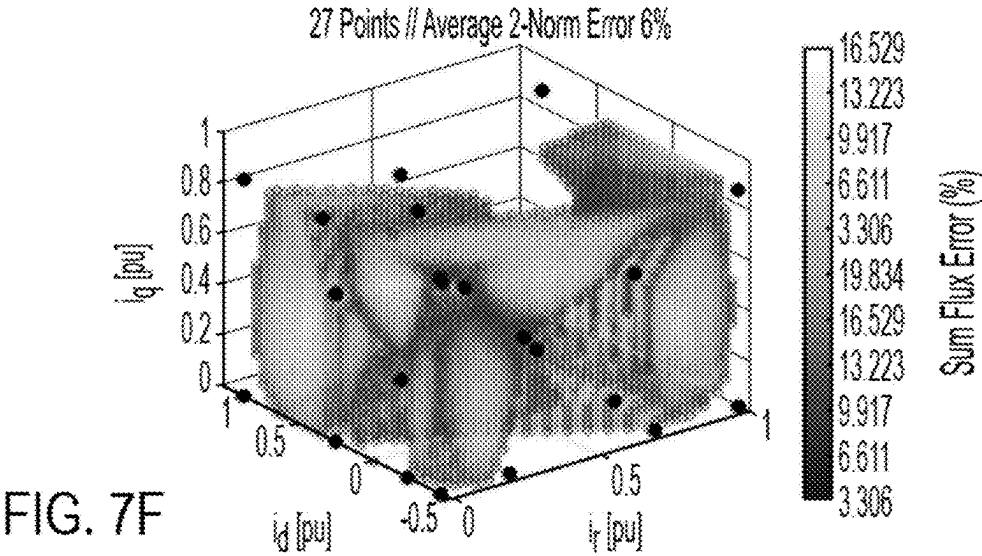
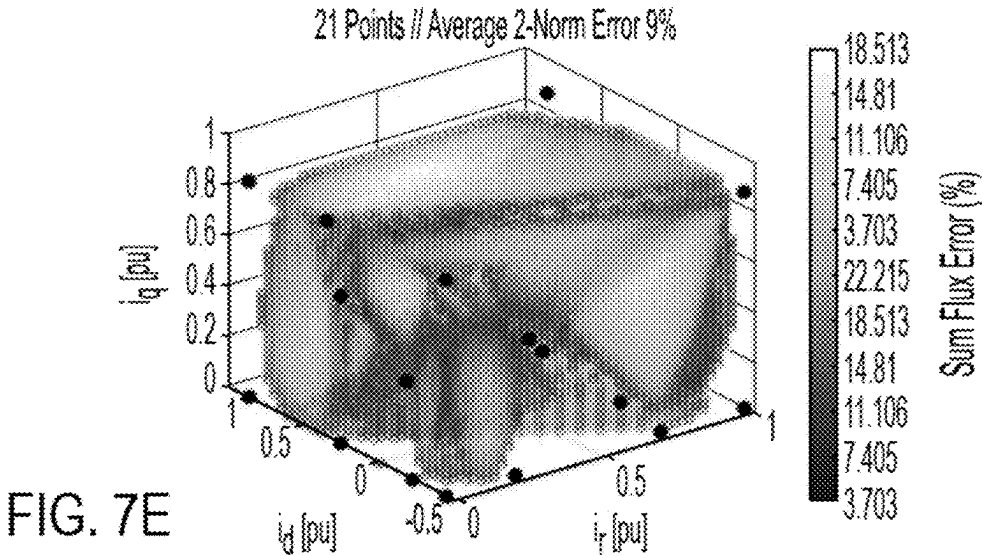
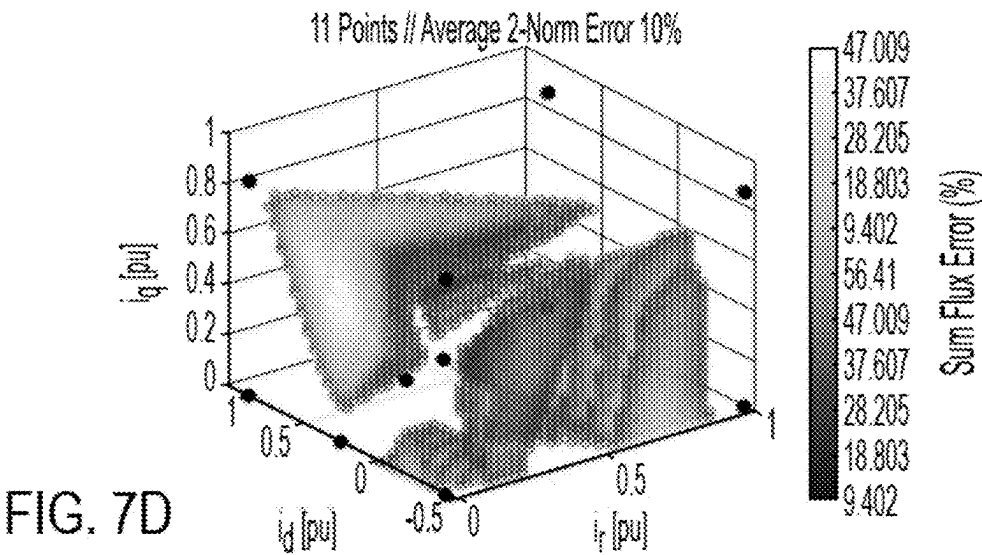


FIG. 6





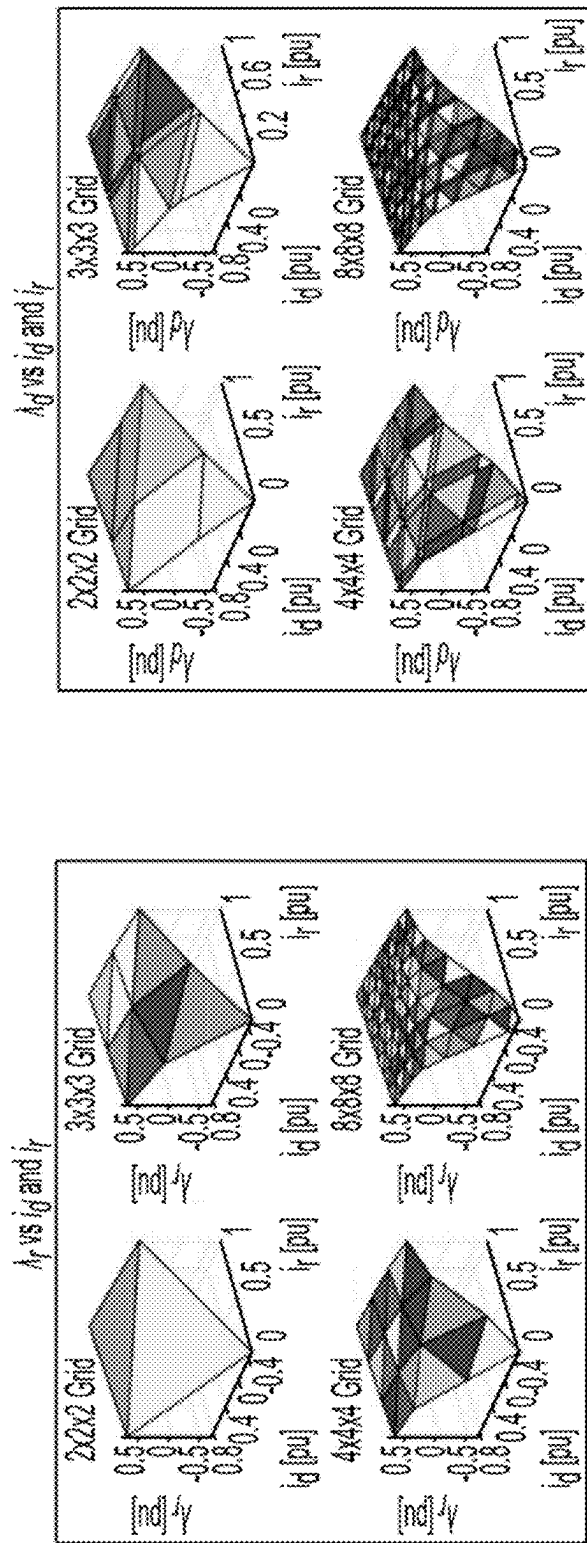


FIG. 8B

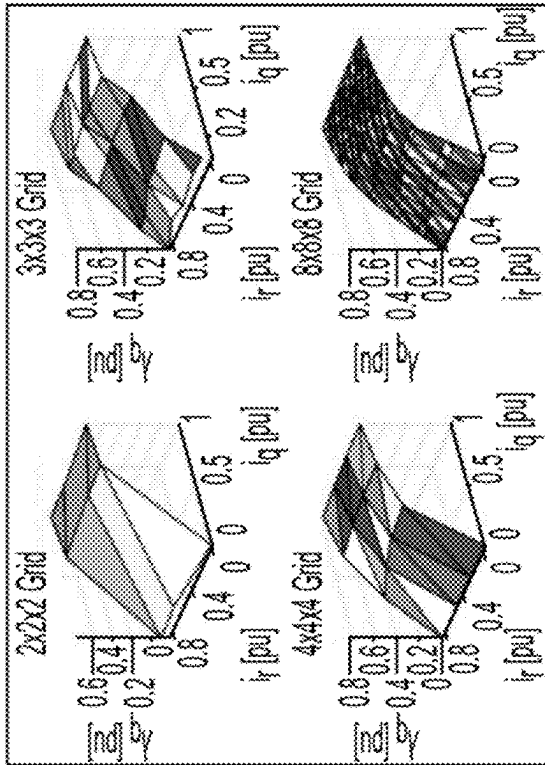


FIG. 8A

λ_q vs i_d and i_q

FIG. 8C

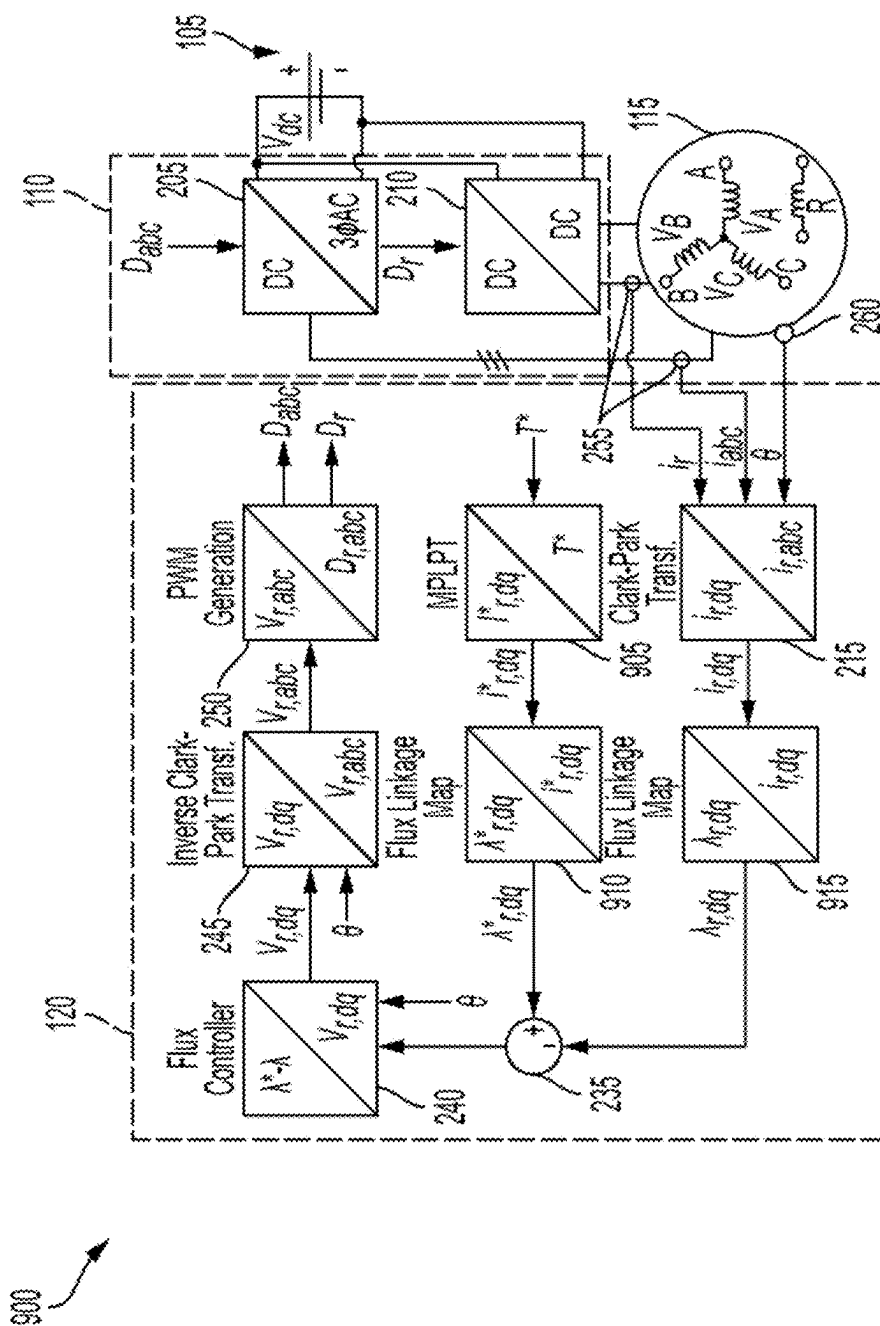


FIG. 9A

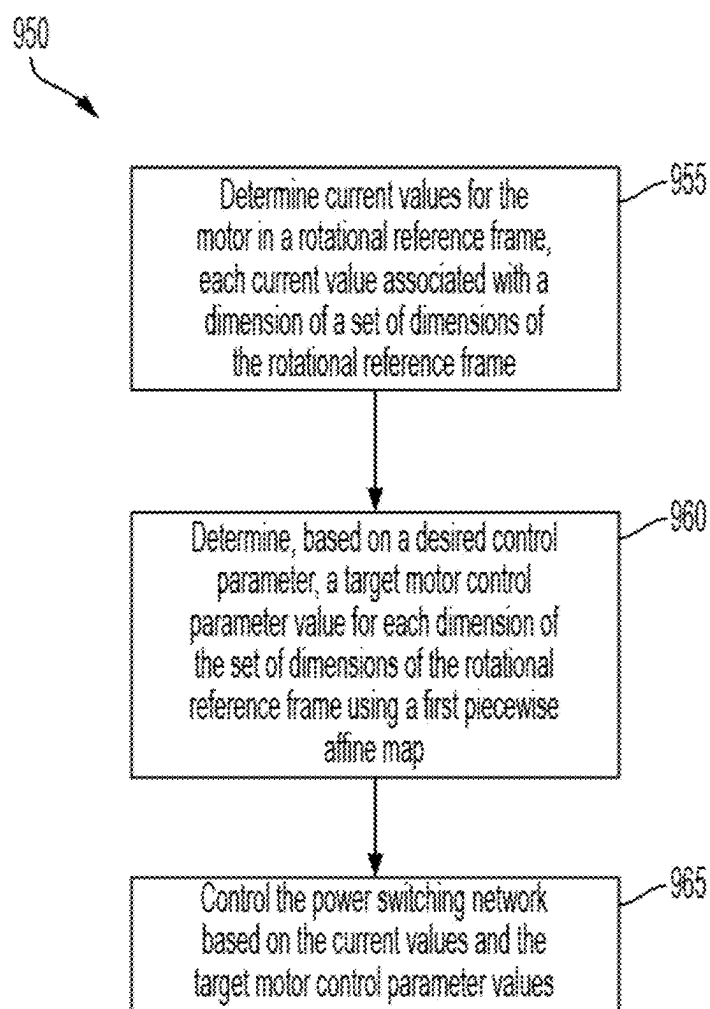


FIG. 9B

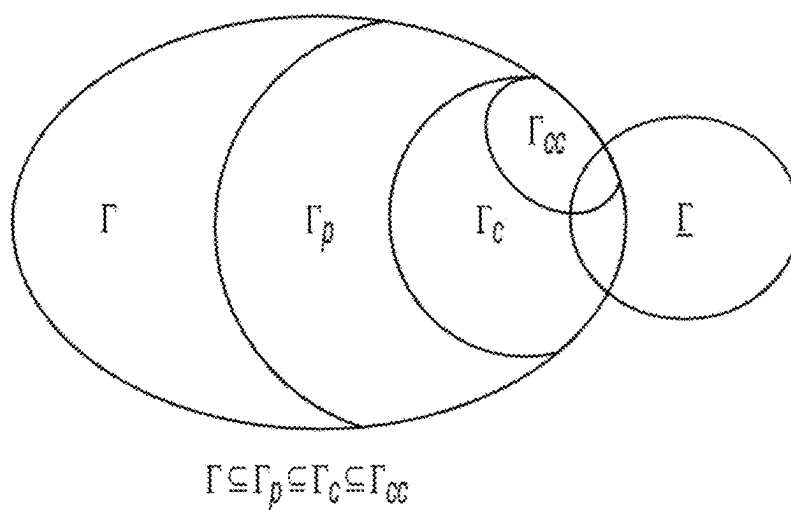


FIG. 10A

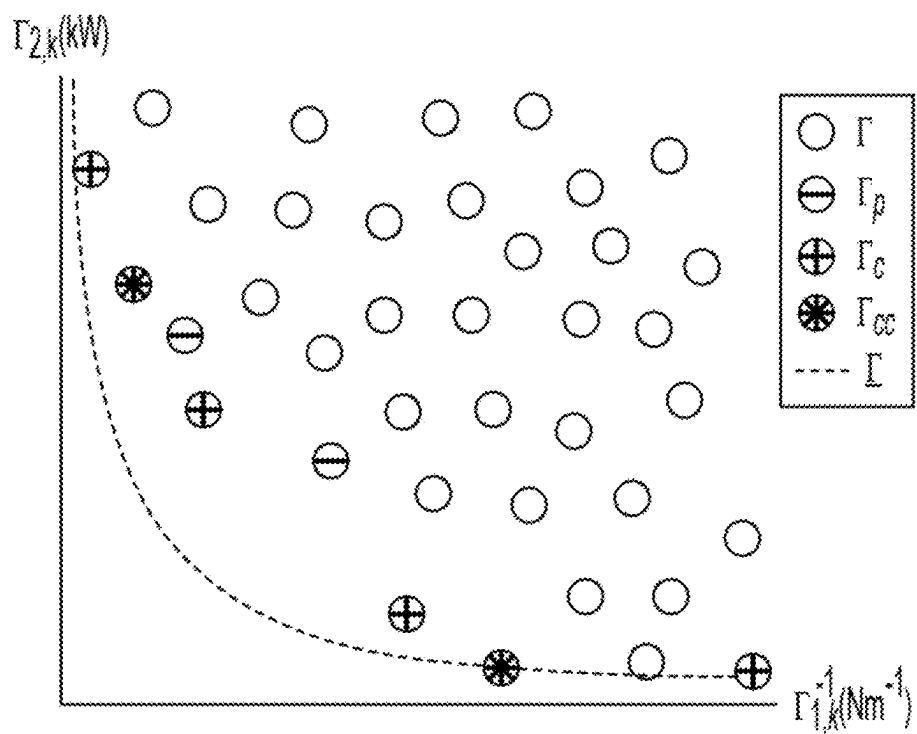


FIG. 10B

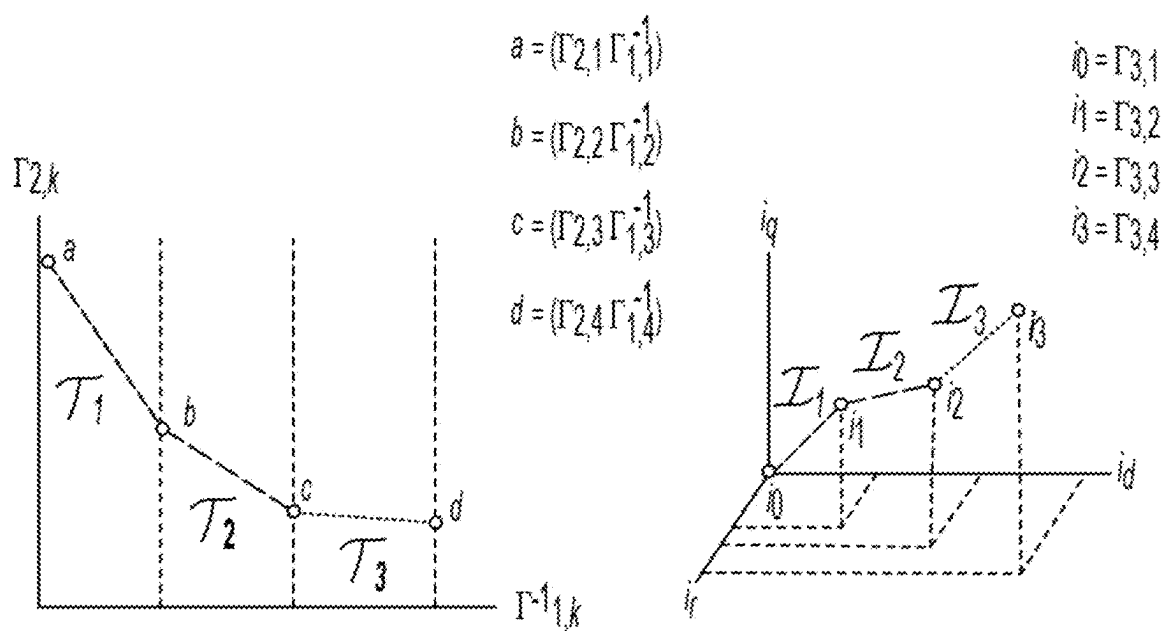


FIG. 11

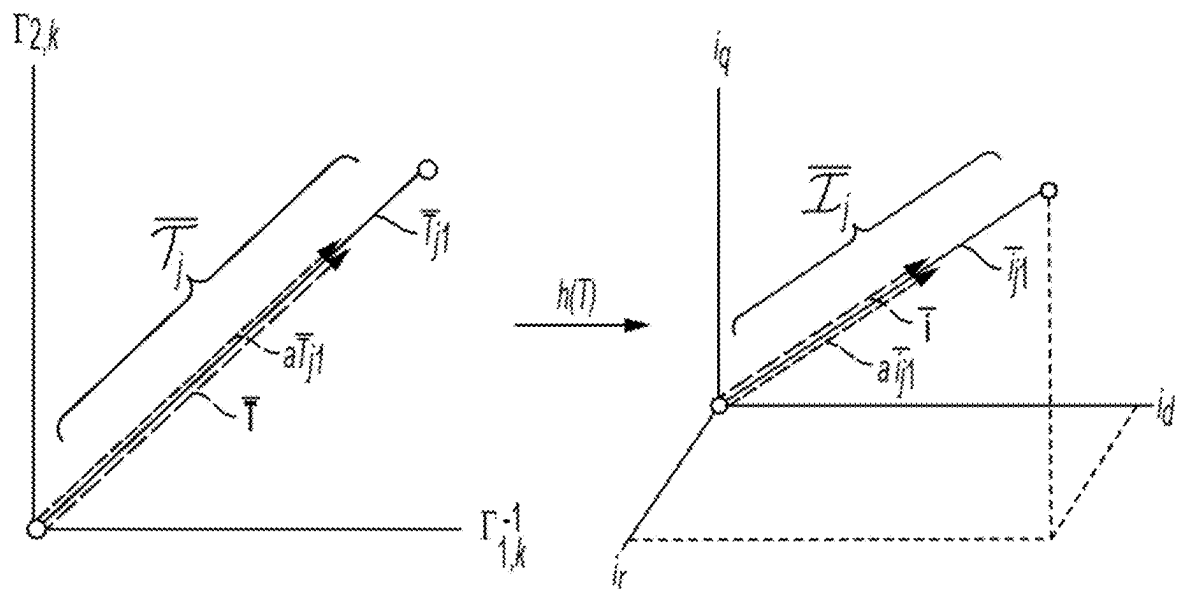


FIG. 12

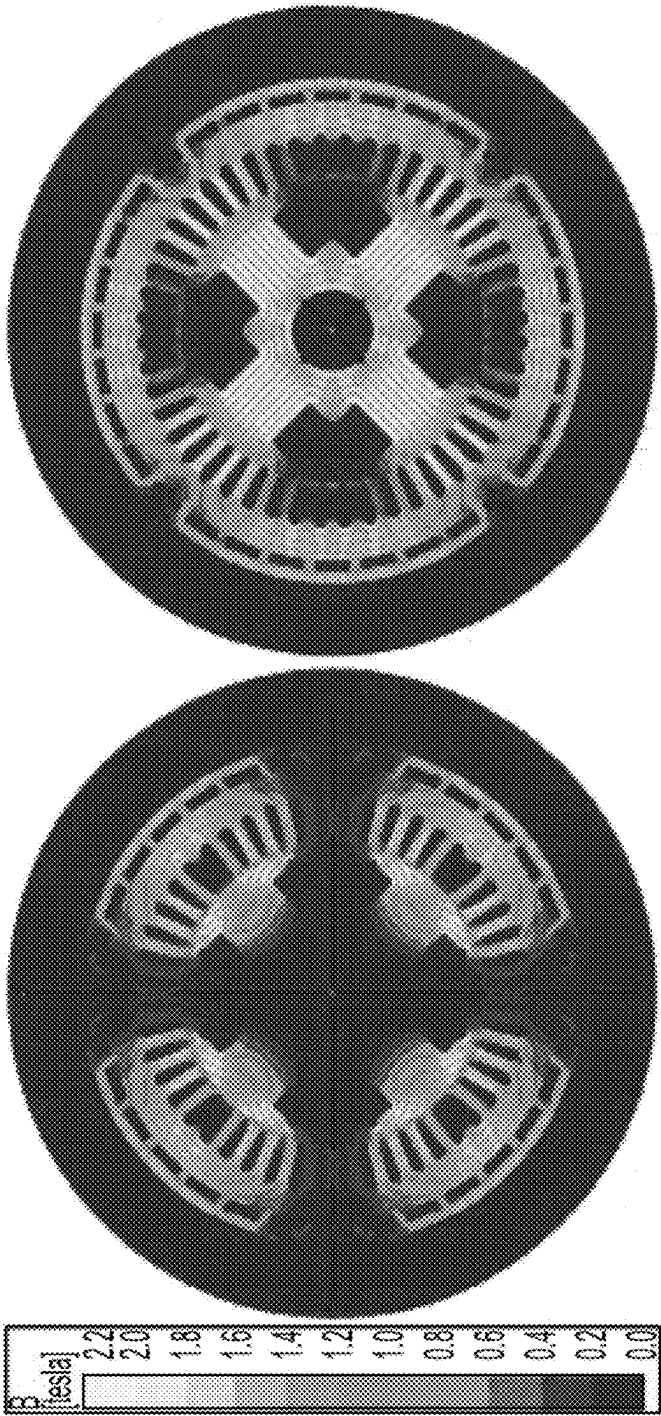


FIG. 13

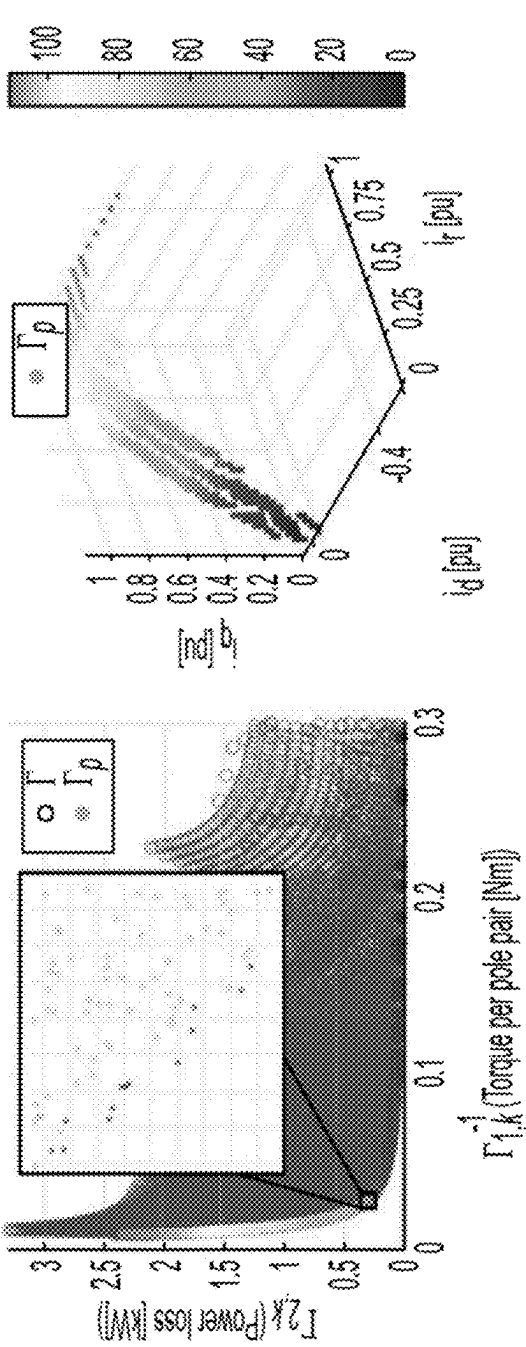


FIG. 14A

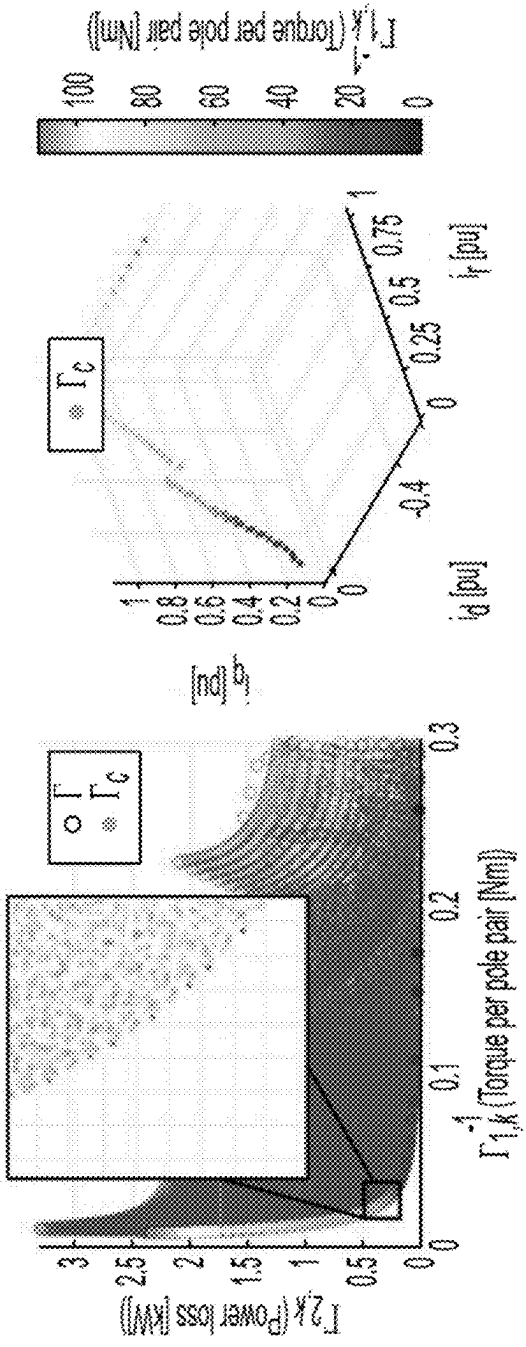


FIG. 14B

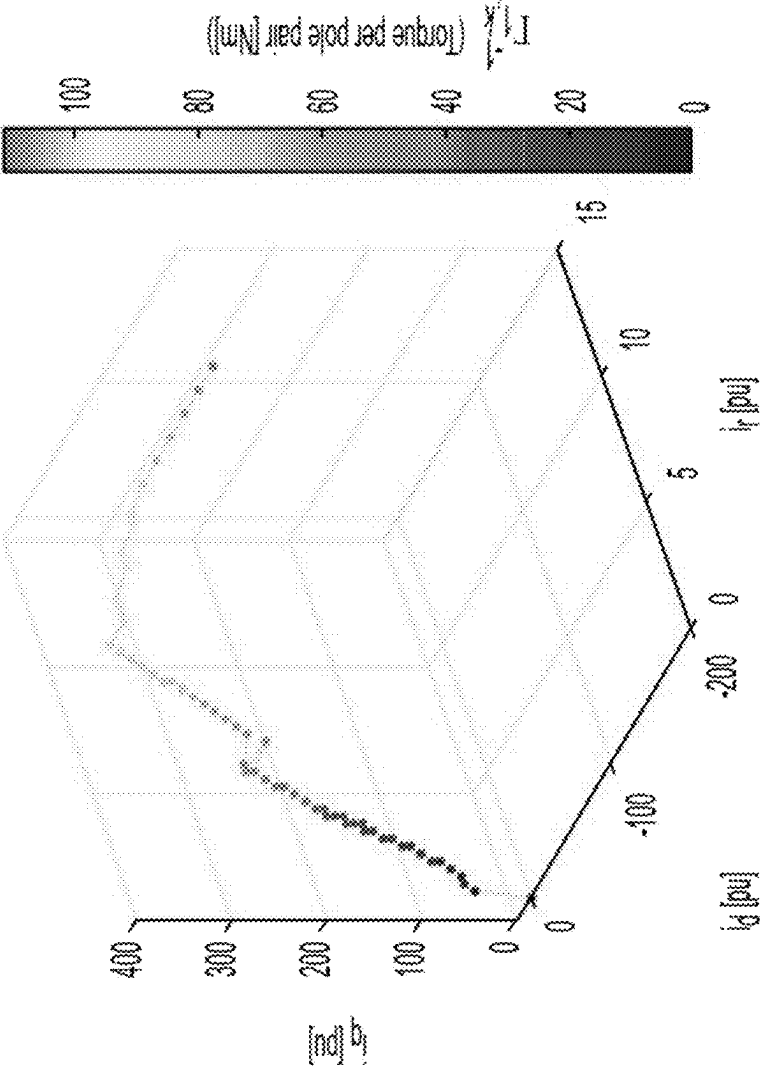


FIG. 14C

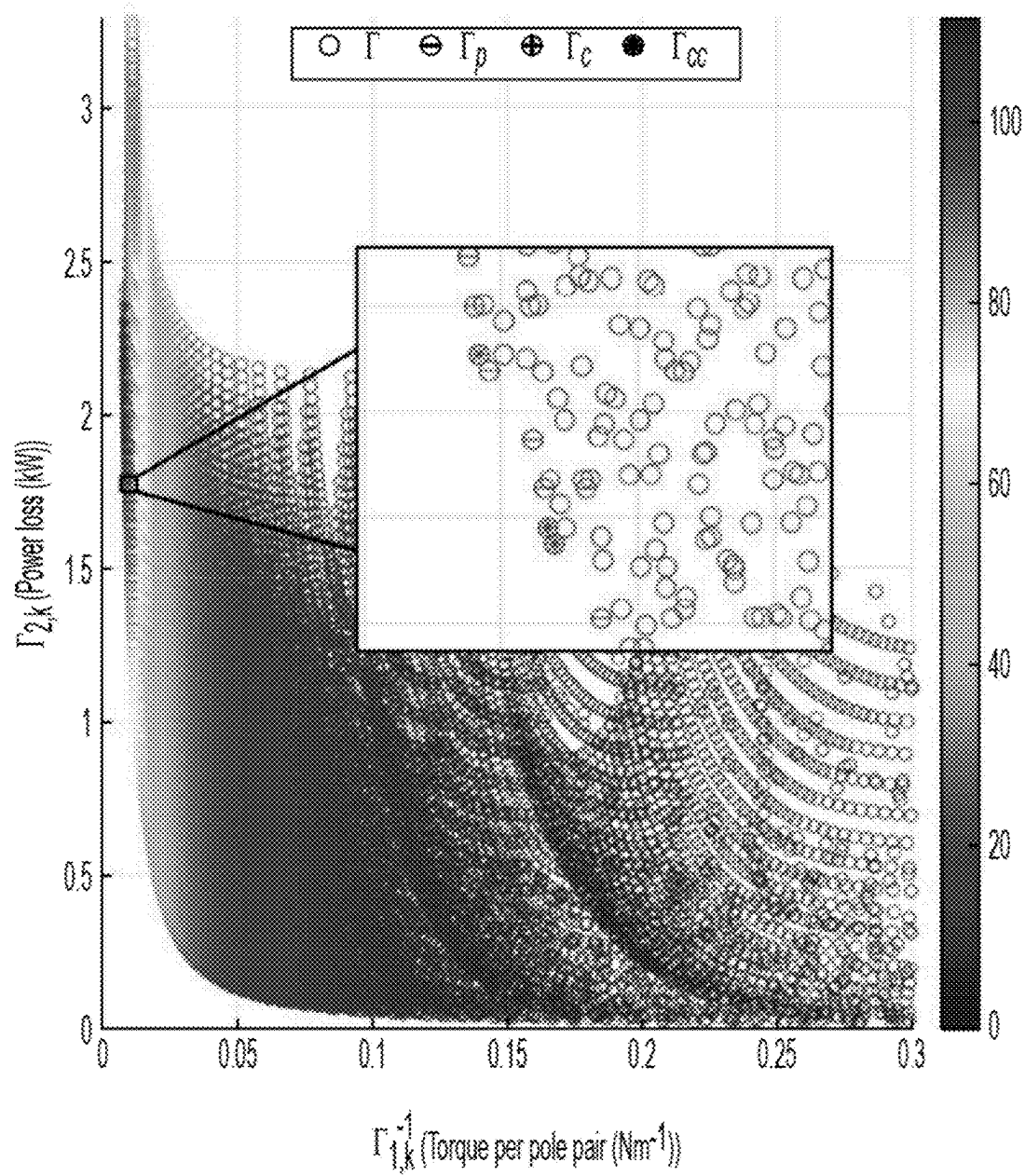


FIG. 15A

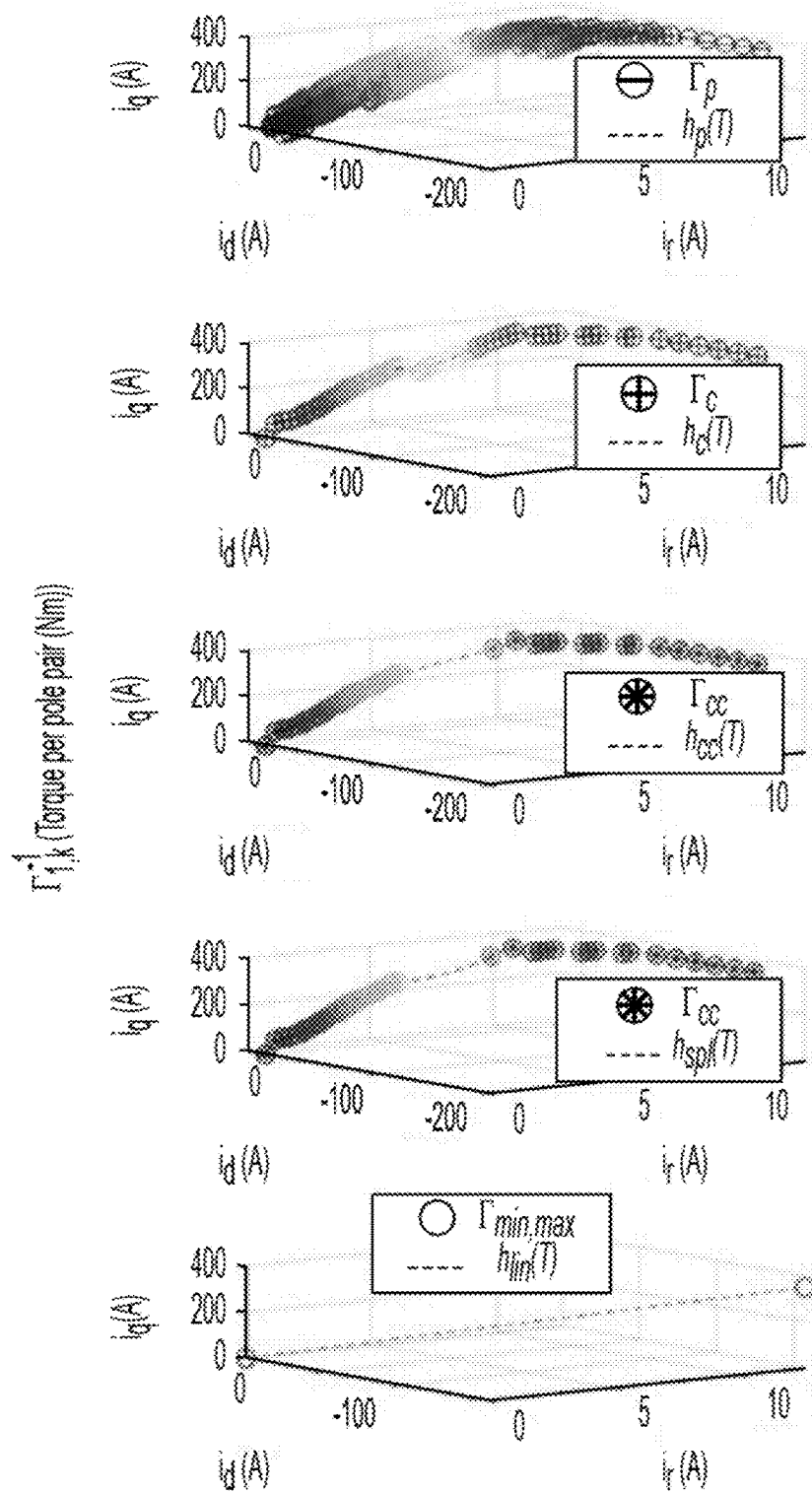


FIG. 15B

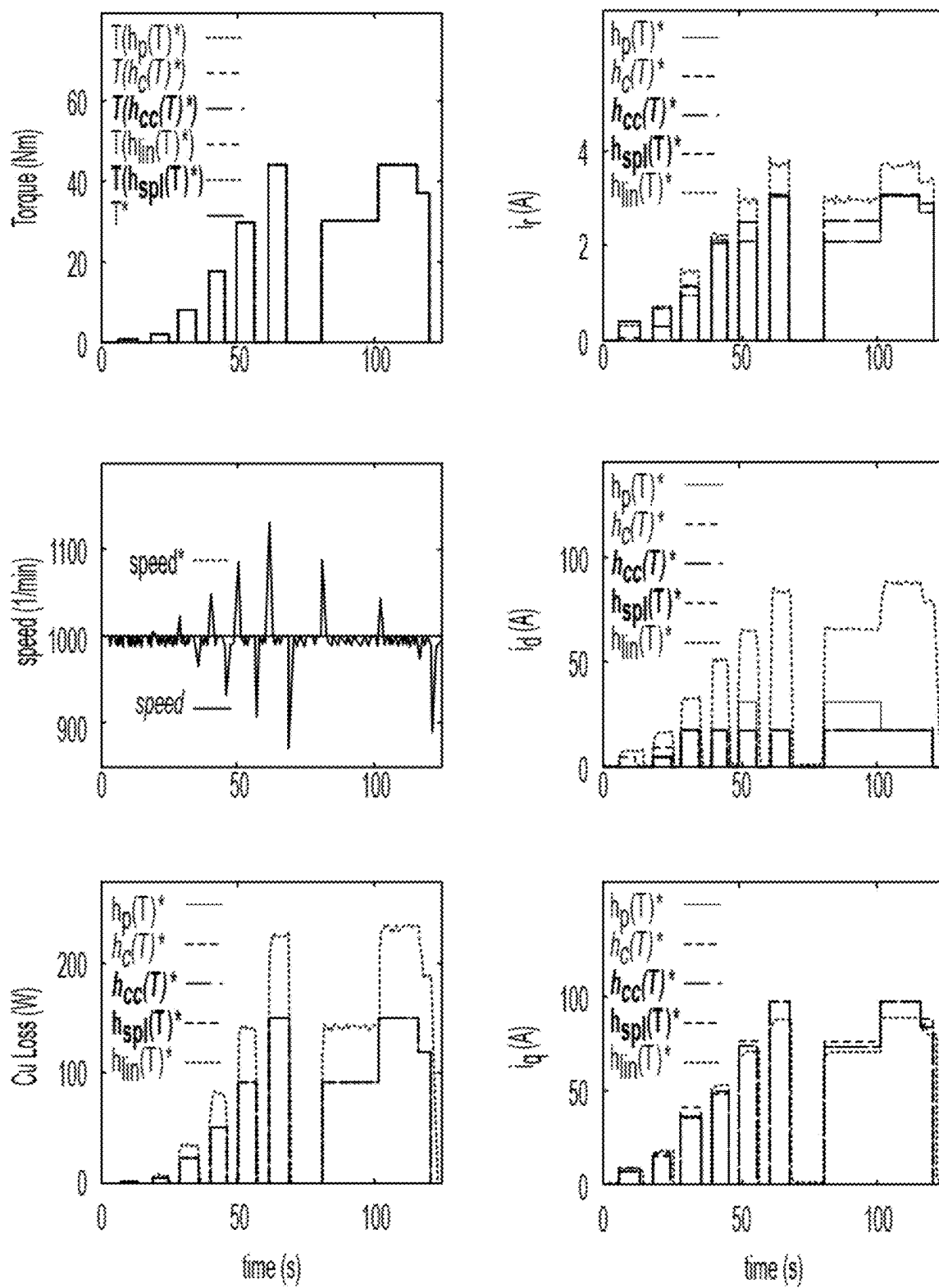


FIG. 15C

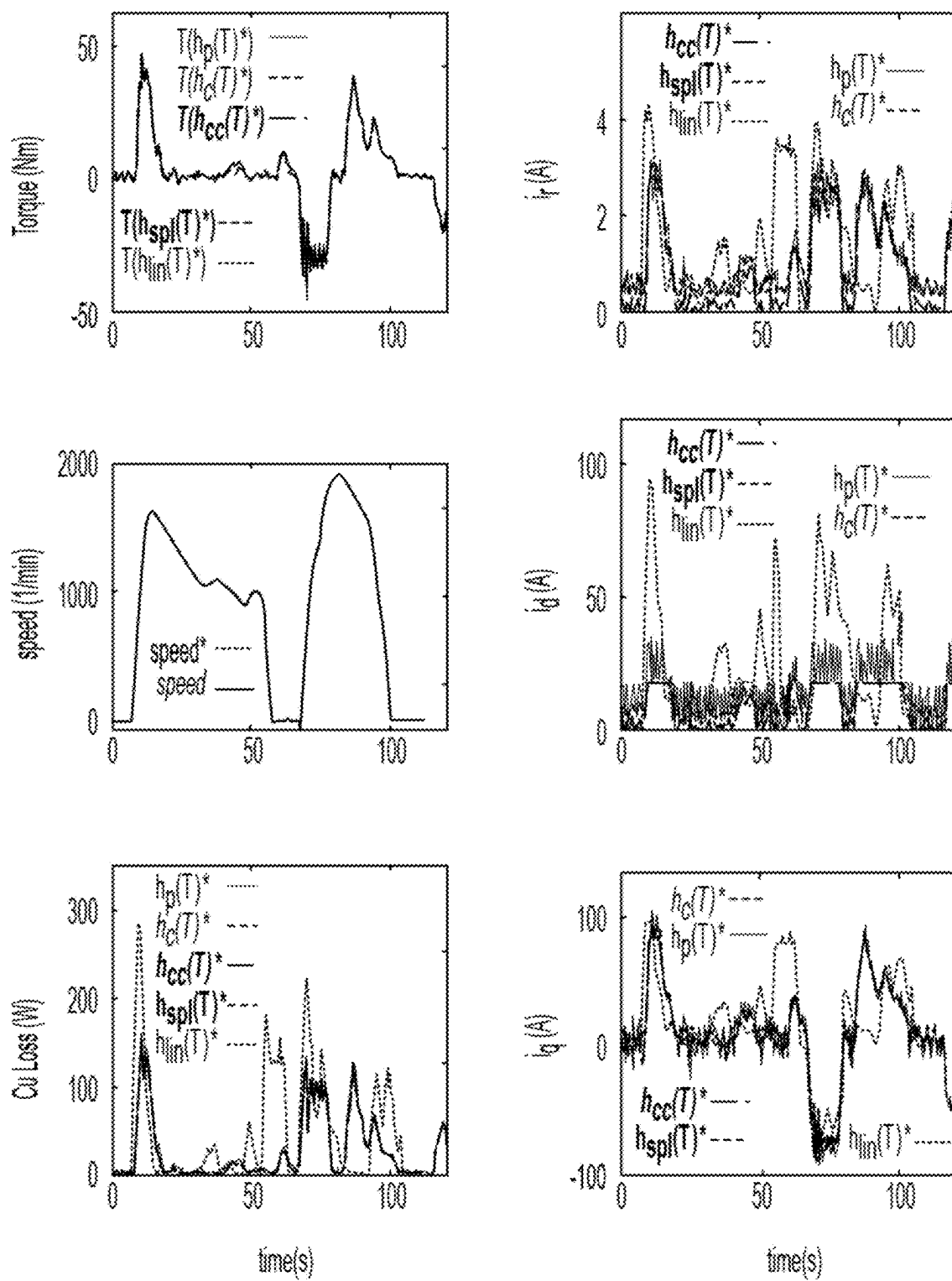


FIG. 15D

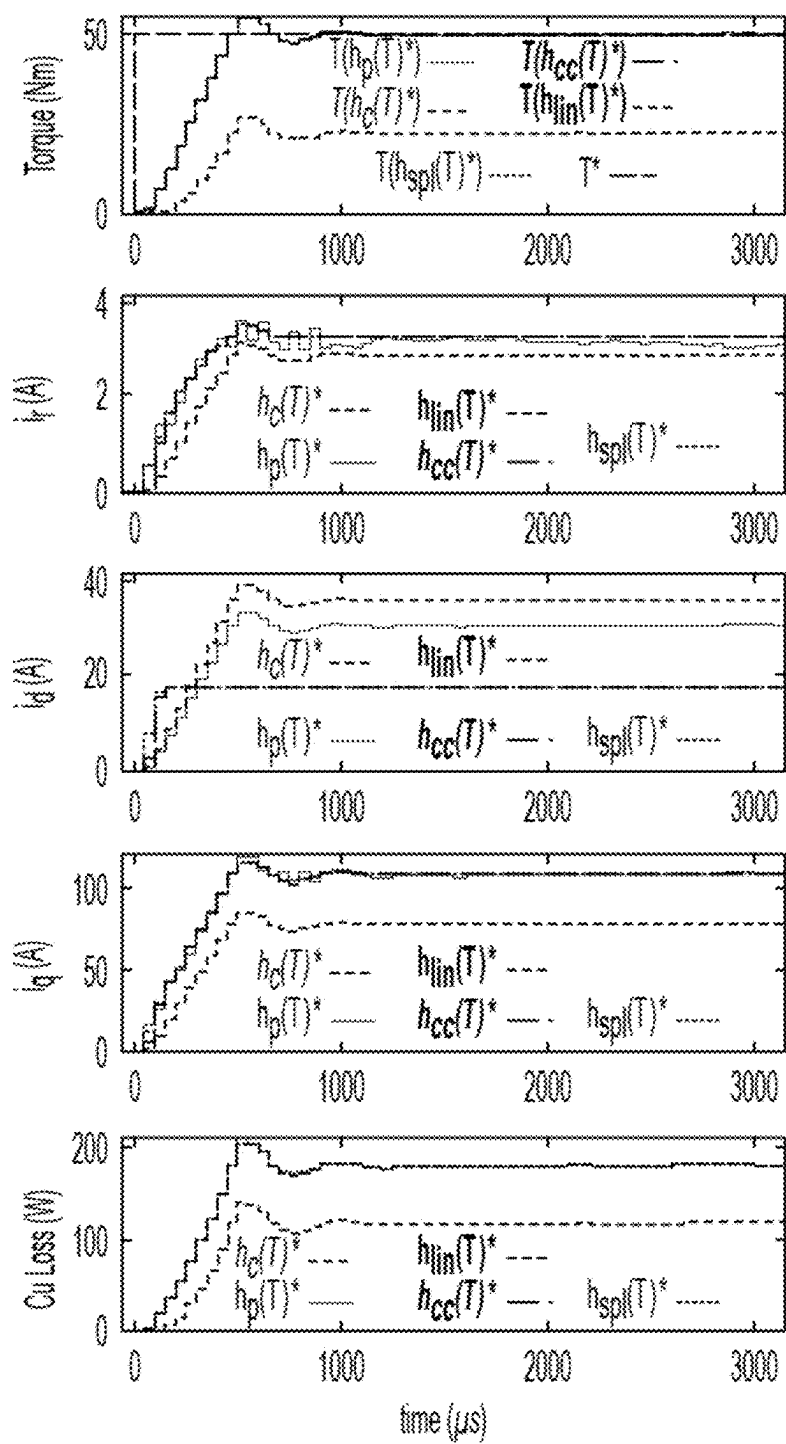


FIG. 15E

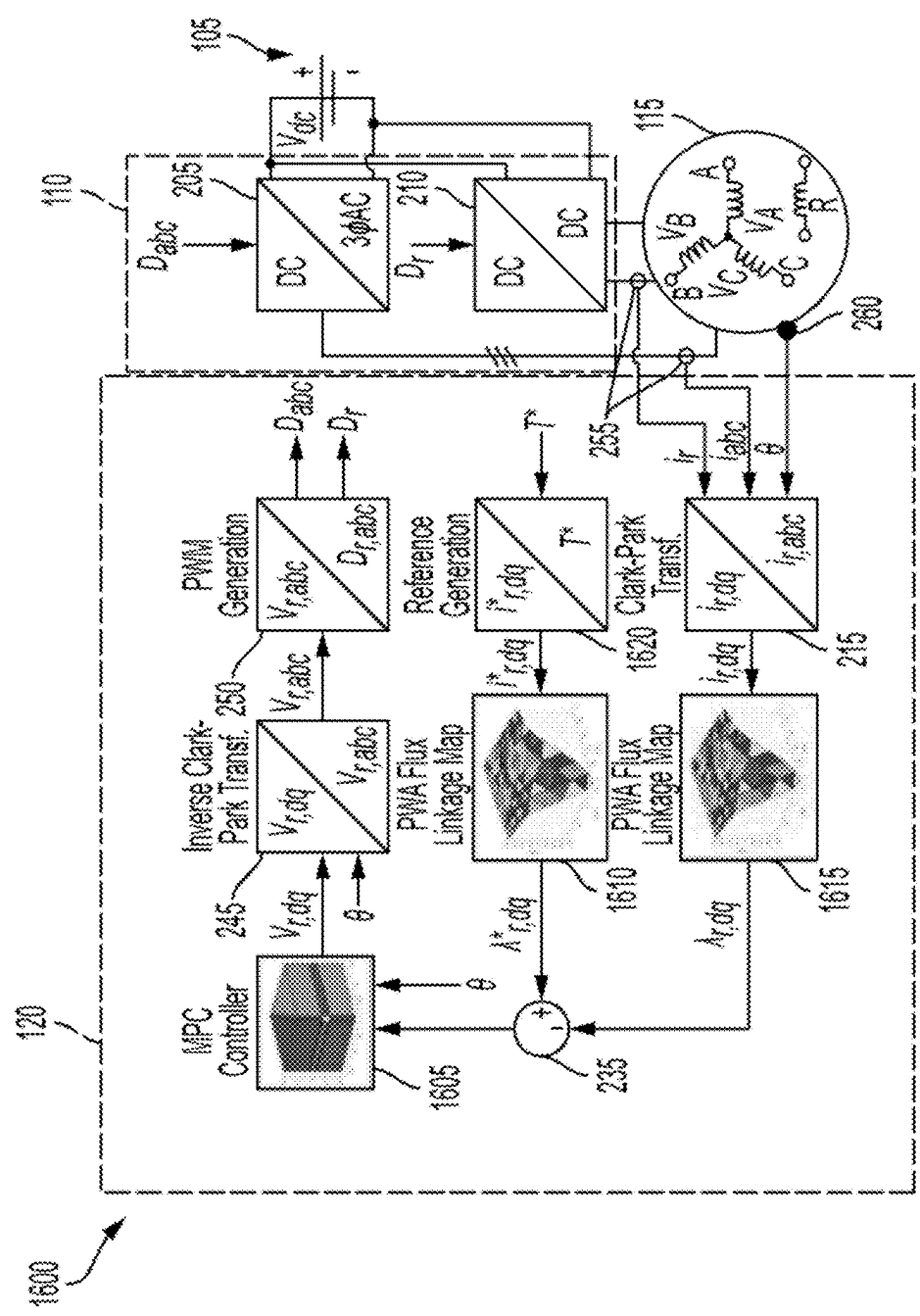


FIG. 16

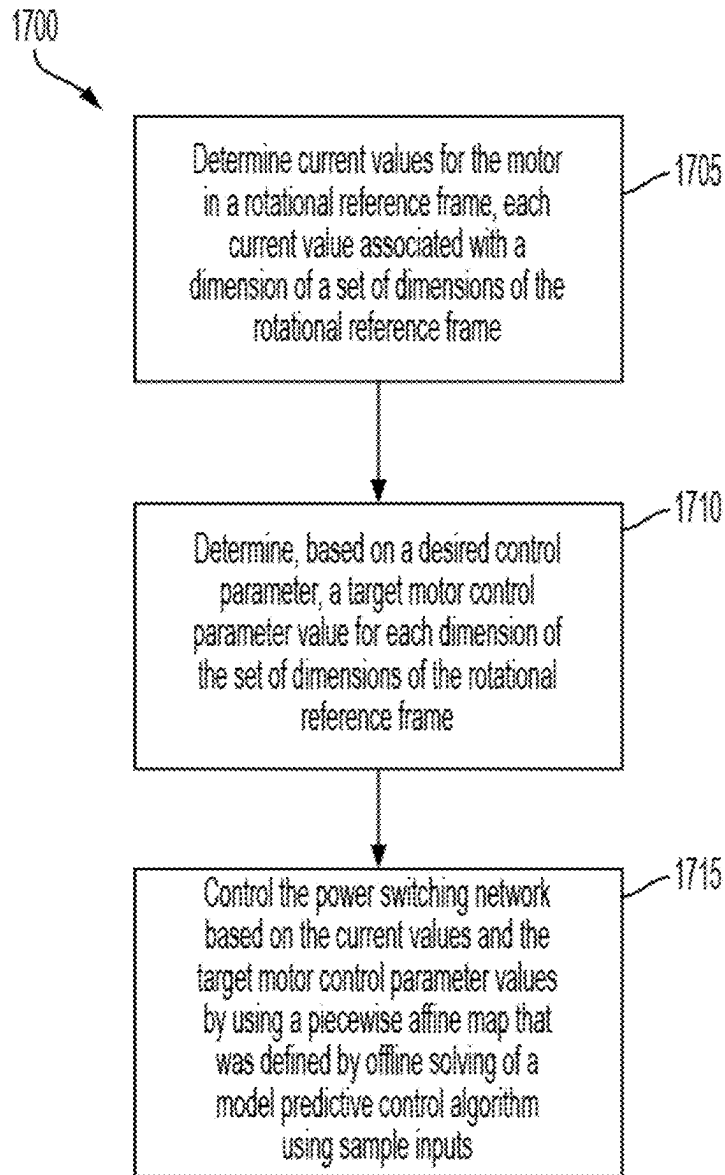


FIG. 17

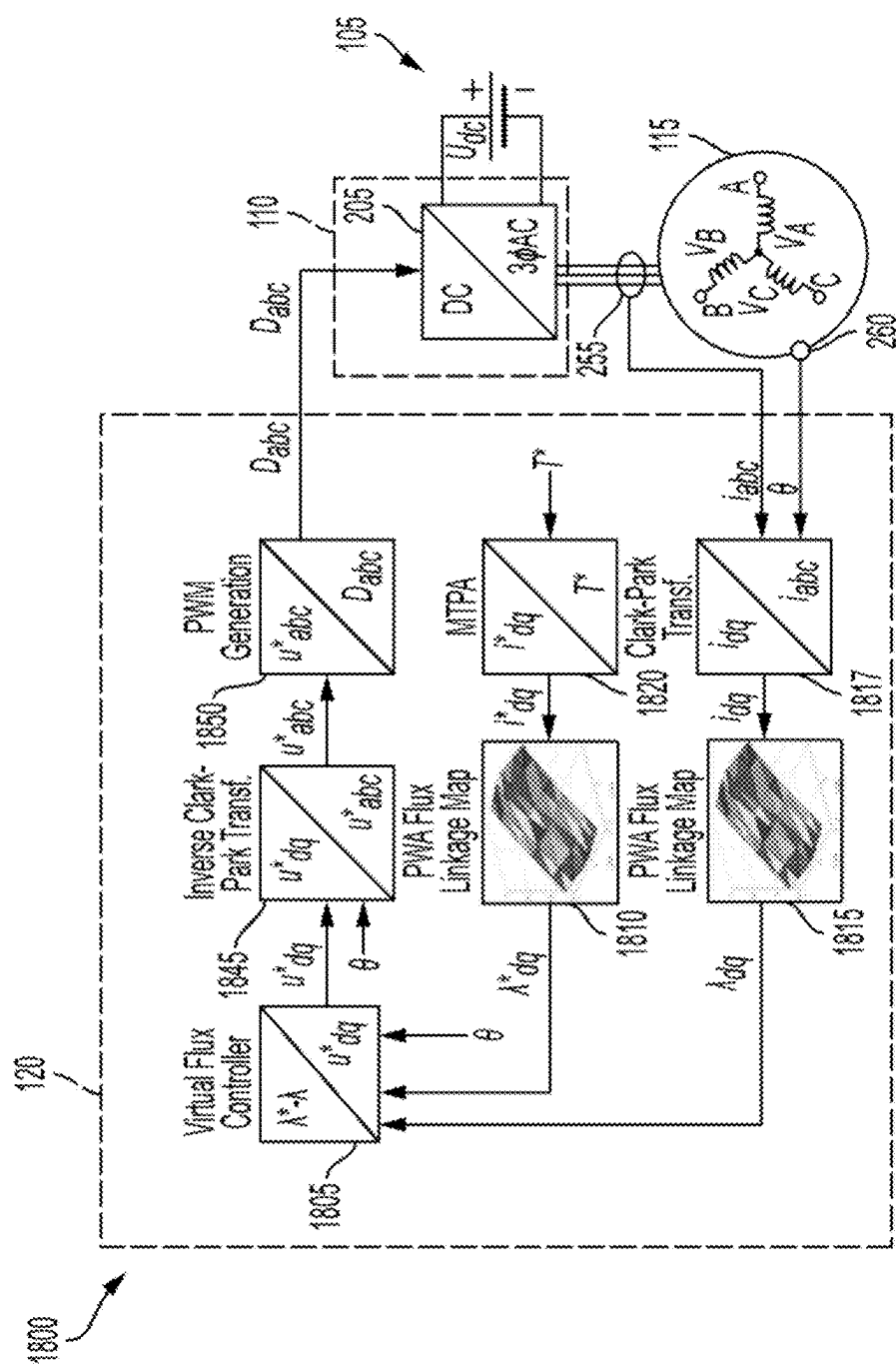


FIG. 18

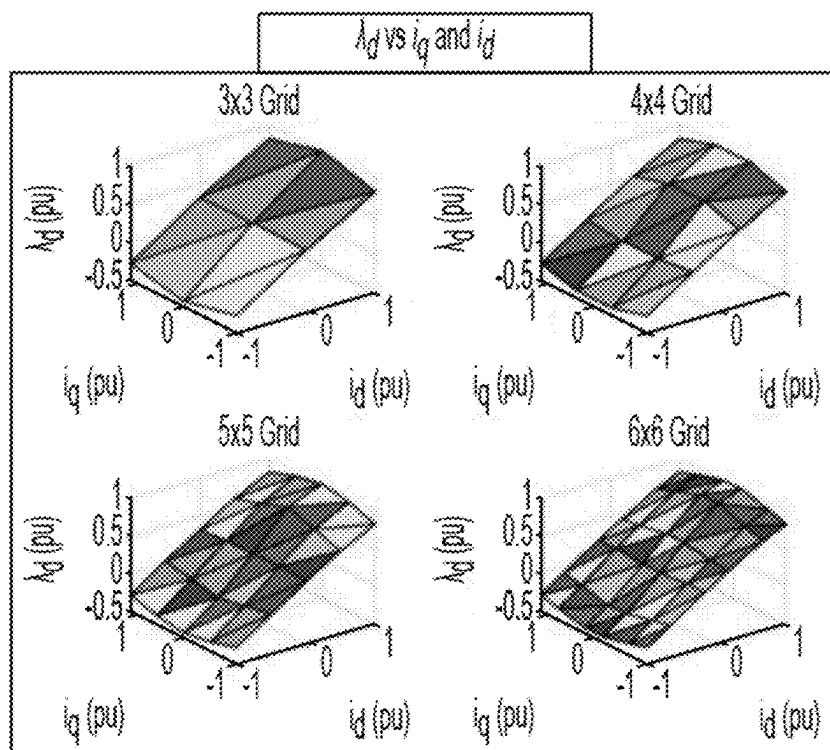


FIG. 19A

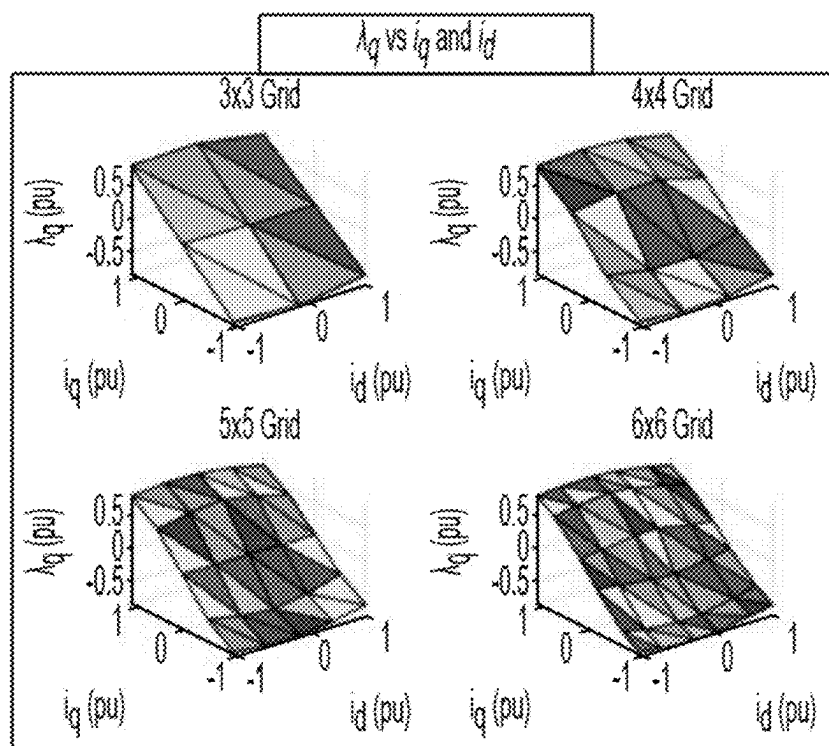


FIG. 19B

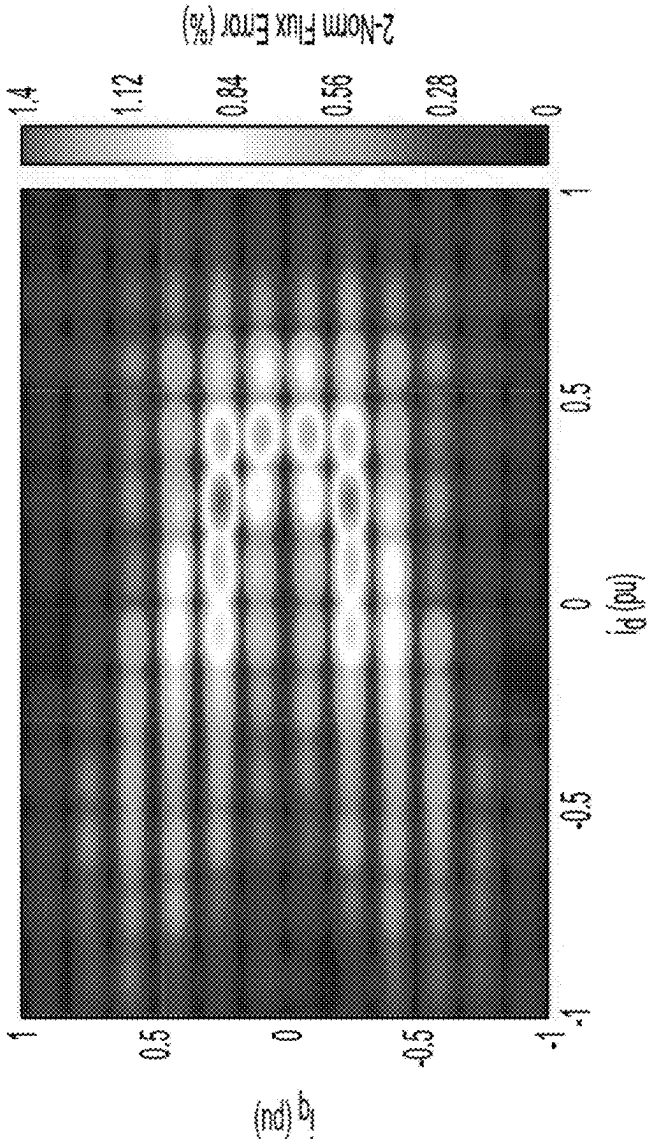


FIG. 20

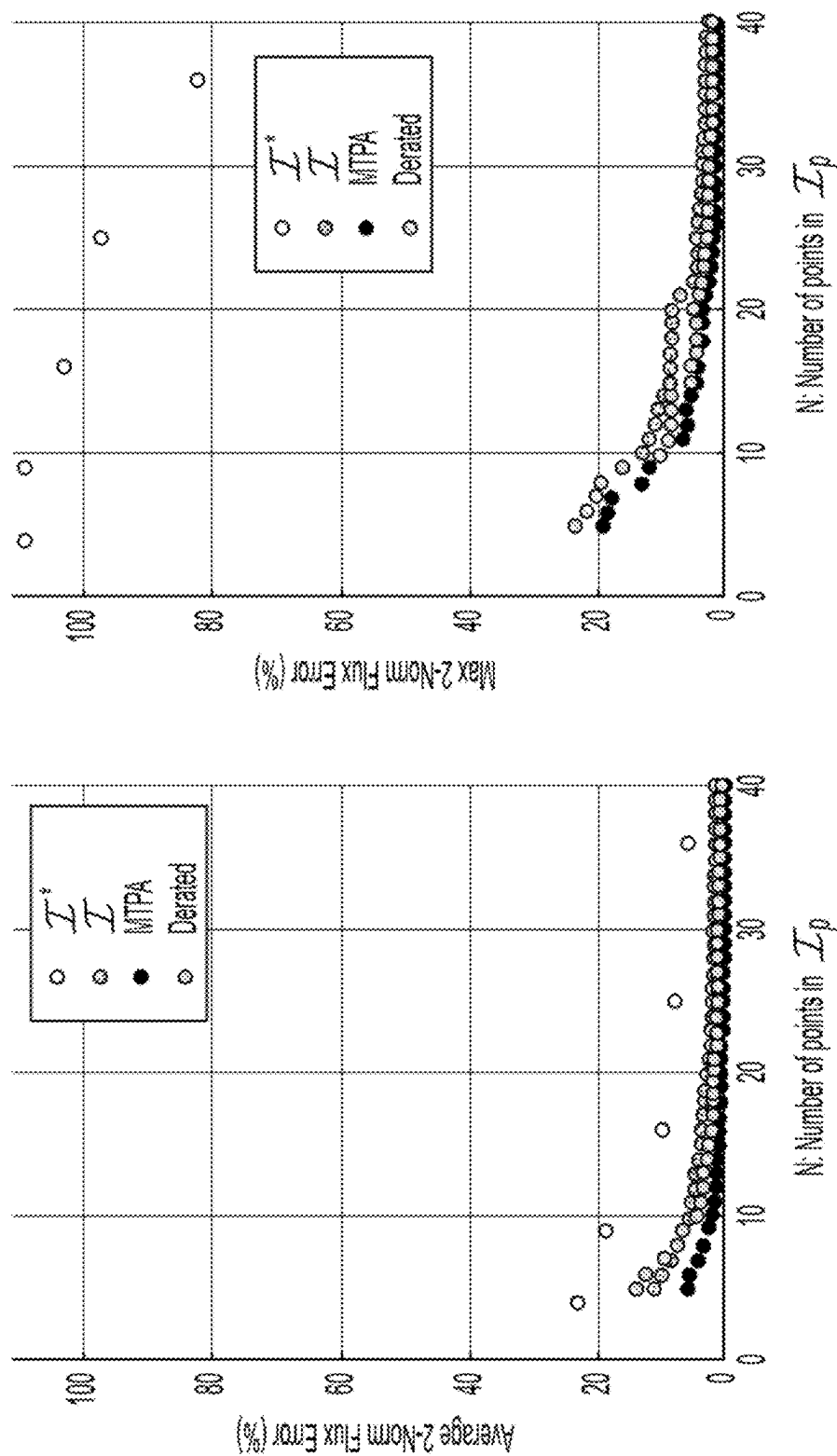


FIG. 21

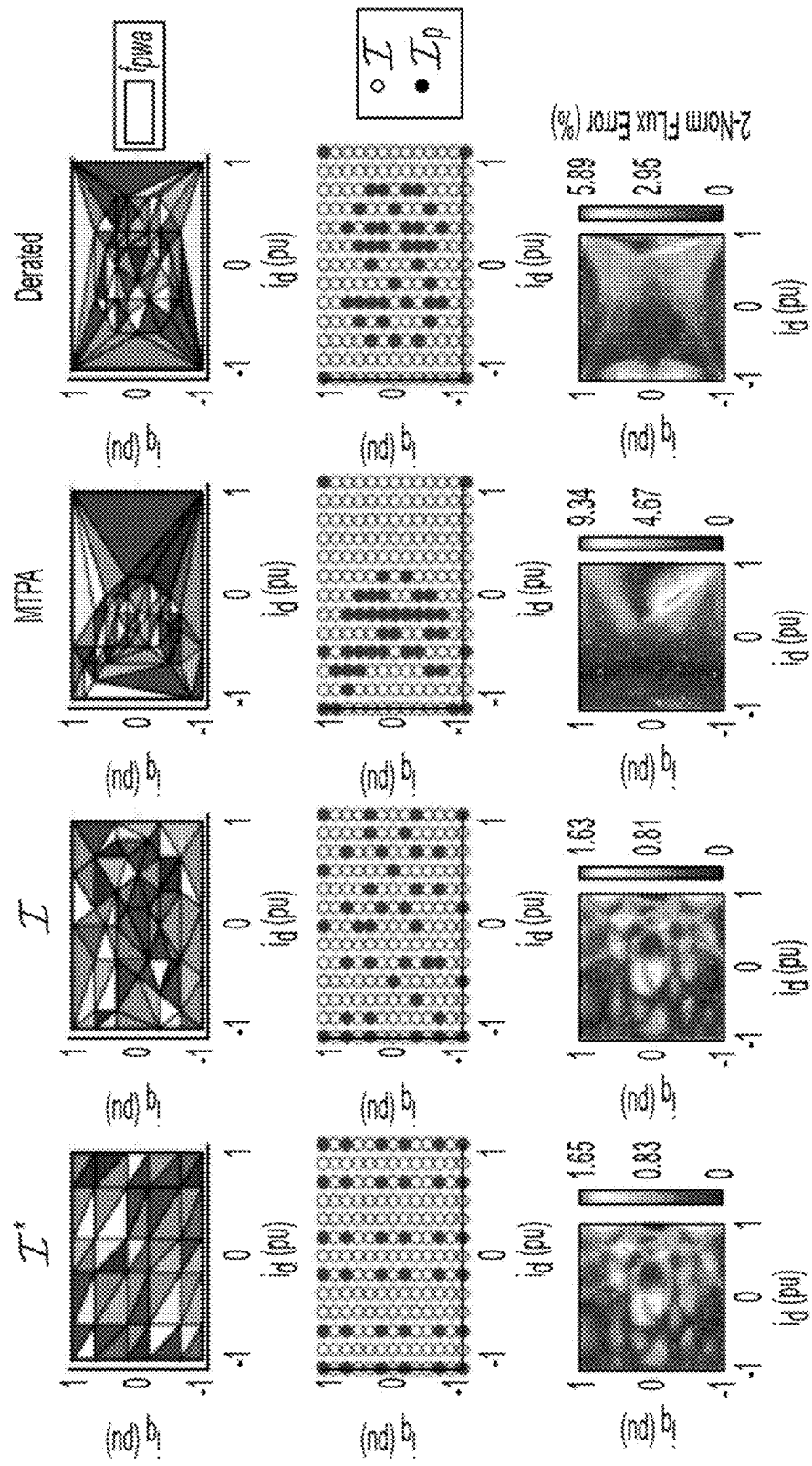


FIG. 22

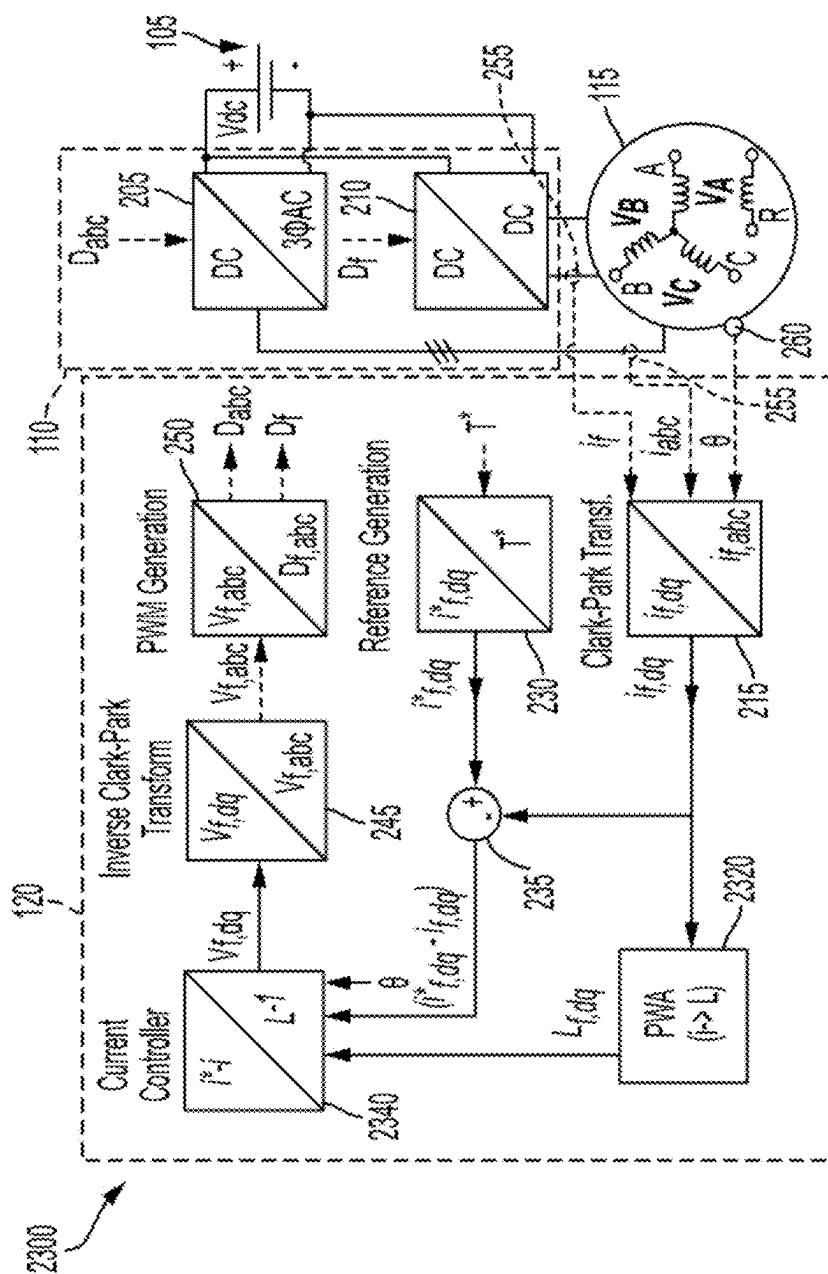


FIG. 23

MOTOR CONTROL USING PIECEWISE AFFINE MODEL

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/730,268, filed Jul. 18, 2024, which is represents the U.S. national stage entry of International Application No. PCT/US2023/011786 filed Jan. 27, 2023, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/304,527, filed on Jan. 28, 2022, to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/345,879, filed May 25, 2022, to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/409,418, filed Sep. 23, 2022, to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/420,360, filed Oct. 28, 2022, and to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/479,352, filed Jan. 10, 2023, each of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH

[0002] N/A

BACKGROUND

[0003] Electric machines (e.g., electric motors) produce torque using magnetic fields and currents and use ferromagnetic materials to maximize and channel magnetic flux. In particular, modern electric machine designs may aim at minimizing core materials to reduce motor weight and cost. This relationship between flux and the current that generates the flux is generally non-linear and exhibits saturation and cross saturation. This relationship may be modeled using magnetic models (MMs), which are also referred to as flux linkage maps. Digital controllers for electric machines may use an MM, even if just a linearized one. The accuracy and performance of these controllers can significantly depend on the accuracy of the MM for some machines and applications. MMs can be categorized into static (offline) and dynamic (online) methods, and can include other nonlinear drive-system effects such as, for example, switching harmonics, switching dead times, iron losses, and machine temperature. Offline MMs may use one or a combination of Finite Element Analysis (FEA), analytical calculations, and experimental values to measure inductances at various operating points. The discrete values obtained by these methods may be linked together using a variety of methods. Online MMs may use a combination of online-estimated parameters from real-time measurements and an offline MM to produce a dynamic MM. Such dynamic MM models may have the ability to adapt to temperature, switch dead time, PWM harmonics, aging, and partial faults in real time. Examples of online estimation techniques used in dynamic MMs include Extended Kalman Filters, observer-based LPV, neural networks, and Taylor Series approximations.

SUMMARY

[0004] Both offline and online MM methods are subject to computational and memory constraints of the digital signal processor (DSP) that is used for control of the electric motors. Electric motors of various types have been produced and used in many industries and contexts. The complexity of the control technique may vary depending on the type of motor. As one example type of motor, a synchronous motor is an alternating current (AC) motor having a stator that is

driven by AC supply signals (e.g., one signal for each phase of the stator) to cause rotation of a rotor. More particularly, the AC supply signals in stator windings of the stator generate magnetic fields that interact with a magnetic field or fields of the rotor to cause rotation of the rotor. The rotation of the rotor is generally synchronous with the frequency of the AC supply current. The rotor may be a permanent magnet rotor, a wound field rotor, or a hybrid rotor including both wound fields and permanent magnets. In the case of a permanent magnet rotor, one or more permanent magnets of the rotor generate the magnetic field or fields of the rotor. In the case of a wound field rotor, current is supplied to one or more field windings of the rotor to generate the magnetic field or fields of the rotor. In the case of the hybrid rotor, both permanent magnets and wound fields receiving current generate the magnetic field or fields of the rotor.

[0005] Controlling the application of current to the stator windings and, in the case of a wound field rotor, rotor windings, at the particular time and amplitude to efficiently drive a synchronous motor can be challenging. For example, a motor controller may control an inverter to provide an AC signal to each phase of the motor based on current rotor position and other characteristics of the motor. The physics of the magnetic fields of each stator winding interacting with the rotating rotor can lead to complex mathematics problems that are challenging to create and solve to address factors that lead to efficient driving of the motor, and these challenges can be exacerbated in the case of a wound field synchronous (WFS) motor because of the added wound field rotor. A WFS motor may also be referred to as a wound rotor synchronous machine (WRSN), a wound field synchronous machine (WFSM), a wound rotor synchronous generator (WRSNG), a wound field synchronous generator (WFSNG), as well as several other names.

[0006] In some systems, motor controllers operate using a rotating reference frame to simplify the motor control. For example, motor characteristics (in a stationary reference frame) may be measured and transformed into a direct-quadrature-Null (DQN) space, or DQN+rotor (R) space or reference frame (also referred to as the DQNR, RDQNull, and RDQØ reference frame), using a transform based on the Clarke and Park transforms. In other words, the motor characteristics (e.g., stator currents, rotor currents, and rotor position) can be transformed into a D-axis value, a Q-axis value, an N-axis (or Ø-axis) value, and an R (rotor field) value. By using a rotating reference frame where the stator rotates at the frequency of the AC signals, the AC signals can be treated as direct current signals (i.e., the D, Q, N, and R values), which can simplify the calculations used to determine control signals. Desired DQN and R values may be calculated based on the determined DQN and R values, and then transformed back into stator and rotor control values in the stationary reference frame to control the motor. In some examples, the rotor field dimension of this reference frame is referred to using the variable “F” or “f” (i.e., for rotor field) instead of “R” or “r.”

[0007] Relative to permanent magnet (PM) synchronous motors, in RDQN control schemes for WFS motors, the rotor provides an extra state cross-coupling between the (stator) D-axis and R (rotor field), in addition to a state of coupling between the (stator) D-axis and Q-axis that may exist in both PM synchronous and WFS motors. In other words, for both PM synchronous and WFS motors, changes

to the D-axis impact the Q-axis and changes to the Q-axis impact the D-axis. However, for WFS motors, an additional control complexity is present in that changes to the D-axis impact R, and changes to R impact the D-axis. The cross-coupling between the D-axis and R components stems, at least in some cases, from the inherent air gap between the stator and rotor. These cross-couplings increase the complexity and present challenges to designing motors and motor controllers for high performance applications of WFS motors.

[0008] Some embodiments disclosed herein address these or other issues. For example, some embodiments disclosed herein are directed to motor control using piecewise affine (PWA) modelling. Such motor control may enable an offline MM-based motor control that reduces the use of computational and memory resources of a motor controller (e.g., a DSP) while providing improved motor control accuracy, relative to other offline MM-based motor control techniques. Although primarily described herein with respect to WFS or permanent magnet synchronous (PMS) motors, motor control using PWA modeling is also applicable to other motor types, including other brushless motors with permanent magnet rotors, induction motors, universal motors, reluctance motors (synchronous and switched), and the like. Further, as is well known, an electric machine serving as an electric motor that outputs mechanical power from input electric power may also operate in reverse and serve as an electric generator that outputs electric power from input mechanical power. Accordingly, for ease of description, the electric machines described herein will generally be referred to as electric motors, but are meant to also encompass electric generators and devices that may operate as both an electric motor and an electric generator. That is, the motor control techniques described herein may also be applied to controlling the electric motors operating as generators. The term “electric machine” may also be used to generically refer to either or both of an electric motor and an electric generator.

[0009] In one embodiment, a motor control system is provided. The motor control system includes a power switching network configured to be coupled to a power supply; a motor coupled to the power switching network; and an electronic controller. The electronic controller is configured to: determine current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determine, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a piecewise affine map; determine a target flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and control the power switching network based on the flux linkage values and the target flux linkage values.

[0010] In another embodiment, a method of controlling a motor is provided. The method includes: determining, by an electronic controller, current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a piecewise affine map; determining, by the electronic controller, a target flux linkage value for each of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and controlling, by the electronic control-

ler, a power switching network coupled between a power supply and the motor based on the flux linkage values and the target flux linkage values.

[0011] In another embodiment, a motor system is provided. The motor system includes an electronic controller including a processor and a memory. The electronic controller is configured to: obtain a data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of an electric motor; apply a domain decomposition algorithm to the data set to generate current simplices and flux linkage simplices; and store the current simplices and flux linkage simplices in a memory.

[0012] In another embodiment, a method of controlling a motor is provided. The method includes obtaining, by an electronic controller, a data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of an electric motor; applying, by the electronic controller, a domain decomposition algorithm to the data set to generate current simplices and flux linkage simplices; and storing, by the electronic controller, the current simplices and flux linkage simplices in a memory.

[0013] In another embodiment, a motor system is provided. The motor system includes a power switching network configured to be coupled to a power supply, a motor coupled to the power switching network, and an electronic controller. The electronic controller is configured to: determine current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determine, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map defining a minimum power loss per torque (MPLPT) function; and control the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values.

[0014] In another embodiment, a method of controlling a motor is provided. The method includes: determining, by an electronic controller, current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determining, by the electronic controller and based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map; and controlling, by the electronic controller, a power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values.

[0015] In another embodiment, a motor system is provided. The motor system includes a power switching network configured to be coupled to a power supply; a motor coupled to the power switching network; and an electronic controller. The electronic controller is configured to: determine current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determine, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and control the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values by using a piecewise affine map that was defined by offline solving of a constrained finite time optimal control algorithm using sample inputs.

[0016] In another embodiment, a method is provided. The method includes determining, by an electronic controller, current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determining, by the electronic controller and based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and controlling, by the electronic controller, a power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values by using a piecewise affine map that was defined by offline solving of a model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs.

[0017] The foregoing and other aspects and advantages of the present disclosure will appear from the following description. In the description, reference is made to the accompanying drawings that form a part hereof, and in which there is shown by way of illustration one or more embodiment. These embodiments do not necessarily represent the full scope of the invention, however, and reference is therefore made to the claims and herein for interpreting the scope of the invention. Like reference numerals will be used to refer to like parts from Figure to Figure in the following description.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0018] FIG. 1 illustrates a motor system according to some embodiments.

[0019] FIG. 2 illustrates an example of the motor system of FIG. 1 including a controller implementing a current-to-flux piecewise affine (PWA) map according to some embodiments.

[0020] FIG. 3 illustrates a process for controlling a motor using a PWA map according to some embodiments.

[0021] FIG. 4 illustrates a configuration system according to some embodiments.

[0022] FIG. 5 illustrates two plots for an example data set of current-flux linkage pairs in the RDQ domain for a three-phase wound field synchronous motor (WFSM).

[0023] FIG. 6 illustrates a process to generate a PWA map using an irregularly spaced grid of operational points.

[0024] FIGS. 7A-7F illustrate respective heat maps of a 2-Norm error for PWA maps generated using the process of FIG. 6.

[0025] FIGS. 8A-C illustrate examples of PWA maps that are generated from data sets of regularly sampled current grids that are downsampled to various extents.

[0026] FIG. 9A illustrates another example of the motor system of FIG. 1, which includes a controller implementing a MPLPT control scheme according to some embodiments.

[0027] FIG. 9B illustrates a process for implementing MPLPT motor control using a piecewise affine model according to some embodiments.

[0028] FIG. 10A illustrates relationships between sets of datapoints that may be considered for use in generation of a MPLPT control scheme according to some embodiments.

[0029] FIG. 10B illustrates examples points of the sets of datapoints of FIG. 10A according to some embodiments.

[0030] FIG. 11 illustrates three-dimensional current slope and current offset for an affine map according to some embodiments.

[0031] FIG. 12 illustrates a simplices and a shift of origin according to some embodiments.

[0032] FIG. 13 illustrates a cross-section of a WFS motor used to produce experimental MPLPT control results according to some embodiments.

[0033] FIG. 14A illustrates a set of points Γ and pareto frontier Γ_p collected using FEA-simulated data for the WFS motor (left), and the corresponding three-dimensional MPLPT currents that will be candidate points for MPLPT (right) according to some embodiments.

[0034] FIG. 14B illustrates simulated points Γ and convex pareto-optimal solutions Γ_c (left) and the corresponding three-dimensional MPLPT currents that will be used to construct $h(T)$ (right) according to some embodiments.

[0035] FIG. 14C illustrates a piecewise linear function according to some embodiments.

[0036] FIG. 15A illustrates simulation results including powerloss versus torque domain FEA-simulated points Γ and subsets Γ_p , Γ_c , Γ_{cc} .

[0037] FIG. 15B illustrates simulation results including current domain sets Γ , Γ_p , Γ_c , Γ_{cc} , and functions $h_p(T_p)$, $h_c(T_p)$, $h_{cc}(T_p)$, $h_{lin}(T_p)$, $h_{spl}(T_p)$.

[0038] FIG. 15C illustrates WFS motor testbench experimental results for MTPA PWA including, from top to bottom on the left side, torque (reference, measured, MTPA PWA); speed (reference and measured); copper losses (experimental, MTPA PWA), and from top to bottom on the right side, rotor current (measured, MTPA PWA); d-axis stator current (measured, MTPA PWA); q-axis stator current (measured, MTPA PWA).

[0039] FIG. 15D illustrates WFS motor testbench experimental results for MTPA PWA following a dynamic speed reference including, from top to bottom on the left side, experimental torque tracking speed reference, and real-time copper losses for each MTPA function, and from top to bottom on the right side, experimental and post-processed rotor current i_r , stator current i_d , and stator current i_q using the MTPA maps $h_p(T)$, $h_c(T)$, $h_{cc}(T)$, and $h_{spl}(T)$.

[0040] FIG. 15E illustrates WFS motor testbench experimental results for MTPA PWA with 50 Nm dynamic torque step and, from top to bottom, torque reference T^* and recalculated torques from currents $h_p(T)$, $h_c(T)$, $h_{cc}(T)$, and $h_{spl}(T)$, experimental and postprocessed rotor current i_r and stator currents i_d , i_q generated from $h_p(T)$, $h_c(T)$, $h_{cc}(T)$, and $h_{spl}(T)$ MTPA functions, and real-time copper losses for each MTPA function

[0041] FIG. 16 illustrates another example of the motor system of FIG. 1, which implements a model predictive control (MPC) control scheme according to some embodiments.

[0042] FIG. 17 illustrates a process for controlling a motor using a model predictive control technique according to some embodiments.

[0043] FIG. 18 illustrates another example of the motor system of FIG. 1, which includes a permanent magnet (PM) synchronous motor and implements one or more of a current-to-flux PWA map, a model predictive control (MPC) control scheme, and MTPA or MPLPT-based reference generation according to some embodiments.

[0044] FIGS. 19A and 19B illustrate differently sized regularly-gridded PWA map functions according to some embodiments.

[0045] FIG. 20 illustrates an example of a 2-Norm flux error distribution for a 13×13 regularly gridded set of current points used to create a current-to-flux PWA map for a PM synchronous motor according to some embodiments.

[0046] FIG. 21 illustrates average and maximum 2-Norm flux error for different current sets used to create a current-to-flux PWA map for a PM synchronous motor according to some embodiments.

[0047] FIG. 22 illustrates a simplicial mesh, current point placement, and 2-Norm flux error distribution for different current-to-flux PWA maps for a PM synchronous motor according to some embodiments.

[0048] FIG. 23 illustrates another example of the motor system of FIG. 1, which includes a controller a current-to-inductance piecewise affine (PWA) map according to some embodiments.

DESCRIPTION

[0049] One or more embodiments are described and illustrated in the following description and accompanying drawings. These embodiments are not limited to the specific details provided herein and may be modified in various ways. Furthermore, other embodiments may exist that are not described herein. Also, functions performed by multiple components may be consolidated and performed by a single component. Similarly, the functions described herein as being performed by one component may be performed by multiple components in a distributed manner. Additionally, a component described as performing particular functionality may also perform additional functionality not described herein. For example, a device or structure that is “configured” in a certain way is configured in at least that way, but may also be configured in ways that are not listed.

[0050] As used in the present application, “non-transitory computer-readable medium” comprises all computer-readable media but does not consist of a transitory, propagating signal. Accordingly, non-transitory computer-readable medium may include, for example, a hard disk, a CD-ROM, an optical storage device, a magnetic storage device, a ROM (Read Only Memory), a RAM (Random Access Memory), register memory, a processor cache, or any combination thereof.

[0051] In addition, the phraseology and terminology used herein is for the purpose of description and should not be regarded as limiting. For example, the use of “comprising,” “including,” “containing,” “having,” and variations thereof herein is meant to encompass the items listed thereafter and equivalents thereof as well as additional items. Additionally, the terms “connected” and “coupled” are used broadly and encompass both direct and indirect connecting and coupling, and may refer to physical or electrical connections or couplings. Furthermore, the phrase “and/or” used with two or more items is intended to cover the items individually and together. For example, “a and/or b” is intended to cover: a; b; and a and b.

[0052] “Flux linkage,” as used herein, may be described as the change in magnetic field that can be detected as a voltage between two ends of a conductive element. Additionally, unless otherwise noted, the term “flux” is used herein as abbreviated or shorthand notation for “flux linkage” when discussing the relationship between the magnetic field and electrical circuit within an electromagnetic mechanical machine.

[0053] Inductance, as used herein, is a quantity derived from the relationship between the flux linkage across an electrical element and the current through that electrical element. Being a non-linear relationship, such inductance may be described as the instantaneous change in flux linkage

with respect to current (also referred to as “incremental inductance”); as relative to the total flux linkage (λ) at some current (i), where λ/i is the “apparent inductance”; or as relative to the total field energy at some current (i), which is determined by

$$L_{EE} = \frac{2}{i_f^2} \int_{i=0}^{i_f} \lambda(i) di$$

(also referred to as “energy-equivalent inductance”).

[0054] FIG. 1 illustrates a motor system 100, according to some embodiments. The motor system 100 includes a power supply 105, a motor drive circuit 110, an electric machine 115 (also referred to as an electric motor or motor 115), and a motor controller 120. The power supply 105 provides direct current (DC) power to the motor drive circuit 110. Generally, when the motor 115 is being driven as a motor, the motor controller 120 is configured to control the motor drive circuit 110 to apply power from the power supply 105 to the motor 115 to drive rotation of the motor 115. Similarly, when the motor 115 is being operated as a generator, the motor controller 120 is configured to control the motor drive circuit 110 to apply electric power from the motor 115 to the power supply 105.

[0055] In some embodiments, the power supply 105 includes a DC power source that provides the DC power to the motor drive circuit 110. The DC power source may be, for example, one or more batteries, photovoltaic cells, or the like. In some embodiments, the power supply 105 includes an AC/DC rectifier that receives alternative current (AC) power from an AC power source, which may be a utility grid or external generator. In these embodiments, the AC/DC rectifier outputs the DC power to the motor drive circuit 110. In some embodiments, the AC power source is part of the power supply 105 (e.g., in the case of an on-site wind turbine or generator). In some embodiments, the power supply 105 includes both the DC power source and the AC/DC rectifier, and the DC power from the power supply 105 to the motor drive circuit 110 is provided from one or both sources.

[0056] The motor controller 120 includes an electronic processor 125 and a memory 130 (collectively, processing circuitry). Generally, the motor controller 120 monitors characteristics of the motor 115 based on signals received from one or more motor sensors and, based on these characteristics, provides control signals to the motor drive circuit 110. The memory 130 includes one or more of a read only memory (ROM), random access memory (RAM), or other non-transitory computer-readable media. The electronic processor 125 is configured to, among other things, receive instructions and data from the memory 130 and execute the instructions to, for example, carry out the functionality of the motor controller 120 described herein. For example, the memory 130 includes control software defining, among other things, control techniques for the motor 115. As described in further detail below, generally, the electronic processor 125 may be configured to execute the control software to monitor characteristics of the motor 115, receive operational parameters (e.g., motor commands from an input device (not shown)), and to drive the motor drive circuit 110 in accordance with the operational parameters and monitored characteristics. The input device may be or include, for example, an accelerator pedal of an electric vehicle, a trigger, a dial, a keypad, laptop, smartphone, or the

like that outputs one or more operational parameters to the motor controller **120** (e.g., encoded in an analog or digital signal). Example operational parameters that may be input and received by the motor controller **120** include torque commands and/or speed commands.

[0057] Although the motor controller **120**, the electronic processor **125**, and the memory **130** are each illustrated as a respective, single unit, in some embodiments, one or more of these components is a distributed component. For example, in some embodiments, the electronic processor **125** includes one or more microprocessors and/or hardware circuit elements, the memory **130** includes one or more memories, and/or the motor controller **120** includes one or more motor controllers (e.g., each with respective processors and memories).

[0058] In some embodiments, the motor **115** includes a stator assembly and a rotor assembly. The motor **115** may be synchronous motor, for example, a wound field synchronous (WFS) motor, a permanent magnet synchronous (PMS) motor, or a hybrid synchronous motor with a rotor having both wound field(s) and permanent magnet(s). In such examples, the stator assembly includes a stator core and a plurality of stator windings on the stator core that are selectively driven with current to induce magnetic fields that rotate the rotor assembly. The stator core may be, for example, a lamination stack formed by a plurality of laminations. The lamination stack may include a generally annular profile with teeth extending radially inward (in the case of an outer stator) or radially outward (in the case of an inner stator). The stator windings may be wrapped around the teeth or may include conductors that otherwise fill the slots between teeth (i.e., the windings may, in some examples, not actually be wound around another object). In the case of a WFS or hybrid synchronous motor, the rotor assembly includes a rotor core and one or more field windings that are selectively driven with current to induce magnetic fields that interact with the magnetic fields of the stator assembly to rotate the rotor assembly. The rotor core may be, for example, a lamination stack formed by a plurality of laminations. The lamination stack may include a generally annular profile with teeth extending radially inward (in the case of an outer rotor) or radially outward (in the case of an inner rotor). The rotor windings may be wrapped around the teeth or may include conductors that otherwise fill the slots between teeth. In embodiments in which the motor **115** is a hybrid synchronous motor, the rotor assembly includes a combination of a permanent magnets and field windings. In embodiments in which the motor **115** is a PMS motor, the rotor assembly includes one or more permanent magnets and is without rotor field windings. Although the motor **115** is described herein primarily as a synchronous motor, in some examples, the motor **115** is of another type, such as an induction motor, a universal motor, a switched reluctance motors, or another type. Although this example of the motor **115** is described as including teeth, in some examples, the motor **115** does not include teeth, for example, when implemented as a slotless motor.

[0059] More generally, regardless of the particular form or type, the motor **115** (or, electromagnetic mechanical machine), utilizes one or more controllable magnetic fields that are constructed, or energized, in such a manner as to provide a force or torque between two or more components. The force or torque may arise from the interaction of two or

more magnetic fields (at least one of which is controllable) such that the relative motion of one component results in a lower energy state due to reduced interference between the fields. The force or torque may also arise from a circuit that a given magnetic field, or combination of fields, must take through the materials of two or more components, such that the relative motion of one or more components results in a lower energy state due to lower reluctance of the magnetic circuit, where reluctance is the ratio of magnetomotive force to the magnetic field strength.

[0060] In some embodiments, including embodiments of the motor including a rotor with a rotor winding (e.g., WFS motors and hybrid synchronous motors), the motor drive circuit **110** includes a stator drive circuit coupled to one or more stator windings of the motor **115** and a rotor drive circuit coupled to one or more rotor windings of the motor **115**. In some embodiments, including embodiments of the motor **115** without a rotor winding (e.g., PMS motors), the motor drive circuit **110** includes a stator drive circuit coupled to one or more stator windings of the motor **115**, but does not include a rotor drive circuit.

[0061] The stator drive circuit includes, for example, a plurality of power switching elements connected in a bridge configuration. The power switching elements are semiconductor switching devices such as, for example, a field effect transistor (FET) (e.g., a metal-oxide-semiconductor field effect transistors (MOSFETs)), a bipolar junction transistor (BJT), or insulated gate bipolar transistor (IGBT). The stator drive circuit may include an output terminal for each phase of the stator assembly of the motor **115**. For example, in embodiments of the stator assembly having three phases, the stator drive circuit may include three output terminals, each connected to a terminal of a respective phase of the stator assembly. The stator drive circuit receives DC power from the DC power supply **105** and control signals from the motor controller **120**. The control signals, which may be pulse-width modulated control signals having respective duty cycles, control the power switching elements to turn on and off in a coordinated manner to drive the stator windings of the motor **115**. For example, the motor controller **120**, via the control signals, may control the stator drive circuit to generate a sinusoidal drive signal at each output terminal to drive each phase of the stator assembly of the motor **115** with a respective sinusoidal drive signal. Accordingly, the stator drive circuit may also be referred to as a DC-to-AC inverter. Each phase of the stator assembly of the motor **115** may be associated with one or more stator windings.

[0062] The rotor drive circuit, when present, includes, for example, a further one or more power switching elements. The power switching elements of the rotor drive circuit may also be connected in a bridge configuration. The rotor drive circuit may include an output terminal pair coupled across each controllable rotor winding of the rotor assembly of the motor **115**. The rotor drive circuit receives DC power from the DC power supply **105** and control signals from the motor controller **120**. The control signals, which may be pulse-width modulated control signals having respective duty cycles, control the power switching elements of the rotor drive circuit to turn on and off in a coordinated manner to drive the rotor windings of the motor **115**. For example, the motor controller **120**, via the control signals, may control the rotor drive circuit to generate a DC voltage across each rotor winding. In some examples, the rotor drive circuit includes a single power switching element, single passive element

(e.g., a diode), or a plurality of passive elements (e.g., a plurality of diodes) arranged to control the current through the rotor winding(s).

[0063] The rotor drive circuit provides a power coupling between the power supply **105**, which is stationary (i.e., non-rotating), and the one or more windings of the rotor assembly, which rotates. Thus, the rotor drive circuit may include a stationary portion and a rotary portion. For example, the rotor drive circuit may include a slip ring and brushes that provides a conductive connection between the stationary portion and the rotary portion. In some embodiments, the rotor drive circuit includes another power coupling type.

[0064] In some examples, the rotor drive circuit is or includes a DC-to-DC converter that steps down or steps up DC voltage received from the DC power supply **105** to a desired voltage level for the rotor winding(s).

Motor System with a Piecewise Affine (PWA) Map-Based Control

[0065] FIG. 2 illustrates a particular example of the motor system **100**, according to some embodiments. For example, the motor controller **120** is illustrated as a collection of functional blocks with respective inputs and outputs. Each of the functional blocks may be implemented by a dedicated hardware circuit of the electronic processor **125** of the controller **120**, by a block of software or instructions stored in the memory **130** and executed by the electronic processor **125**, or a combination thereof. The motor drive circuit **110** is further illustrated as including a stator drive circuit **205** and a rotor drive circuit **210**. The motor drive circuit **110**, stator drive circuit **205**, and the rotor drive circuit **210** may each be referred to individually or collectively as a power switching network. A power switching network, such as these circuits, may be configured to switch voltage, current, and/or power. The motor **115** is illustrated as a WFS motor having a three-phase stator with phases (A, B, C) and a rotor field winding (R). As previously noted, in other examples, the motor **115** is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, or another motor type. When the motor **115** is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, the rotor field winding (R) is not included in the motor **115** and, accordingly, the rotor drive circuit **210** may not be included, the motor controller **120** may not sense or control current through the rotor field winding (R), and the control blocks of the motor controller **120** may not receive, process, or generate rotor field components.

[0066] In FIG. 2, the functional blocks of the motor controller **120** include a Clark-Park current transform block **215**, piecewise affine (PWA) current-to-flux linkage maps **220** and **225**, reference generation block **230**, a difference operation block **235**, a flux controller **240**, an inverse Clark-Park voltage transform block **245**, and a pulse width modulation (PWM) generation block **250**. In other examples, one or more of the functional blocks are combined together or distributed into sub-blocks. An example of operation of the motor system **100** and the motor controller **120** of FIG. 2 is provided below with respect to FIG. 3.

[0067] FIG. 3 illustrates a process **300** for controlling a motor using piecewise affine modelling. The process **300** is described as being carried out by the motor system **100** of FIG. 2. However, in some embodiments, the process **300** may be implemented by another motor system, for example, motor system **900**, **1600**, and/or **1800**. Additionally, although the blocks of the process **300** are illustrated in a

particular order, in some embodiments, one or more of the blocks may be executed partially or entirely in parallel, may be executed in a different order than illustrated in FIG. 3, or may be bypassed.

[0068] In block **305**, the motor controller **120** determines current values for the motor **115** in a rotational reference frame, such as the RDQN reference frame. Each current value is associated with a dimension (or axis) of a set of dimensions of the RDQN reference frame. Here, the set of dimensions includes the R (or field (f)), D, and Q dimensions (e.g., I_f , I_d , I_q , also referenced as $I_{f,d,q}$). As used herein, the variables F, f, R, and r are used interchangeably to refer to rotor field characteristics. For example, rotor field current may be expressed as I_r or as I_f and rotor field flux linkage may be expressed as λ_r or as λ_f .

[0069] For example, to implement block **305**, the motor controller **120** may determine electrical operational characteristics of the motor **115** in a stationary reference frame; determine a rotational position of the motor **115** (e.g., of the rotor of the motor **115**); and transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor **115** in the rotational reference frame. For example, to determine the electrical operational characteristics of the motor **115** in the stationary reference frame and the rotational position of the rotor, the controller **120** may receive current measurements from current sensors **255** configured to sense current of each phase of the stator windings (e.g., I_a , I_b , I_c , also collectively referred to as I_{abc}) and current of the rotor winding(s) (e.g., I_f , sometimes referred to as I_r) of the motor **115**. The controller **120** may also receive rotational position measurements (θ) from a rotational position sensor **260** configured to measure the rotational position of the rotor. In some examples, the controller **120** may determine current and rotational motor position using other techniques. For example, the controller **120** may use a “sensorless” design to determine the rotor position, for example, by inferring rotor position by detecting zero-crossings, peaks, and/or valleys of back electromotive force (emf) signals on the stator windings. Further, the controller **120** may calculate the current values from voltage measurements on the stator windings and/or rotor winding (s) provided by voltage sensors. To transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame, the motor controller **120** may perform, via Clark-Park transform block **215**, a Clark-Park transform on the determined current i_{abc} and rotational position (θ) of the motor **115**.

[0070] In block **310**, the motor controller **120** is configured to determine, based on the current values, a flux linkage or inductance value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a piecewise affine map. For example, the motor controller **120** is configured to determine flux linkage values $\lambda_{f,d,q}$ using PWA current-to-flux linkage map **220** or to determine inductance values $L_{f,d,q}$ using a PWA current-to-inductance map **2320**, described in further detail below with respect to FIG. 23. The set of dimensions may or may not include the null dimension and, accordingly, the motor controller **120** may or may not determine a flux linkage value for a null axis of the rotational reference frame. A piecewise affine (PWA) map (e.g., PWA map **220**), as used in block **310**, is a nonlinear current-to-flux linkage map that is divided into M domains each with a corresponding affine function that provides a

one-to-one mapping of current values to flux linkage values. The affine function of each of the M domains may be linear (i.e., the current-flux linkage relationship may be linearized in each of the M domains). In other embodiments, however, the affine function corresponding to each of the M domains may be quadratic, spline, etc. Further, each of the M domains corresponds to a simplex (e.g., generated using domain decomposition or Delaunay triangulation as described in further detail below). One example of a current-to-flux linkage PWA map is as follows:

$$\lambda = f(i) \approx f_{PWA}(i) = \begin{cases} L_1 i + \psi_1, & i \in \mathcal{I}_1, \\ L_2 i + \psi_2, & i \in \mathcal{I}_2, \\ \dots & \dots \\ L_M i + \psi_M, & i \in \mathcal{I}_M, \end{cases}$$

where λ is flux linkage, i is current, L_j is $\Delta\lambda/\Delta i$ (i.e., the slope of flux linkage with respect to current), ψ_j is flux that is a constant of integration, and $\mathcal{I}_j$ is the simplex (or domain). Additionally, Volt*seconds (Vs) may be the unit for both ψ_j and λ .

[0071] The current-to-flux linkage PWA map **220** may also correspond to a flux linkage-to-current PWA map that is the inverse of the current-to-flux linkage PWA map **220**, although this inverse PWA map may not be explicitly utilized by the motor controller **120** in the process **300**. One example of this inverse (flux linkage-to-current) PWA map is:

$$i = g(\lambda) \approx g_{PWA}(\lambda) = \begin{cases} L_1^{-1}(\lambda - \psi_1), & i \in \Lambda_1, \\ L_2^{-1}(\lambda - \psi_2), & i \in \Lambda_2, \\ \dots & \dots \\ L_M^{-1}(\lambda - \psi_M), & i \in \Lambda_M, \end{cases}$$

where $i = g \circ f = g \circ f(i) f(i)$.

[0072] In some embodiments, using a PWA map (e.g., the PWA map **22**) to determine flux linkage value based on a current value includes a two-step process. First, the motor controller **120** identifies on which simplex (or domain) of the PWA map the current value resides. Second, the motor controller **120** uses the particular affine function associated with the identified simplex to calculate the flux linkage.

[0073] With respect to the first step, the motor controller **120** may identify the simplex (or domain) of the PWA map on which the current value resides using various techniques. In one example, the motor controller **120** may iteratively check simplices (e.g., one by one) to determine whether the current value resides thereon, and continue to do so until the simplex having the current value is identified. Mathematically, this check may be described as projecting the coordinate(s) of current(s) into the local coordinate system of the simplex as a local coordinate vector and, when the components of the local coordinate vector are all be between 0 and 1, a point is considered contained within a simplex. The check for each simplex may include multiplying the current value by a particular transformation matrix associated with the simplex and: (a) if the output is >1 , the input current does not reside on it, and (b) if the output is <1 , the input current does reside on the simplex. Here, the transformation matrix may identify the $n+1$ points that create the simplex, where one selected point (p_0) creates the origin of the simplex, and

each of the other points (p_1 to p_n) in the simplex can be expressed as one of N vectors p_{x0} relative to the origin (where $N=n$, and for $x=1$ to N). In this example, the N vectors include vector $p_{10}=p_1-p_0$, vector $p_{20}=p_2-p_0$, . . . vector $p_{N0}=p_n-p_0$. The collection of relative vectors, that is the set of vectors p_{10} , p_{20} . . . p_{N0} , form the columns of the transformation matrix. A test vector, p_r , can then be transformed into the local coordinate system by multiplying the inverse of the transformation matrix by p_{r0} . In some examples, the test vector may be expressed in the current space, for example, with i_r , i_d , i_q and units of Amp-turns, or in the flux linkage space, for example, with λ_r , λ_d , λ_q and units of Volt-seconds per turn). Although this function and matrix is described with respect to a PWA map used to convert current to flux linkage, a matrix using the same format and formula may be used with respect to a PWA map used to convert from flux linkage to current (with different values, but an operational point (e.g., pointN) is the same point in both matrices). In some examples, such an operational point may be expressed via six components to specify current through each coil of the motor and flux linkages of each coil of the motor (e.g., i_r , i_d , i_q , λ_r , λ_d , λ_q). However, because only three of these six variables may be specified independently, shorthand notation with three variables may be used (e.g., i_r , i_d , i_q or λ_r , λ_d , λ_q).

[0074] In other embodiments, different techniques may be used to identify the simplex, such as k-d trees, cosine similarity, a radial basis function, gaussian function, neural net algorithm, a classifier algorithm, and the like.

[0075] With respect to the second step, once the particular simplex (or domain) is identified, the motor controller **120** uses the particular affine function associated with the identified simplex (or domain) to calculate the flux linkage. For example, with reference to the above example current-to-flux linkage PWA map **220**, if the motor controller **120** identifies the simplex $\mathcal{I}_2$ in the first step, then the motor controller **120** obtains the coefficients L_2 (a 3D slope matrix) and ψ_2 (a 3D intercept matrix) for the associated affine function $L_2 i + \psi_2$ to calculate flux linkage (i.e., flux linkage (λ)= $L_2 i + \psi_2$). For example, the motor controller **120** applies the current values to the affine function to calculate the flux linkage. Here, this may include the motor controller **120** multiplying the current values by the 3D slope matrix L_2 , and adding the 3D intercept matrix ψ_2 , to arrive at the flux linkage values. The 3D intercept matrix (ψ) may be considered a vector that represents the origin of the simplex represented in flux linkage space. The matrix L may be the product of the local coordinate transformation matrix from both current space and flux linkage space (e.g., $L = t_{\lambda}^* \text{inverse}(t_i)$).

[0076] In block **315**, the motor controller **120** is configured to determine a target value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. For example, the motor controller **120** is configured to determine target values in the form of target flux linkage values $\lambda_{f,dq}^*$ or in the form of target current values $i_{f,dq}^*$. The motor controller **120** may or may not determine a flux linkage value for a null axis of the rotational reference frame. To determine the target flux linkage values, the motor controller **120** may determine a desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*) or motor speed (not shown)) for the motor **115**. The desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*) or speed) may also be referred to as a motor command, and may be provided by an input device as described above. The

motor controller **120** may then, using the reference generation block **230**, transform the desired control parameter to target current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame (e.g., $I_{f,dq}^*$). For example, the motor controller **120** may use the reference generation block **230** in the form of a lookup table (e.g., stored in the memory **130**) that maps potential values for the desired control parameter T^* to the target current values. The lookup table may be populated in advance based on experimental data. The motor controller **120** may then determine, based on the target current values, the target flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the piecewise affine (PWA) map **225**. The motor controller **120** may use the PWA map **225** to determine the target flux linkage values based on the target current values in a similar manner as the PWM map **220** is used to determine the flux linkage values based on the current values. The two PWA maps **220** and **225** illustrated in FIG. 2 may be duplicate PWA maps, or the motor controller **120** may use one PWA map for both the actual values and the target values (i.e., although two PWA maps are illustrated, in some embodiments, one shared PWA map is included instead). In other examples, the target current values output by the reference generation block **230** are used as the target values, as explained in further detail below with respect to FIG. 23.

[0077] In block **320**, the motor controller **120** is configured to control the power switching network based on the flux linkage or inductor values and the target values (e.g., target flux linkage values or target current values). See discussion below with respect to FIG. 23 for a discussion of control based on inductor values and target current values. Returning to FIG. 2, however, in some embodiments, the motor controller **120** may generate control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor **115** based on a difference between the target flux linkage value and the flux linkage value for the dimension. For example, the motor controller **120** may, using the difference block **235**, determine a difference between each flux linkage value and target flux linkage value for each respective dimension of the set of dimensions of rotational reference frame (e.g., R, D, and Q dimensions, optionally Null dimension). This difference value and the rotational position of the motor (θ) may be provided to the flux controller **240**. The flux controller **240** may be, for example, a proportional integral derivative (PID) controller, a PI controller, a lookup table, a model-based controller (e.g., implementing model predictive control (MPC), as described in further detail below), or another control device. The motor controller **120** (e.g., via the flux controller **240**) may then generate a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on the difference value and the rotational position. For example, the flux controller **240** may output voltage commands V_f , V_d , and V_q (also referred to collectively as $V_{f,dq}$).

[0078] The motor controller **120** may then transform the voltage commands from the rotational reference frame to the stationary reference frame. For example, the motor controller **120**, using the inverse Clark-Park transform block **245**, may perform an inverse Clark-Park transform on the voltage commands $V_{f,dq}$ to generate voltage commands V_f , V_a , V_b , and V_c (also referred to collectively as $V_{f,abc}$) in the stationary reference frame.

[0079] The motor controller **120** may then, using PWM generation block **250**, generate a pulse width modulated

control signal for each dimension of the stationary reference frame to control the power switching network to drive a stator of the motor. For example, the PWM generation block **250** may implement, and the motor controller **120** may access, respective lookup tables for each of the stator phases and the rotor field winding, where the motor controller **120** provides a voltage command to the respective lookup tables of the PWM generation block **250** (e.g., V_a to the lookup table for stator phase A, V_b to the lookup table for stator phase B, V_c to the lookup table for stator phase C, and V_f to the lookup table for the rotor field winding). The PWM generation block **250**, via the lookup tables, may return control signal parameters (e.g., a duty cycle) for each stator phase and the rotor field winding.

[0080] Ultimately, then, as part of block **320**, the motor controller **120** may provide control signals to the drive circuit **110** including stator drive control signals D_a , D_b , D_c (also collectively referred to as D_{abc}) and rotor drive control signals D_f (sometimes referred to as D_r) in accordance with the control signal parameters (e.g., at the particular duty cycles indicated by the voltage commands). These control signals may be applied to control terminals of power switching elements of the stator drive circuit **205** and rotor drive circuit **210** of the motor drive circuit **110**. For example, the control signals D_{abc} may be provided to the stator drive circuit **205** to control the power switching elements thereof, and the control signal D_f may be provided to the rotor drive circuit **210** to control the power switching elements thereof.

[0081] When in a motor operational mode, based on the control signals, the motor drive circuit **110** is controlled to apply power from the power supply **105** to the motor **115** to drive rotation of the motor **115**. Similarly, when in a generator operational mode, based on the control signals, the motor drive circuit **110** is controlled to apply electric power from the motor **115** to the power supply **105** (e.g., to charge the power supply) and/or to another electrical load.

Generating a Piecewise Affine (PWA) Map

[0082] In some embodiments, a PWA map as generated and used herein is based on a state-space model of the motor ultimately to be controlled. For example, in the case of a WFS motor that is neutral-point isolated (thus, having generally no 0-axis flux and current) and without damper windings, voltage equations for a state-space model are:

$$\begin{aligned}\dot{\lambda}_r &= u_r - R_r i_r = \bar{u}_r, \\ \dot{\lambda}_d &= \omega \lambda_q + u_d - R_s i_d = \omega \lambda_q + \bar{u}_d, \\ \dot{\lambda}_q &= -\omega \lambda_d + u_q - R_s i_q = -\omega \lambda_d + \bar{u}_q,\end{aligned}$$

where “ $\dot{}$ ” is the d/dt operator; λ_r is the rotor flux linkage (i.e., field flux linkage); λ_d and λ_q are the d-axis and q-axis stator flux linkages, respectively; i and v are the currents and voltages of the appropriate dimension; R_r and R_s are the rotor and stator resistances, and ω is the synchronous speed, i.e. the electrical velocity of the machine. Furthermore, we introduce the voltages $\bar{v}(\bar{u}_r)$ that are the terminal voltages compensated by the winding resistive voltage drop. This concept can be generalized to include compensation for inverter nonlinear behavior such as switch on-voltage drops and dead times. For other motor types, a similar state model

may be defined with modified equations to account for differences in the motors, including for motors with higher dimensions.

[0083] The torque of the machine, T , is defined by:

$$T = p i_{rdq} J \lambda_{rdq},$$

where p is the number of pole pairs, and J is the cross-coupling matrix:

$$J = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

[0084] The machine currents map onto machine flux with a nonlinear map

$$\lambda_r = f_r(i_r, i_d, i_q),$$

$$\lambda_d = f_d(i_r, i_d, i_q),$$

$$\lambda_q = f_q(i_r, i_d, i_q),$$

[0085] That captures magnetic coupling between axis, magnetic saturation, and cross-saturation. These equations can be written as a standard state-space systems using vector notation

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{\lambda} &= A\lambda + B\bar{v}, \\ i &= g(\lambda), \end{aligned}$$

where the state is the flux $\lambda = [\lambda_r, \lambda_d, \lambda_q]^T \in \Lambda$, the input is the compensated voltage $\bar{v} = [\bar{v}_r, \bar{v}_d, \bar{v}_q]^T \in V$, and the measurement is the current $i = [i_r, i_d, i_q]^T \in I$. The linear dynamic model is defined by the matrices

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \omega \\ 0 & -\omega & 0 \end{bmatrix}, B = I = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The output function $g: \lambda \rightarrow i$ is the inverse of the nonlinear flux map $f(\bullet) = [f_r(\bullet), f_d(\bullet), f_q(\bullet)]^T$, and $f: i \rightarrow \lambda$.

[0086] As described herein, a PWA map may be generated to express the nonlinear current-to-flux map $f(\bullet)$ and a PWA map may be generated to express the nonlinear flux-to-current map $g(\bullet)$. In some embodiments, a multi-step process is implemented to generate such a PWA map. The resulting PWA map may be used, for example, in the process 300. The multi-step process may be executed by an electronic controller 400 including a processor 405 and a memory 408, as illustrated in FIG. 4. The electronic controller 400 may be a computing device, such as a server, a local computing device, a cloud-based system that includes a collection of sub-computing devices, or the like. This electronic controller 400 may be separate from the motor controller 120. In some examples, the electronic controller 400 may be communicatively coupled with the motor controller 120 via a network 410 (e.g., one or more of a local area network, a wide area network, a cellular network, a telecommunications network, etc.). In some examples network 410 is communicatively coupled to the motor controller 120 temporarily, in advance of operation of the motor controller 120 to

control a motor (e.g., the motor 115). For example, the communicative coupling may be used by the electronic controller 400 to configure the motor controller 120 to have and/or implement a PWA map (e.g., PWA map 220 and/or 225) generated by the electronic controller 400. The motor controller 120 may, in some examples, disconnect from the electronic controller 400 after a configuration stage to implement offline operation using the PWA map(s) 225 and/or 225. The elements of FIG. 4 may be referred to as a configuration system 420.

[0087] The processor 405 and memory 408 may be similar to the processor 125 and memory 130 of the motor controller 120 described above, although, at least in some embodiments, they may have increased processing power and memory capabilities relative to the motor controller 120 that may have space and power constraints. Additionally, although described in the singular, the electronic controller 400 may include one, two, or more controllers (e.g., each with a processor and memory) operating in a distributed manner. Similarly, the processor 405 and memory 408 of electronic controller 400 may include one, two, or more respective processors and memories operating in a distributed manner.

[0088] The resulting PWA map generated by the electronic controller 400 may be received by and stored on a motor controller (e.g., on the memory 130 of the motor controller 120), enabling the motor controller to control a motor while offline (e.g., not connected to remote processing systems) in a manner as described above with respect to the process 300.

[0089] In some embodiments, to generate a PWA map for use in controlling an electric motor (e.g., the motor 115), such as described in the process 300, the electronic controller 400 (1) obtains a data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of the electric motor; (2) applies a domain decomposition algorithm to the data set to generate current simplices and flux linkage simplices, and (3) creates a PWA map (or function) (e.g., f_{PWA} or g_{PWA}) using the simplices.

[0090] With respect to the first step, to obtain the data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of the electric motor, the electronic controller 400 (or another electronic controller) may perform a simulation for the motor (e.g., using finite element analysis) to generate the data set; may, through experimentation, estimate or calculate flux linkage based on observations of voltage and current over time, and potentially other system parameters, for example, resistances, torques, rotational speeds, or the like, to generate the data set; or may generate the data set through a combination of simulation and experimentation. As one example, in the RDQN space, the data set may include current-flux linkage pairs expressed as $(i_r, i_d, i_q; \lambda_r, \lambda_d, \lambda_q)$. In this example, where the system may intend to have zero current under nominal operation, the null dimension (N) may be ignored. The size of the data set may depend on the number of operational points of the motor that are taken into consideration. The more operational points, the larger the data set. In some embodiments, the operational points may be selected to be operational points of interest for the motor or those operational points that make up the entire or a substantial portion of the operational domain of the motor. See additional description below regarding selection of operational points.

[0091] Turning to the second step, the electronic controller 400 applies the domain decomposition algorithm to the data set to generate current simplices and flux linkage simplices.

Stated another way, the electronic controller **400** generates current simplices and flux linkage simplices based on a domain decomposition technique. Various domain decomposition algorithms or techniques, also referred to as domain subdivision algorithms, may be applied to generate the current simplices and flux linkage simplices. For example, the domain decomposition algorithm or technique may be Delaunay triangulation. In another example, the domain decomposition algorithm or technique may be an irregularly sampled, but rectangular, decomposition, for example, a quad tree algorithm, a box tree algorithm (also referred to as oct tree), or KD-tree algorithm (depending upon the number of independent dimensions). In another example, the domain decomposition algorithm is an alpha shape algorithm or technique. Delaunay triangulation is a known mathematical meshing algorithm or technique, and quad tree, box tree, KD-tree, and alpha shape are also known domain decomposition algorithms or techniques. In some examples, the electronic controller **400** applies the domain decomposition to the current points (that make up the current-flux linkage pairs of the operational points) from the previous step to generate the current simplices, and applies the domain decomposition to the flux linkage points (that make up the current-flux linkage pairs of the operational points) from the previous step to generate the flux linkage simplices.

[0092] In some examples, to calculate the Delaunay triangulation for a set of current points (e.g., for N current points), first a Voronoi diagram of the current points may be constructed. The Voronoi diagram splits the current space into N Voronoi cells, where all points in a Voronoi cell are closer to a single point of the original set of current points than any other point. To obtain the Delaunay triangulation, one may find the dual of the Voronoi diagram. Generally, the Delaunay triangulation maximizes the minimum angle in the simplices it creates, thus reducing “skinny” simplices. Such skinny simplices may be undesirable in this context. Here, “skinny” simplices may be described by their aspect ratio. In other words, a simplex having an aspect ratio above a threshold amount may be considered “skinny,” while a simplex having an aspect ratio below the threshold amount may be considered “not skinny.” The aspect ratio of a simplex can be enforced by the sampling of the space, or the construction of the Delaunay, when desired.

[0093] For the resulting current simplices generated, each simplex is connected at a shared boundary to another simplex so that all simplices are connected within the domain, and no simplex overlaps another simplex within the domain. Additionally, the simplices may be defined such that they are closed domains on one side and open domains on the other such that any arbitrary point in the domain will belong to one and only one simplex within the Delaunay construction (even if it is on a boundary). In an example using a three-phase WFSM, assuming the RDQ domain without position (theta) dependency, each simplex may be a tetrahedron (a three-dimensional shape). If theta (θ) is included in the domain (e.g., a RDQ θ domain), each simplex may be a four-dimensional shape. Accordingly, each simplex may be n-dimensions, where n is the number of variables or dimensions of the domain.

[0094] The flux linkage simplices are similar to the current simplices. That is, for resulting flux linkage simplices generated, each simplex is connected at a shared boundary to another simplex so that all simplices are connected within the domain, and no simplex overlaps another simplex within

the domain. Additionally, the simplices may be defined such that they are closed domains on one side and open domains on the other such that any arbitrary point in the domain will belong to one and only one simplex within the Delaunay construction (even if it is on a boundary). Further, each simplex may be n-dimensions, where n is the number of variables or dimensions of the domain.

[0095] In some embodiments, of the resulting simplices, each current simplex is associated with just one flux linkage simplex (and vice-versa) and, further, each coordinate in each current simplex is associated with just one coordinate in the associated flux linkage simplex (and vice-versa). In other words, for each coordinate in current space there is one and only one coordinate in flux linkage space.

[0096] FIG. 5 includes two plots for an example data set of current-flux linkage pair in the RDQ domain for a three-phase WFSM. On the left side of FIG. 5, a first plot **500** of each of the current simplices generated by the Delaunay triangulation algorithm executed on the example data set is illustrated. On the right side of FIG. 5, a second plot **505** of each of the flux linkage simplices generated by the Delaunay triangulation algorithm executed on the example data set is illustrated. Each current simplex of the first plot **500** corresponds to a flux linkage simplex on the second plot **505** (and vice-versa) and, further, each coordinate in each current simplex is associated with just one coordinate in the associated flux linkage simplex (and vice-versa).

[0097] Turning to the third step of PWA map generation, the electronic controller **400** creates a PWA map (or function). For example, a particular PWA map may map current to flux linkages ($f_{PWd}(i)$) (e.g., PWM map **220** or **225** of FIG. 2) or may map flux linkages to current ($g_{PWd}(\lambda)$). The PWA map divides an original domain into M subsets, with each subset defined as a simplex. A simplex is the simplest possible polytope in any D-dimensional space. For example, a simplex for three-dimensions, as in the example WFS motor, has the form of a tetrahedron. A D-dimensional simplex can be defined as the convex hull of its D+1 vertices (called the V-notation); alternatively, a simplex can be defined by its faces defined as affine inequalities (called the H-notation). For example,

$$I_j = H(\{i_{jo}, i_{j1}, \dots, i_{jD}\})$$

where $i_{jo}, i_{j1}, \dots, i_{jD} \in I_P$. Each current simplex I_j forms a domain of an affine map that maps into the flux simplex,

$$\Lambda_j = H(\{\lambda_{jo}, \lambda_{j1}, \dots, \lambda_{jD}\})$$

where $\lambda_{jo}, \lambda_{j1}, \dots, \lambda_{jD} \in \Lambda_P$. The general position of the defining set of measurement points implies that the vertices of each simplex are linearly independent and full dimension (not degenerate).

[0098] Continuing with the example of a tetrahedron simplex, each tetrahedron I_j is defined by four vertices. Let one vertex i_{jo} be the support vector such that the origin can be moved $\bar{i} = i - i_{jo}$. In the shifted dimension, the simplex is defined by

$$\bar{I}_j = H(0, \bar{i}_{j1}, \dots, \bar{i}_{jD}),$$

where $\bar{i}_{jk} = i_{jk} - i_{jo}$ with $k = \{1, \dots, D\}$ span the simplex. Furthermore, we shift the flux space by the corresponding flux vector $\bar{\lambda} = \lambda - \lambda_{jo}$ that results in the simplex

$$\bar{\Lambda}_j = H(0, \bar{\lambda}_{j1}, \dots, \bar{\lambda}_{jD})$$

where $\bar{\lambda}_{jk} = \lambda_{jk} - \lambda_{jo}$ where $k = \{1, \dots, D\}$ span the simplex.

[0099] The nonzero vertices can be interpreted as a basis and since an affine map is an isomorphism, the relative position of a vector in the current and flux simplex is the same:

$$\bar{\tau} = a_1 \bar{\tau}_{j_1} + \dots + a_D \bar{\tau}_{j_D}$$

The coefficients can be obtained similar to how space vector modulation (SVM) computes relative on-times. Further, $\bar{\tau}$ is projected onto the basis of $\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j$:

$$p_{j_k} = \text{proj}_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_{j_k}} \bar{\tau} = \frac{\bar{\tau}_{j_k} \cdot \bar{\tau}}{\|\bar{\mathbf{I}}_{j_k}\|^2}$$

And obtain the relative length of the vector by dividing the magnitude of the projections with the magnitude of the basis vectors:

$$a_{j_k} = \frac{\|p_{j_k}\|}{\|\bar{\mathbf{I}}_{j_k}\|}.$$

[0100] To find the flux vector λ , we multiply a_k with the basis vectors of $\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j$:

$$\bar{\lambda} = a_1 \bar{\lambda}_{j_1} + \dots + a_D \bar{\lambda}_{j_D}.$$

Then, the motor flux results from shifting the origin.

[0101] These preceding four equations can be simplified using vector notation, where the bases of $\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j$ and $\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j$ are the matrices:

$$M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j} = [\bar{\mathbf{I}}_{j_1}, \dots, \bar{\mathbf{I}}_{j_D}],$$

$$M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j} = [\bar{\mathbf{I}}_{j_1}, \dots, \bar{\mathbf{I}}_{j_D}],$$

and $\mathbf{a} = [a_1, \dots, a_D]^T$. Then, $\bar{\mathbf{I}} = M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j} \mathbf{a}$ and $\bar{\lambda} = M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j} \mathbf{a}$. Because the simplices are not degenerate, the bases are nonsingular, resulting in the linear relationship:

$$M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j}^{-1} \bar{\tau} = M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j}^{-1} \bar{\lambda},$$

which can be used to map current to flux and vice versa. Substituting the original coordinates provides:

$$M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j}^{-1} (\lambda - \lambda_{j_0}) = M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j}^{-1} (i - i_{j_0}),$$

which results in the affine map

$$\lambda = L_j i + \psi_j,$$

$$\text{where } L_j = M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j} M_{\bar{\mathbf{I}}_j}^{-1} \text{ and } j = \lambda_{j_0} - L_j i_{j_0}.$$

[0102] Rewriting in RDQ notation, the equation relating current to flux linkage for the WFS motor without saturation has the form:

$$\lambda_{rdq} = L_{rdq} i + \psi_{rdq}$$

where $L_{rdq} \in \mathbb{R}^{3 \times 3}$ is the inductance matrix and ψ_{rdq} is the flux-offset vector:

$$L_{rdq} = \begin{bmatrix} L_{rr} & L_{rd} & L_{rq} \\ L_{dr} & L_{dd} & L_{dq} \\ L_{qr} & L_{qd} & L_{qq} \end{bmatrix}, \psi_{rdq} = \begin{bmatrix} \psi_r \\ \psi_d \\ \psi_q \end{bmatrix}$$

[0103] The diagonal terms of L are the self-inductances of the rotor (L_{rr}) and stator (L_{dd} , L_{qq}), while the non-diagonal terms are the mutual inductances between the three axes. Typically, L_{rq} , L_{dq} , L_{qr} , L_{qd} are negligible, while L_{dr} and L_{rd} create the cross-coupling effect.

Selection of Operational Points and PWA Map Optimization

[0104] In some examples, a regularly spaced grid of operational points is used in the first step of PWA map generation. Generally, the more operational points selected in the first step, the more simplices generated in the second step, and the larger and/or more complex the PWA map. As the PWA map increases in size and/or complexity, the accuracy of the PWA map may improve until reaching an approximate peak. In some examples, the electronic controller may downsample the operational points such that fewer than the total number of available operational points are used to generate the PWA map. Such downsampling may, generally, reduce the size and/or complexity of the PWA map, and may result in a reduction in accuracy. Depending on the amount of downsampling, the amount of operational points available, and the like, the reduction may be minimal or at least within design tolerance for a particular system. Accordingly, the number of operational points used to generate a PWA map may be a balance between the size and/or complexity of the PWA map versus the desired accuracy of the PWA map.

[0105] In some examples, an irregularly spaced grid of operational points is used in the first step of PWA map generation. An irregularly spaced grid of operational points may enable a reduction of points in some portions of the operational domain of the motor (e.g., where the current-flux linkage relationship is more linear), an increase in points in other portions of the operational domain of the motor (e.g., where the current-flux linkage relationship is more nonlinear), or both. Selectively reducing operational points, particularly where the current-flux linkage relationship may be more linear, can minimize or limit any reduced accuracy from removing operational points, while improving memory and processing efficiencies based on a smaller and/or less complex PWA map. Similarly, selectively adding operational points, particularly where the current-flux linkage relationship may be more nonlinear, can maximize or improve accuracy of the PWA map, with minimal or reduced impact on memory and processing efficiencies. As a result, the PWA map generated using an irregularly spaced grid of operational points can provide high accuracy, high respon-

siveness, and low computational requirements compared to PWA maps generated using regularly spaced grid of operational points.

[0106] Multiple techniques may be used to generate a PWA map using an irregularly spaced grid of operational points. For example, FIG. 6 illustrates a first process **600** to generate a PWA map, f_{oig} , using an irregularly spaced grid of operational points. The PWA map f_{oig} may be a current-to-flux PWA map, although a similar process may be used to generate a flux-to-current PWA map as well. In this example, the electronic controller (e.g., electronic controller **400**) may start with an initial set of operational points, iteratively generate PWA maps and, for each PWA map, detect a portion of the operational domain with high or the highest error rates (e.g., from a random sampling), and add operational points for that portion to be used in the next successive PWA map to be generated. As shown in FIG. 6, this iterative process may be repeated until the operational points reaches a predetermined threshold N (i.e., until $|I_p| \geq N$). In other examples, the process may be repeated until a PWA map reaches a desired accuracy (e.g., an average of k error values I is less than threshold value).

[0107] More particularly, in block **605**, the electronic controller **400** may define an initial set current points and corresponding flux points that define the full operating region of the machine (e.g., the motor **115**). The electronic controller **400** may obtain the initial set from a memory (e.g., the memory **408**) or an external memory or input/output interface. In the illustrated example, the initial set includes eight current points and eight flux points making up eight current-flux operation point pairs; however, in other examples, the initial set includes a different number (more or less) of current-flux operation point pairs. Additionally, in some examples, the initial set of current and flux points may define an operating region of the machine that is less than the full operating range.

[0108] In block **610**, the electronic controller **400** creates a PWA function f_{oig} for the sets of current and flux points. For example, the electronic controller **400** creates current mesh and flux mesh by executing the domain decomposition (e.g., Delaunay triangulation algorithm) on the initial set of current points and corresponding flux points, and defining the PWA function for each simplex in the two meshes, using the above-described techniques.

[0109] In block **615**, the electronic controller **400** determines whether the PWA map generation process **600** is complete. For example, the electronic controller **400** may compare the number of operational points (e.g., current points I_p) to a predetermined threshold N. In response to the number of operational points being at or above the predetermined threshold, the electronic controller **400** may determine that the PWA map generation process **600** is complete, and may output or store (e.g., in the memory **408** or **130**) the PWA map f_{oig} generated from the most recent execution of block **610**. In response to the number of operational points being less than the predetermined threshold, the electronic controller **400** may process to block **620**. In other examples, the electronic controller **400** may determine that the PWA map generation process **600** is complete based on another criteria, for example, whether the PWA map most recently generated reaches a desired accuracy (e.g., an average of k error value (E) is less than threshold value), the number of iterations reaches an iteration threshold, or the like.

[0110] In block **620**, the electronic controller **400** computes an error between the PWA map most recently generated and a high-fidelity function. The high-fidelity function may serve as a baseline on which to judge the accuracy of a PWA map. For example, the electronic controller **400** may compare a 2-Norm error ("Error") of k random current points between the output function (PWA map) f_{oig} and a high-fidelity function (e.g., $f_{S,44 \times 31 \times 42}$), where:

$$\text{Error} = \{E_1, \dots, E_k\}$$

$$E_k = \sqrt{(\lambda_k - \lambda_{k,exp})^2}$$

$$\lambda_k = f_{oig}(i_k)$$

$$\lambda_{k,exp} = f_{S,44 \times 31 \times 42}(i_k)$$

$$i_k = \text{random}(i \in I)$$

[0111] In block **625**, the electronic controller **400** determines the maximum error in the error set (Error), for example, by comparing each of the resulting values in the Error set, and identifies the random current i_{max} and random flux λ_{max} corresponding to the maximum error (e.g., from the calculations in the previous block **620** associated with the maximum error).

[0112] In block **630**, the electronic controller **400** adds a maximum error point to the current and flux set. For example, the electronic controller **400** creates a new current set and new flux set by using the previous current set and previous flux set and adding i_{max} to the current set and λ_{max} to the flux set. In this way, the current set and flux set each increase in size by one point. The electronic controller **400** then returns to block **610** to create an updated PWA function based on the new current set and flux set. The steps **610-630** may be repeated until the electronic controller **400** determines, in block **615**, that the PWA generation process **600** is complete.

[0113] FIGS. 7A-7F illustrate heat maps of a 2-Norm error for PWA maps generated using the process of FIG. 6. In the example illustrated, an additional operational point is added in each successive PWA map generated by an iteration of the process. The error heat maps are associated with a select subset of the iterations of the process that are illustrative of the trend of decreasing average error as the number of points increases. The illustrated heat maps start at 8 points and increase to 27 points, where the points are shown as black dots within the diagrams, and the average error present generally reduces as operational points are added (from 15% to 6%). The title of each heat map includes the number of points and the average error. In particular, FIG. 7A includes 8 points and an average error of 15%, FIG. 7B includes 9 points and an average error of 12%, FIG. 7C includes 10 points and an average error of 28%, FIG. 7D includes 11 points and an average error of 10%, FIG. 7E includes 21 points and an average error of 9%, FIG. 7F includes 27 points and an average error of 6%. The error scale of each heat map varies as shown by the vertical error key on the right side of each heat map, with the maximum error for the heat map at the top of the key (e.g., 57.877% in FIG. 7A).

[0114] In another example technique used to generate a PWA map (f_{oig}) using an irregularly spaced grid of operational points, the electronic controller may start with a large initial set of operational points and successively remove

operational points, rather than starting with a small initial set and adding operational points. For example, in this technique, the electronic controller may start with the large initial set of operational points, then iteratively generate PWA maps and, for each PWA map, detect a portion of the operational domain with low or the lowest error rates (e.g., from a random sampling), and remove operational points for that portion to be used in the next successive PWA map to be generated. This process may be repeated until the operational points reach a predetermined threshold N (i.e., until $|I_p| \leq N$). In other examples, the process may be repeated until a the PWA map falls into a desired accuracy range (e.g., an average of k error value (E) is in a predetermined range). This process may also be referred to as downsampling.

[0115] In some embodiments, even further memory and processing efficiencies may be gained by selectively reducing the samples or operational points making up the data set (from the first step of PWA map generation noted above). For example, rather than using regular sampling, in some embodiments, the electronic controller uses a data set derived from irregular sampling where, for example, generally linear regions of operation may have less sampling than generally nonlinear regions of operation. An example process for irregular sampling is discussed above with respect to the flow chart of FIG. 6. In some embodiments, other techniques are used select operational points to make up the data set. For example, the controller may choose a point (whether at random or regularly gridded) and construct the L matrix. Then, the controller may run a cosine similarity function and test the output. When the output is above a certain accuracy threshold or score, the controller may remove one or more points to the data set (e.g., if the mapping is above a size or complexity threshold) or exit the process. When the output is below the certain threshold or score, the controller may add further points to the data set. Then, if the process was not exited, the controller may repeat the process for the modified data set. If the process was exited, the controller may move on to another region and repeat the process, or if all regions have been completed, finalize the mapping based on the final data set. This technique generally homes in on a data set of operational points that provides a mapping having sufficient accuracy and a sufficiently reduced memory footprint and complexity. In other embodiments, other criteria may be used to test a particular region and to determine whether the process is complete.

[0116] The plots in FIG. 8A-8C include examples of the PWA maps that are generated from data sets of regularly sampled current grids that are downsampled, to various extents. In particular, each of FIGS. 8A, 8B, and 8C includes four plots, each plot of a regularly gridded data set at one of the following sampling levels: 8×8 grid, 4×4 grid, 3×3 grid, and 2×2 grid. FIG. 8A illustrates plots of λ_r vs i_d and i_r , sliced at $i_q=0$; FIG. 8B illustrates plots of λ_d vs i_d and i_r , sliced at $i_q=0$, and FIG. 8C illustrates plots of λ_q vs i_d and i_r , at $i_d=0$.

[0117] As described above, some techniques for selecting operational points to form an irregular grid used to generate a PWA map include starting with a smaller set of operational points and adding operational points to the set to arrive at the irregular grid of operational points, while other techniques include starting with a larger set of operational points and removing operational points from the set to arrive at the irregular grid of operational points. In some examples,

techniques that includes starting with a smaller set and adding operational points to the set is less computationally demanding than starting with a larger set and removing operational points, reducing the amount processing and memory resources used (e.g., by the electronic controller 400). This reduction in resources can result because, for example, creating the meshes and performing the domain decomposition (see, e.g., block 610) on smaller sets of operational points is less computationally demanding than performing such operations on larger sets of operational points.

[0118] A resulting PWA map, such as ultimately created using the process 600 or variations thereof, may be used by a motor controller to control a motor (e.g., by the motor controller 120 to control the motor 115), as described herein. Additionally, a resulting PWA map may be used as a representation of a motor controller and motor for purposes of simulation. This use of the PWA map can be beneficial because, for example, the PWA map accurately represents the associated non-linear motor and flux-based control thereof using less processing and memory resources than other modeling techniques used for motors. Accordingly, performing simulations with the PWA map can occur more quickly, with less processing and less memory resources, than other modeling techniques.

[0119] Based on experimental testing using various numbers of current-flux pair operational points (ranging from 8 points to 90 points), the amount of memory used (in kilobytes (kB)) and computational time (in microseconds (μs)) increase nonlinearly with the number of simplices used in the current-to-flux PWA map. Nevertheless, the memory used and computational time remained within a suitable range for typical motor controllers, even at relatively high fidelity. For example, at 45 operational points used to create the meshes, the memory used was still below 20 kB and with a computational time under 50 μs . Indeed, at 30, 40, 45, and 48 operational points, the computational time was between 20-40 microseconds, and at 8, 12, 18, and 24 operational points, the computational time was below 20 microseconds. Additionally, at 8, 12, 18, 24, 30, and 40 operational points, the memory usage was below 10 kB, and at 45, 48, and 60 operational points, the memory usage was between 10 kB and 20 kB.

Use of Other Current-to-Flux Linkage Maps

[0120] In some embodiments of the process 300, instead of using a PWA map as described above, another mapping of current to flux linkage is generated from the simplices resulting from the domain decomposition and used in the process 300. For example, instead of using a piecewise function including a plurality of linear relationships, a piecewise function including a plurality of quadratic functions is used to provide the current-to-flux linkage mapping. Generally, the quadratic functions may enable use of even fewer datapoints while still preserving the accuracy of the representation; however, the computational complexity to perform an inverse lookup (e.g., to solve a quadratic function to get from flux linkage to current) may increase. However, in some embodiments, such as the motor controller implementing the process 300, the motor controller may not include an inverse lookup to map flux linkage to current and the increased complexity may be irrelevant. In some contexts, such as in a simulation or motor analysis, the increased complexity may have a larger potential impact.

[0121] Other techniques may include, for instance K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN), which includes a method of searching that can be used to find adjacent simplices. KNNs, or other similar methods, utilize a distance metric as a way to build up a tree—for example, a KDTree or BallTree in higher dimensions. When provided a data point, this tree would return K nearest simplices. The metric defined can be any metric that is said to be a “true metric” in the mathematical sense, where a true metric satisfies each of the following conditions:

[0122] 1:

$$d(x, y) \geq 0$$

[0123] 2: $d(x, y) = d(y, x)$

[0124] 3: $d(x, y) = 0$ only if $x = y$

To find adjacent simplices to a data point using this method, in some instances, the center of the simplex is used as the “Neighbors.”

[0125] Another technique includes cosine similarity, which can be used when comparing data points as vectors in high dimensions where the angle returned gives a relative similarity between the two vectors compared (not absolute). Vectors can, in some instances, contain neural embeddings of higher order data within a lower dimensional space. As more dimensions are included in the simplices, reducing the number of relevant adjacent simplices becomes a larger task. Simplices may be discarded, thereby reducing the number of points required, based on whether a simplex has a high cosine similarity to its neighbors when generating the PWA map. Due to the linearity within the simplex, the cosine similarity could be taken between the gradients within the two simplices that are being compared.

[0126] Another technique includes decision trees, where a classification tree is fit to the dataset. For example, a “random forest” approach may take many decision trees using different subsets of the dataset and average their results making them much more robust while also giving a confidence score in the prediction, which can be used in some instances. Additionally, gradient boosting is a method that may be used, which creates many individual decision trees. This, in turn, creates additional trees by focusing on where previous trees have done poorly rather than equally weighting each tree as in a random forest.

[0127] Neural networks may also be utilized, including fully connected networks for less complex problems, convolutional networks, recurrent networks (which are particularly useful for time series problems), and/or generative networks.

Simplex Generation Process

[0128] In some embodiments, a simplex generation process is provided and, for example, executed by the electronic 400 controller including the processor 405 and the memory 408. As noted above, the processor 405 and memory 408 may be similar to the processor and memory of the motor controller 120 described above, although, at least in some embodiments, they may have increased processing power and memory capabilities relative to the motor controller 120 that may have space and power constraints. Additionally, although described in the singular, the electronic controller may include one, two, or more controllers (e.g., each with a

processor and memory) operating in a distributed manner. Similarly, the processor and memory of electronic controller may include one, two, or more respective processors and memories operating in a distributed manner.

[0129] In some embodiments, the simplex generation process includes the electronic controller 400 (1) obtaining a data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of the electric motor; (2) applying the domain decomposition algorithm to the data set to generate current simplices and flux linkage simplices, and (3) storing the current simplices and flux linkage simplices in a memory (e.g., the memory 408 and/or the memory 130). The first two steps may be executed similar to the first two steps for the PWA generation noted in the previous sections. In the third step, the electronic controller 400 may store the current simplices and the flux linkage simplices in the memory of the electronic controller and/or another memory with which the electronic controller is in communication.

[0130] The generated simplices may then be used to generate a PWA map or other map relating current and flux linkage, as discussed above, as well as for other purposes. For example, the simplices may be integrated into a motor analysis or simulation system and used by the system to convert current values to flux linkage values, and/or to convert flux linkage values to current values. This includes state space modeling and finite element analysis. The simplices may also be used to produce an accurate model of the machine with an irregular grid.

Current-to-Inductance PWA Map

[0131] FIG. 23 illustrates a particular example of the motor system 100 including a current-based controller, identified as motor system 2300, according to some embodiments. The description of components for FIGS. 1 and 2 above similarly applies to the components in FIG. 23 sharing the same element numbers or names, except as otherwise provided herein. For example, the motor controller 120 is again illustrated as a collection of functional blocks with respective inputs and outputs. Each of the functional blocks may be implemented by a dedicated hardware circuit of the electronic processor 125 of the controller 120, by a block of software or instructions stored in the memory 130 and executed by the electronic processor 125, or a combination thereof. The motor drive circuit 110 is further illustrated as including a stator drive circuit 205 and a rotor drive circuit 210. The motor 115 is illustrated as a WFS motor having a three-phase stator with phases (A, B, C) and a rotor field winding (R), and the motor system 2300 is primarily described with respect to a WFS motor. However, in other examples, the motor 115 is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, or another motor type. When the motor 115 is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, the rotor field winding (R) is not included in the motor 115 and, accordingly, the rotor drive circuit 210 may not be included, the motor controller 120 may not sense or control current through the rotor field winding (R), and the control blocks of the motor controller 120 may not receive, process, or generate rotor field components.

[0132] In contrast to FIG. 2, the motor system 2300 of FIG. 23 includes a current-to-inductance PWA map 2320, which may be implemented as a piecewise affine map that maps input current values $i_{r,dq}$ (illustrated as $i_{f,dq}$) to inductance values $L_{r,dq}$ (illustrated as $L_{f,dq}$), as described in further detail below. Further, the target current values ($i^*_{r,dq}$)

and the current values ($i_{r,dq}$) are provided to the difference operator **235**, which provides the determined difference to a current controller **2340**. Additionally, the current controller **2340** is provided in place of the flux controller **230** of FIG. 2. The current controller **2340** receives the determined current difference ($i_{r,dq} - i_{r,dq}^*$) and inductance ($L_{r,dq}$) and, based on these values, generates and outputs a voltage command $V_{f,dq}$. For example, to determine the voltage command, the current controller **2340** may multiply an inverse of the inductance values (which may form a matrix) by the determined current difference (e.g., $V_{f,dq} = L_{r,dq}^{-1}(i_{r,dq} - i_{r,dq}^*)$). In some examples, the inverted inductance matrix ($L_{r,dq}^{-1}$) can be a direct output of the PWA map **2320** and received by the current controller **2340** as the inductance values. In such cases, in some examples, the matrix inversion can be an offline computation.

[0133] The voltage output is provided to the inverse Clark-Park transform block **245**, which is ultimately used to control the motor **115** in a similar manner as described with respect to FIG. 2. For example, the current controller **2340** may output voltage commands V_f , V_d , and V_q (also referred to collectively as $V_{f,dq}$ or $V_{r,dq}$). The voltage commands may then be used to control the motor similar to as described above with respect to FIG. 2 (e.g., via inverse Clark-Park transform block **245**, PWM generation block **250**, and motor drive circuit **110**). Like the flux controller **240**, the current-based controller **2340** may be, for example a proportional integral derivative (PID) controller, a PI controller, a lookup table, or another control device.

[0134] The PWA map **2320** may map or correspond the current inputs ($i_{r,dq}$) to inductance values (e.g., $L_{r,dq}$ or $L_{r,dq}^{-1}$) that are output by the PWA map. More specifically, as previously discussed above, the PWA map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains. The PWA map **2320** may be generated using similar techniques as described above with respect to current-to-flux linkage map **220**, except with updated equations to account for the relationship between current and inductance in place of the relationship between current and flux linkage, which may be derived from the relationship of inductance to flux linkage and current (e.g., see discussion above of incremental inductance, apparent inductance, and energy-equivalent inductance). To obtain an inductance from a set of inputs to the PWA map **2320**, a controller (e.g., the motor controller **120**) may identify a first domain corresponding to the set of inputs and selected from the plurality of domains. The first domain is associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions. Then, the controller may apply the set of inputs (i.e., the current values and one or more additional motor characteristics) to the first affine function to determine the inductance value for each dimension of the rotational reference frame. In some examples, each of the plurality of domains associated with respective affine functions) corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of input-output pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor. Here, the input of each input-output pair includes, for an operational point of the motor, current values, and the output includes the corresponding inductance value.

[0135] In some examples, the motor system **2300** of FIG. 23 includes a minimum power loss per torque (MPLPT) control block to serve as the reference generation block **230**,

such as MPLPT block **905** of FIG. 9A (discussed below) and/or the flux controller **2340** is implemented as an MPC controller, as discussed further with respect to FIG. 16.

PWA Map for MPLPT Control Scheme

[0136] In some examples, the motor system **100** implements a minimum power loss per torque (MPLPT) control scheme. The MPLPT control scheme can reduce or minimize electrical losses of the motor **115** given a reference torque (e.g., an input torque command indicating a desired output torque of the motor **115**) while taking saturation and cross-saturation into account. By reducing electrical losses, namely copper and iron losses, using MPLPT, the motor system **100** provides power-efficient torque control of the motor **115**. To implement MPLPT control scheme, an MPLPT optimization problem is solved using a convex pareto frontier of simulated or measured data points. Magnetic saturation and cross-saturation effects are captured using sampled points throughout full-machine operation. A filtered solution set is mapped to current space using piecewise affine functions, which approximate the current using a piecewise linear function for a given torque. This set of piecewise linear functions enables the machine controller **120** to implement MPLPT online or as an offline lookup table. This section focuses on WFS motor, but similar concepts are applicable to other motor types, including PMS motors, hybrid synchronous motors, universal motors, induction motors, and reluctance motors (synchronous and switched).

[0137] Directly controlling the torque of any machine is generally difficult, as controllers are able to control and regulate some combination of voltage, current, or flux. A typical approach is to define a reference torque, which is then directly mapped to a reference set of currents. This mapping is generally not unique, and there is no optimal solution as torque is a non-convex function of current. This problem is typically referred to as Maximum Torque per Ampere (MTPA), but is rephrased in this research as Minimum Power Loss per Torque (MPLPT) to include iron losses. The MPLPT problem becomes more complex with the addition of the strong saturation in magnetic flux of a WFS motor that operates in the linear and non-linear magnetic regimes to prevent high flux error during saturation and cross-saturation.

[0138] Existing online MTPA methods may be computationally expensive on a controller, while offline MTPA methods include adding a cross-coupling torque term and additional variables that decrease the inductance in saturation to approximate saturation effects, which produces a difficult-to-optimize equation and large lookup table.

[0139] In some examples, the MPLPT approach proposed herein uses pareto-optimal simulated or experimental values to the MPLPT as candidate points for an MPLPT current path. The solution set is reduced by using convex pareto-optimal points, and the points are linked using a Piecewise Affine (PWA) function. This approach produces a set of linear functions that are computationally cheap to run on a controller for any reference torque of the machine.

[0140] FIG. 9A illustrates a particular example of the motor system **100**, identified as motor system **900**, implementing such an MPLPT control scheme, according to some embodiments. The description of components for FIGS. 1 and 2 above similarly applies to the components in FIG. 9A sharing the same element numbers or names, except as

otherwise provided herein. For example, the motor controller **120** is again illustrated as a collection of functional blocks with respective inputs and outputs. Each of the functional blocks may be implemented by a dedicated hardware circuit of the electronic processor **125** of the controller **120**, by a block of software or instructions stored in the memory **130** and executed by the electronic processor **125**, or a combination thereof. The motor drive circuit **110** is further illustrated as including a stator drive circuit **205** and a rotor drive circuit **210**. The motor **115** is illustrated as a WFS motor having a three-phase stator with phases (A, B, C) and a rotor field winding (R), and the motor system **900** is primarily described with respect to a WFS motor. However, in other examples, the motor **115** is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, or another motor type. When the motor **115** is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, the rotor field winding (R) is not included in the motor **115** and, accordingly, the rotor drive circuit **210** may not be included, the motor controller **120** may not sense or control current through the rotor field winding (R), and the control blocks of the motor controller **120** may not receive, process, or generate rotor field components.

[0141] In contrast to FIG. 2, the motor system **900** of FIG. 9A includes an MPLPT function block **905**, which may be implemented as a piecewise affine map that maps an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*)) to target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ as described in further detail below. Further, the current-to-flux linkage maps **910** and **915** may be implemented as piecewise affine maps as described above with respect to FIG. 2, or may be implemented through other mapping functions (e.g., lookup tables, real-time executed functions, etc.). Further still, in some embodiments, the functional blocks or maps **905** and **910** may be combined into a single piecewise affine map that maps an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*)) to target flux linkage values $\lambda_{r,dq}^*$.

[0142] Additionally, in some embodiments, the flux controller **240** within the controller **120** may implement current-based motor control, rather than flux linkage-based control as illustrated in FIG. 9A. For example, the current-to-flux linkage maps **910** and **915** may not be present in the controller **120**, and the target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ and measured current values $i_{r,dq}$ may be provided to the difference calculation block **235** of the controller **120**. The difference calculation block **235** of the controller **120** may then provide difference values indicating the differences between the target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ and measured current values $i_{r,dq}$ to the current-based controller block that is provided in place of the flux controller block shown in FIG. 9A. Like the flux controller **240**, the current-based controller block may be, for example a proportional integral derivative (PID) controller, a PI controller, a lookup table, or another control device. Whether flux-based or current-based, the controller block (and, thus, the motor controller **120**) may then generate a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on the received difference values and the rotational position of the motor (θ). For example, the flux controller **240** may output voltage commands V_β , V_α , and V_q (also referred to collectively as $V_{f,dq}$ or $V_{r,dq}$). The voltage commands may then be used to control the motor similar to as described above with

respect to FIG. 2 (e.g., via inverse Clark-Park transform block **245**, PWM generation block **250**, and motor drive circuit **110**).

[0143] FIG. 9B illustrates a process **950** for implementing MPLPT motor control using a piecewise affine model. The process **950** is described as being carried out by the motor system **900** of FIG. 9A. However, in some embodiments, the process **950** may be implemented by another motor system, for example, the motor system **100**, **1600**, or **1800**. Additionally, although the blocks of the process **950** are illustrated in a particular order, in some embodiments, one or more of the blocks may be executed partially or entirely in parallel, may be executed in a different order than illustrated in FIG. 9B, or may be bypassed.

[0144] In block **955**, the motor controller **120** determines current values for the motor **115** in a rotational reference frame, such as the RDQN reference frame or the. Each current value is associated with a dimension (or axis) of a set of dimensions of the RDQN reference frame. Here, the set of dimensions includes the R (or field (f)), D, and Q dimensions (e.g., i_β , i_α , i_q , also referenced as $i_{f,dq}$). As used herein, the variables F, I, R, and r are used interchangeably to refer to rotor field characteristics. For example, rotor field current may be expressed as i_r or as i_β and rotor field flux linkage may be expressed as λ_r or as λ_β .

[0145] For example, to implement block **955**, the motor controller **120** may determine electrical operational characteristics of the motor **115** in a stationary reference frame; determine a rotational position of the motor **115** (e.g., of the rotor of the motor **115**); and transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor **115** in the rotational reference frame. For example, to determine the electrical operational characteristics of the motor **115** in the stationary reference frame and the rotational position of the rotor, the controller **120** may receive current measurements from current sensors **255** configured to sense current of each phase of the stator windings (e.g., i_a , i_b , i_c , also collectively referred to as i_{abc}) and current of the rotor winding(s) (e.g., i_β , sometimes referred to as i_r) of the motor **115**. The controller **120** may also receive rotational position measurements (θ) from a rotational position sensor **260** configured to measure the rotational position of the rotor. In some examples, the controller **120** may determine current and rotational motor position using other techniques. For example, the controller **120** may use a “sensorless” design to determine the rotor position, for example, by inferring rotor position by detecting zero-crossings, peaks, and/or valleys of back electromotive force (emf) signals on the stator windings. Further, the controller **120** may calculate the current values from voltage measurements on the stator windings and/or rotor winding (s) provided by voltage sensors. To transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame, the motor controller **120** may perform, via Clark-Park transform block **215**, a Clark-Park transform on the determined current i_{abc} and rotational position (θ) of the motor **115**.

[0146] In block **960**, the motor controller **120** determines, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map. For example, the motor controller **120** may receive the desired control parameter in the form of an input

command or reference value, which may indicate a desired motor torque value (T^*). The desired control parameter may be retrieved from a memory (e.g., the memory **130**) or received via an input/output device of the motor controller **120** (e.g., from a user operating a keyboard, pushbutton, level, dial, etc.).

[0147] The motor controller **120** may then apply the MPLPT function block **905** to the desired control parameter. For example, the MPLPT function block **905** may implement a piecewise affine (PWA) map that maps an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor reference torque (T^*)) to target current values $i^*_{r,dq}$, as described in further detail below. Alternatively, in some embodiments, the functional blocks or maps **905** and **910** may be combined into a single piecewise affine map that maps, according to MPLPT, an input desired control parameter (e.g., reference torque (T^*)) to target flux linkage values $\lambda^*_{r,dq}$. Additional detail describing the generation of the MPLPT function block **905** and its PWA map is provided below.

[0148] To determine the target motor control parameter value (e.g., $i^*_{r,dq}$) based on the desired control parameter (e.g., reference torque (T^*)) using the PWA map of the MPLPT function block **905**, the motor controller **120** may use the PWA map in a similar manner as described above with respect to PWA maps **220**, **225** to translate an input to the output. More particularly, to use the PWA map of the MPLPT function block **905**, the motor controller **120** may identify a first domain corresponding to the desired control parameter (e.g., reference torque (T^*)) selected from a plurality of domains of the PWA map, where the first domain is associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions of the PWA map. Then, the motor controller **120** may apply the desired control parameter (e.g., reference torque (T^*)) to the first affine function to determine the target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. For example, as described in further detail below, the PWA map of the MPLPT function block **905** may be defined as $h_{PWA}(T_p)$, where each function of the PWA map takes the form $m_j T_p + i_j$. Accordingly, once the particular affine function of the PWA map is identified, the motor controller **120** may plug the reference torque (T^*) into the identified function and solved to generate the target motor control parameter value.

[0149] In some examples, the output current value of the MPLPT function block **905** is an intermediate target motor control parameter value that is then further translated to a (final) target motor control parameter value by the current-to-flux linkage map **910**. In other examples, such as where the controller **240** of FIG. 9A is a current-based controller rather than a flux-based controller, or where the MPLPT function block **905** is configured to map reference torque (T^*) directly to a target flux value (λ^*), the output current value of the MPLPT function block **905** is the (final) target motor control parameter value.

[0150] In block **965**, the motor controller **120** controls the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values. For example, the motor controller **120** may generate control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor **115** based on a difference between the target motor control parameter value (e.g., flux linkage value output by block **910**) and the flux linkage value for each dimension (e.g., output by the block **915**). For example, the motor controller **120** may,

using the difference block **235**, determine a difference between each flux linkage value and target flux linkage value for each respective dimension of the set of dimensions of rotational reference frame (e.g., R, D, and Q dimensions, optionally Null dimension). This difference value and the rotational position of the motor (θ) may be provided to the flux controller **240**. The flux controller **240** may be, for example, a proportional integral derivative (PID) controller, a proportional integral (PI) controller, a lookup table, a model-based controller (e.g., implementing model predictive control (MPC), as described in further detail below), or another control device. The motor controller **120** (e.g., via the flux controller **240**) may then generate a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on the difference value and the rotational position. For example, the flux controller **240** may output voltage commands V_ϕ , V_d , and V_q (also referred to collectively as $V_{f,dq}$).

[0151] The motor controller **120** may then transform the voltage commands from the rotational reference frame to the stationary reference frame. For example, the motor controller **120**, using the inverse Clark-Park transform block **245**, may perform an inverse Clark-Park transform on the voltage commands $V_{f,dq}$ to generate voltage commands V_ϕ , V_a , V_b , and V_c (also referred to collectively as $V_{f,abc}$) in the stationary reference frame.

[0152] The motor controller **120** may then, using PWM generation block **250**, generate a pulse width modulated control signal for each dimension of the stationary reference frame to control the power switching network to drive a stator of the motor. For example, the PWM generation block **250** may implement, and the motor controller **120** may access, respective lookup tables for each of the stator phases and the rotor field winding, where the motor controller **120** provides a voltage command to the respective lookup tables of the PWM generation block **250** (e.g., V_a to the lookup table for stator phase A, V_b to the lookup table for stator phase B, V_c to the lookup table for stator phase C, and V_f to the lookup table for the rotor field winding). The PWM generation block **250**, via the lookup tables, may return control signal parameters (e.g., a duty cycle) for each stator phase and the rotor field winding.

[0153] Ultimately, then, as part of block **965**, the motor controller **120** may provide control signals to the drive circuit **110** including stator drive control signals D_a , D_b , D_c (also collectively referred to as D_{abc}) and rotor drive control signals D_f (sometimes referred to as D_r) in accordance with the control signal parameters (e.g., at the particular duty cycles indicated by the voltage commands). These control signals may be applied to control terminals of power switching elements of the stator drive circuit **205** and rotor drive circuit **210** of the motor drive circuit **110**. For example, the control signals D_{abc} may be provided to the stator drive circuit **205** to control the power switching elements thereof, and the control signal D_f may be provided to the rotor drive circuit **210** to control the power switching elements thereof.

[0154] When in a motor operational mode, based on the control signals, the motor drive circuit **110** is controlled to apply power from the power supply **105** to the motor **115** to drive rotation of the motor **115**. Similarly, when in a generator operational mode, based on the control signals, the motor drive circuit **110** is controlled to apply electric power from the motor **115** to the power supply **105** (e.g., to charge the power supply) and/or to another electrical load.

MPLPT Problem Statement

[0155] As noted, the MPLPT block **905** targets minimizing losses $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda)$, which may include the sum of winding (copper) losses $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda)$ and core losses $\pi_{lcr}(i, \lambda)$, for a given reference torque T^* , or may focus on minimizing copper loss (e.g., when core loss as less impactful or negligible, such as when the machine operates below a base speed and has little to no field weakening). The output of the MPLPT block **905** may a reference current i^* (as shown in FIG. 9A) and/or a reference flux λ^* . The winding losses may be defined as $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda) \approx i^T R i$, and the core losses may be defined as $\pi_{lcr}(i, \lambda) \approx \omega^2 \lambda^T G \lambda$, where i is current, λ is flux, T is torque, R is a matrix defining winding resistance that approximates DC and (skin effect and proximity effect) AC winding losses, and G is a matrix that defines the core conductance that approximates (eddy current and hysteresis effect) core losses. The problem solved by the MPLPT block **905** (the MPLPT Equation) may be stated as follows: for a torque reference T^* , the MPLPT reference current i^* and reference flux λ^* are, and presuming copper losses being dominant over core losses:

$$[i^*, \lambda^*] = \arg \min_{i \in \mathcal{I}, \lambda \in \Lambda, \bar{v} \in \mathcal{V}} \pi_{lc}(i, \lambda),$$

$$\text{subj. to } f(\lambda, \bar{v}) = \lambda,$$

$$g(\lambda) = i,$$

$$\tau_p(i, \lambda) = T_p^*$$

where the electrical losses $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda)$ is the objective function being minimized (as noted, in other examples, the objective function being minimized may more generally be the losses $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda)$), subject to constraints: $f(\lambda, \bar{v}) = \lambda$, $g(\lambda) = i$, and $\tau(i, \lambda) = T_p^*$. Here, $f(\lambda, \bar{v}) = \lambda$ may define a relationship between flux linkage and voltage for the motor, such as defined by, for example, the following voltage equations for a WFS motor with neutral-point isolated machine (without zero-axis flux and current and without damper windings):

$$\dot{\lambda}_r = v_r - R_r i_r = \bar{v}_r,$$

$$\dot{\lambda}_d = \omega \lambda_q + v_d - R_s i_d = \omega \lambda_q + \bar{v}_d,$$

$$\dot{\lambda}_q = -\omega \lambda_d + v_q - R_s i_q = -\omega \lambda_d + \bar{v}_q,$$

[0156] Additionally, $g(\lambda) = i$ may define a current-flux relationship for the motor, such as defined by, for example, a current-flux map $\phi(\bullet)$, which may be obtained with finite element analysis (FEA) or experimental measurements. An equation that may be used for relating current to flux linkage in an WFS motor without saturation has the form $\lambda = L i + \psi$, where L is the inductance matrix and ψ is the flux-offset vector:

$$L = \begin{bmatrix} L_{rr} & L_{rd} & L_{rq} \\ L_{dr} & L_{dd} & L_{dq} \\ L_{qr} & L_{qd} & L_{qq} \end{bmatrix}, \psi = \begin{bmatrix} \psi_r \\ \psi_d \\ \psi_q \end{bmatrix},$$

[0157] Finally, $\tau(i, \lambda) = T_p^*$ constrains the quadratic torque function to the specific reference torque of interest T_p^* .

[0158] The solution set for all $T_p^* \in T$, where T is the set of allowable machine torques, will be sets of currents $\mathcal{I}$, fluxes Λ , torques $\mathcal{T}$, and power losses $\mathcal{P}$, where:

$$\mathcal{I} = \{i^* \in \mathcal{I}, \text{ s.t. MPLPT Equation} \} \in \mathbb{R}^3$$

$$\Lambda = \{\lambda^* \in \Lambda, \text{ s.t. MPLPT Equation} \} \in \mathbb{R}^3$$

$$\mathcal{T} = \{T^* \in \mathcal{T}, \text{ s.t. MPLPT Equation} \} \in \mathbb{R}$$

$$\mathcal{P} = \{P_i^* \in \mathcal{P}, \text{ s.t. MPLPT Equation} \} \in \mathbb{R}$$

which can be combined as:

$$\Gamma = \{\mathcal{I}, \mathcal{P}, \mathcal{T}, \Lambda\} \in \mathbb{R}^8$$

[0159] This optimization problem is difficult to solve due to the functions $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda)$, $\tau_p(i, \lambda)$ and state space model equations $f(\lambda, \bar{v})$, $g(\lambda) = i$. Thus, there is no analytical solution for Γ .

[0160] This formulation already accounts for saturation and cross saturation inside the machine because the datapoints include i and λ together. Therefore, changes in inductance L throughout the machine are also modelled. Another dimension that can be added to the data set is a variable resistance matrix R , either by experimental measurements or FEA-analysis. If the diagonal terms in the matrix R increase at the same rate with temperature, then the solution set Γ may stay unchanged, however, the losses may be higher.

MPLPT Quantitative Solution

[0161] In this section, a quantitative solution to the MPLPT problem is provided that assumes low speed operation of the motor **115**. In these conditions, the copper loss is dominant, relative to the winding loss, and the machine operates below base speed (i.e., with no field weakening).

[0162] Taking a large sample of random experimental or simulated datapoints can yield an approximate solution to equation MPLPT optimization problem noted above (i.e., $[i^*, \lambda^*] = \arg \min \pi_{lc}(i, \lambda)$, subject to the noted constraints). FEA-simulated data points will have a current i and flux λ , while experimental data points will have a known current i and an approximated flux λ using flux-linkage map approximations, e.g., via current-flux map $\phi(\bullet)$. These points can be directly mapped to a torque per pole pair T_p and powerloss P_i using $\tau(i, \lambda)$ and $p_i(i, \lambda)$, or to a torque per pole pair T_p and copper loss $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda)$ using $\tau_p(i, \lambda) = \tau(i, \lambda) / p = i^T R i$, and $\pi_{lc}(i, \lambda) \approx i^T R i$.

[0163] The set of all experimental datapoints is denoted:

$$\Gamma = \{\mathcal{I}, \mathcal{P}, \mathcal{T}, \Lambda\} \in \mathbb{R}^8$$

where a single point Γ_j has four components (torque per pole pair, power loss, current, flux.). The value of each component for each point can be denoted $\Gamma_{j,k}$ where j is the component and k is the index of the value. For example, $\Gamma_{1,1}$ is the torque of the first data point. The set of just one component, say torque, for all points can be denoted $\Gamma_{1,k}$, while the collection of all components for one value, say the first value, can be denoted $\Gamma_{j,1}$.

[0164] The datapoints can be plotted according to their power loss, $\Gamma_{2,k}$, and inverse torque, $\Gamma_{1,k}^{-1}$, against Γ to see which points are the most optimal.

[0165] From the set of all datapoints, there will be pareto-optimal, or efficient, values. That is, there is some subset of all values that are the most efficient for a given neighbor-

hood. This subset, and neighborhood for each member of the subset, may be determined as a pareto front, or “pareto-optimal,” defined as a value in that cannot further decrease $\Gamma_{1,k}^{-1}$, without increasing $\Gamma_{2,k}$, or vice-versa. The set of all pareto-optimal points is called a pareto frontier. The pareto frontier for a WFS motor can be denoted Γ_p . The points in the pareto frontier will all have unique torques. The pareto frontier points Γ_p produced by this method can be considered candidate points for a general MPLPT function that will exist in three-dimensional current space $\mathcal{J}$.

[0166] A line connecting all pareto-optimal points is not necessarily convex. Accordingly, a new set Γ_c is defined as the largest subset of pareto-optimal points that creates a convex, piecewise linear function when line segments are added between the points.

[0167] The point $\Gamma_{j,x}$ that corresponds to minimum torque $T_{p,min} \in T_p$ will always be in Γ_c because the minimum torque point occurs at zero losses, and no point can have negative losses. Furthermore, the point $\Gamma_{j,x}$ corresponding to maximum torque $T_{p,max} \in T_p$ will also always be in this set as no point can have higher torque, regardless of losses.

[0168] The curvature of the collection of lines connecting all adjacent Γ_c points in the three-dimensional current space ($\mathcal{J}$) is not necessarily convex. A new set Γ_{cc} is defined as the largest subset of Γ_c points that creates a convex, piecewise linear function when line segments are created between the points and grouped in the current space. The cc denotes that the piecewise linear function created is convex in the two-dimensional ($\Gamma_{1,k}^{-1}, \Gamma_{2,k} \in \mathbb{R}^2$) space, and three-dimensional ($\Gamma_{3,k} \in \mathbb{R}^3$) space. By these definitions $\Gamma \subseteq \Gamma_p \subseteq \Gamma_c \subseteq \Gamma_{cc}$.

[0169] Because points in Γ are MPLPT optimal and Γ_c are not, the losses for a point in Γ_c will always be greater than or equal to the losses in Γ with the same torque. So Γ_c may contain points in Γ , or $\Gamma_c \cap \Gamma \neq \emptyset$. The relationships between the sets, Γ , Γ_p , Γ_c , Γ_{cc} and $\bar{\Gamma}$ are shown in FIG. 10A, and example points of the sets are shown in FIG. 10B on axes of power loss $\Gamma_{2,k}$ and inverse torque $\Gamma_{1,k}^{-1}$.

[0170] Connecting convex pareto-optimal points Γ_c with line segments produces torque and powerloss trajectories that are more optimal than using any interior pareto-optimal points. Connecting points in Γ_{cc} with line segments produces torque and powerloss trajectories that are less optimal than using any interior pareto-optimal points. Connecting pareto-optimal points using straight line segments is an approximation that is valid for densely sampled points. In some examples, adjacent points in Γ_c are within a minimum ϵ Euclidean distance of each other to be considered close enough to approximate a line between them. If two points are not close enough to meet this requirement, more points are simulated or measured.

[0171] Generating a convex pareto frontier can be obtained using a modified divide and conquer algorithm for a set of solutions, and repeated to obtain Γ_{cc} . Linking line segments created using Γ_p , Γ_c , and Γ_{cc} in two-dimensional ($\Gamma_{1,k}^{-1}, \Gamma_{2,k} \in \mathbb{R}^2$) space to three-dimensional ($\Gamma_{3,k} \in \mathbb{R}^3$) current space can be modelled using a piecewise affine map. Each set may have unique properties.

[0172] The above description is just one technique for selecting significant datapoints as a subset of all datapoints. In other examples, other techniques are used to perform such subset identification. Regardless of the selection algorithm, a PWA, or equivalent mapping technique, can be constructed from the resulting subset.

Piecewise Affine Map (PWA) for MPLPT

[0173] In some examples, a piecewise-affine (PWA) map or function is used to express an approximate MPLPT solution path. PWA maps divide a nonlinear map into M domains over which the function may be linearized. The torque domain $\Gamma_{1,k}$ is partitioned into torque regions T_j , but can equivalently be partitioned into powerloss regions. Moving forward, points in this space are interchangeably described as torques $T_{p,k}$ or $\Gamma_{1,k}$ values equivalently. Similarly, the current domain $\Gamma_{3,k}$ will be partitioned into current regions I_j , and currents can be described by i_k or $\Gamma_{3,k}$. Hence, we express the PWA torque-to-current map, or MPLPT function, $h(T_p)$ as:

$$i = h(T_p) \approx h_{PWA}(T_p) = \begin{cases} m_1 T_p + i_1, & T_p \in \mathcal{T}_1, \\ m_2 T_p + i_2, & T_p \in \mathcal{T}_2, \\ \dots & \dots \\ m_M T_p + i_M, & T_p \in \mathcal{T}_M, \end{cases}$$

where $i = m_j T_p + i_j$ is the affine equation that maps torque-powerloss points $T \in T_j$ onto current points $I \in I_j$ and I_j is the image of the domain T_j . The torque simplices cover the full range of machine torques, or $T_1 \cup T_2, \dots, T_M = T$. The affine map is defined by the three-dimensional current slope and a current offset. This is seen on the left plot of FIG. 11. The points used to create $h(T)$ can be from the sets Γ_p , Γ_c , or Γ_{cc} , defined above, and may be denoted $h_p(T)$, $h_c(T)$, and $h_{cc}(T)$, respectively. The process of using the points to create $h(T)$ is described next.

[0174] As previously noted, PWA maps divide the original domain into M sets. Each subset is defined to be a simplex, which is the simplest possible polytope in any D-dimensional space and a line segment in the single dimension of the given problem. A D-dimensional simplex can be defined as the convex hull of its D+1 vertices (called the V-notation); alternatively, a simplex can be defined by its faces defined as affine inequalities, called the H-notation:

$$\mathcal{T}_j = \mathcal{H}(\{T_{j0}, T_{j1}\})$$

where $T_{j0}, T_{j1} \in \mathcal{T}$. Each torque simplex $\mathcal{T}_j$ forms a domain of an affine map that maps into the current simplex:

$$\mathcal{J}_j = \mathcal{H}(\{i_{j0}, i_{j1}\})$$

where $i_{j0}, i_{j1} \in \mathcal{J}$. The general position of the defining set of measurement points (convex) implies that the vertices of each simplex are linearly independent and full dimension (not degenerate). Example simplices that are linked in both spaces are shown in FIG. 11. Each line segment $\mathcal{T}_j$ is defined by two vertices, where one vertex T_{j0} is a support vector such that the origin can be moved $T = T - T_{j0}$.

[0175] In the shifted dimension, the simplex is defined by

$$\bar{\mathcal{T}}_j = \mathcal{H}(\{0, \bar{\mathcal{T}}_{j1}\}),$$

where $\bar{\mathcal{T}}_{j1} = T_{j1} - T_{j0}$, where $\bar{\mathcal{T}}_{j1}$ spans the simplex. Furthermore, the current space is shifted in the same way, $\bar{i} = i - i_{j0}$ that results in the simplex

$$\bar{\mathcal{J}}_j = \mathcal{H}(\{0, \bar{i}_{j1}\}),$$

where $\bar{i}_{j1} = i_{j1} - i_{j0}$, where $\bar{i}_{j1}$ spans the simplex. The D=1 simplices and the shift of origin are illustrated in FIG. 12.

[0176] The nonzero vertices can be interpreted as a basis and since an affine map is an isomorphism, the relative position of a vector in the current and flux simplex is the same:

$$\bar{T} = a\bar{T}_{j1},$$

[0177] The a coefficient can be obtained similar to how space vector modulation (SVM) computes relative on-times. Also, $\bar{T}$ is projected onto the basis of $\bar{T}_j$

$$p_j = \text{proj}_{\bar{T}_{j1}} \bar{T} = \frac{\bar{T}_{j1} \cdot \bar{T}}{\|\bar{T}_{j1}\|},$$

[0178] A relative length of the vector is obtained by dividing the magnitude of the projection with the magnitude of the basis vector:

$$a = \frac{\|p_j\|}{\|\bar{T}_{j1}\|}.$$

[0179] To find the current vector $\bar{i}$, a is multiplied with the basis vector of $\bar{i}_j, \bar{i}_{j1}$:

$$\bar{i} = a\bar{i}_{j1}.$$

[0180] The a coefficients in these equations can be set to equal, resulting in:

$$\frac{T}{T_{j1}} = \frac{\tau}{\tau_{j1}}$$

[0181] The, solving for i yields the resulting linear map

$$i = m_j T + i_j$$

where

$$m_j = \frac{i - i_{j0}}{T_{j1} - T_{j0}}$$

and $i = i_{j0} - m_j T_{j0}$. A visualization of this map is shown in FIG. 12.

Example Experimental Results for MPLPT Control

[0182] Experimental results from simulations implementing MPLPT control are described below with respect to an example 65 kW WFS motor with cross-section shown in FIG. 13 and including the following characteristics:

TABLE I

WRSM MOTOR DRIVE PARAMETERS	
Parameter	Value
Turns ratio N_f/N_s	39
Pole pairs	2

TABLE I-continued

WRSM MOTOR DRIVE PARAMETERS	
Parameter	Value
Stator resistance	11.732 mΩ
Rotor resistance (stator referred)	5.461 mΩ
Shaft inertia	22.76E-3 kg m ²
Switching frequency	10 kHz
Sampling frequency	20 kHz
Nameplate r-axis inductance L_r	1.956 mH
Nameplate d-axis inductance L_d	2.420 mH
Nameplate q-axis inductance L_q	0.789 mH
DC-link voltage	325 V
Maximum power	65 kW
Maximum torque	220 Nm

[0183] This experimental example is provided with respect to an MPLPT path from the most negative machine torque to the most positive. In this case the motor has a torque range of 0 Nm/p to 112 Nm/p and copper loss range from 0 kW to 3.23 kW. The left graph of FIG. 14A shows the set of points Γ and pareto frontier Γ_p collected using FEA-simulated data for the WFS motor, and the right graph of FIG. 14A illustrates the corresponding three-dimensional MPLPT currents that will be candidate points for MPLPT. This example has too many pareto-optimal points Γ_p to all be used in a MPLPT path.

[0184] The resulting pareto-convex points Γ_c are shown in FIG. 14B. More particularly, the left graph of FIG. 14B shows the simulated points Γ and convex pareto-optimal solutions Γ_c , and the right graph of FIG. 14B illustrates the corresponding three-dimensional MPLPT currents that will be used to construct $h(T)$. Applying the PWA map $h(T)$ to the set of pareto-convex points yields the piecewise linear function shown in FIG. 14C. The function $h(T)$ in this case follows an occasionally jagged but mostly smooth curve. The distance between the points varies. There are 60 points in Γ_c and 59 line segments that create the PWA map.

[0185] Further filtering of points in c or a different way to filter out points in c to produce a different $h(T)$ can be implemented to obtain certain qualities in the MPLPT path that can include: convexity, smoothness, and more. Costs can be assigned to the distance between points, angle of adjacent line segments, and other parameters. The selected technique used in this first simulation study strictly minimized power losses for torque without consideration for other potentially desirable qualities of the MPLPT path. But, in other examples, other techniques are used such that other qualities of the MPLPT path are considered.

[0186] Additional experimental results from further simulations implementing MPLPT control were performed with the same example 65 kW WFS motor with cross-section shown in FIG. 13. The motor was again modelled computationally using the Finite Element Method (FEM) and analyzed using Finite Element Analysis (FEA) to generate the full set of datapoints Γ . The sets Γ_p , Γ_c , Γ_{cc} are then obtained in post processing by the techniques described above. These sets are shown in the two-dimensional ($\Gamma_{1,k}$, $\Gamma_{2,k}$) space in FIG. 15A and three-dimensional ($\Gamma_{3,k}$) space in FIG. 15B. The majority of the points from the FEA analysis are not in these sets. Of the 57,288 generated datapoints the sizes of the sets were $|\Gamma_p|=403$, $|\Gamma_c|=60$, $|\Gamma_{cc}|=47$, or less than 1%. The MTPA functions produced using Γ_p , Γ_c , Γ_{cc} are evaluated against a 'linear' MTPA ($h_{lin}(T_p)$), which is a linear trajectory between the maximum

torque point and the origin (in the current domain), as well as against a cubic spline interpolated MTPA ($h_{spi}(T_p)$), which uses the points in Γ_{cc} but they are cubic spline interpolated instead of piecewise affine interpolated.

[0187] Further experimentation was also performed using a WFS motor testbench. The motor testbench was configured to operate using the control diagram in FIG. 9A. The five $h(T_p)$ functions (i.e., $h_p(T_p)$, $h_c(T_p)$, $h_{cc}(T_p)$, $h_{lin}(T_p)$, $h_{spi}(T_p)$) were translated to controller code and evaluated on a Texas Instruments TMS320F28379D real-time microcontroller to test their computation time and memory size. In the PWA formulation, if N points are used to create each $h(T_p)$ function, then N-1 lines (or sub-domains) are used; therefore, the memory size will grow at a rate of $\mathcal{O}(N)$ (coefficients plus boundary conditions). The cubic spline interpolation requires twice as much memory as it must save four coefficients (third degree polynomials) instead of two. The computation time of the PWA $h(T_p)$ functions has two components, a (cold start) search which takes $N \log(N)$ time, and two floating point operations. The cubic spline $h_{spi}(T_p)$ will use the same search, but requires six floating point operations via Horner's method, therefore taking three times as long; both are $\mathcal{O}(N \log(N))$ computation time. As more inputs and outputs are added, cubic spline interpolations tend to increase in complexity by factors of two over PWA. The function $h_{lin}(T_p)$ has $\mathcal{O}(1)$ computation and memory size, but is extremely inaccurate. A summary of MCU performance is shown in TABLE II. The time of the other control operations of the control loop are shown in TABLE III.

TABLE II

MCU Performance of MTPA Functions		
	Comp. Time (μ s)	Memory (KiB)
$h_{lin}(T)$	6	4
$h_p(T)$	226	102
$h_c(T)$	40	18
$h_{cc}(T)$	24	15
$h_{spi}(T)$	72	31

TABLE III

Control Timing Parameters	
Operation	Time (μ s)
ADC Conversions	1.8
MTPA PWA Map $h_{lin}(t)$	6.0
Clarke Park Transform	6.3
Flux Linkage Maps ($\times 2$)	14.6
PI Virtual Flux Controller	6.1
Inverse Clark Park Transform	6.3
PWM Generation	3.1

[0188] For real-time evaluation, several tests were conducted. The first involved the WRS motor being spun at a fixed speed of 1000 1/min using a coupled industrial drive. The WRS motor exerts 0.5-44 Nm variable torque steps that follow torque references over a 120s period. The experimental MTPA function used was h_{lin} . The MTPA references generated offline by $h_p(T_p)$, $h_c(T_p)$, and $h_{cc}(T_p)$ (as well as $h_{spi}(T_p)$) are shown in FIG. 15C and are applied to the requested torques in post processing. A drive cycle emulating the operation of a passenger vehicle was also conducted,

where a reference speed trajectory is applied, and the coupled industrial drive simulates the nonlinear torque load due to vehicle dynamics. This experiment is useful to show the operation of the MTPA functions under dynamically changing speeds and torques (including negative torque operation). It is shown in FIG. 15D. Torque is symmetrical about i_q and, therefore, the maps $h_p(T_p)$, $h_c(T_p)$, $h_{cc}(T_p)$, and $h_{spi}(T_p)$ can handle negative torques by inputting the negative of the requested torque, $-T_p$, and then replacing i_q with $-i_q$ at the output of the function. Lastly, a close up of a torque step showing the transient behavior of the controller and MTPA functions is shown in FIG. 15E.

[0189] In every experiment, the linear MTPA function $h_{lin}(T_p)$ performs the worst, creating up to 70% additional copper losses in some cases. This comes at the expense of extremely fast computation and very low memory size.

[0190] The functions $h_p(T_p)$, $h_c(T_p)$, and $h_{cc}(T_p)$ have different properties that are useful for different applications. Averaged copper loss is shown in TABLE IV. As expected, the function $h_c(T_p)$ outperforms $h_p(T_p)$ and $h_{cc}(T_p)$, although all three are within 1% of each other. The PWA MTPA functions outperform the cubic spline $h_{spi}(T_p)$, with the trade-off of losing smoothness in I.

TABLE IV

Efficiency and Accuracy of MTPA Functions			
	Avg. π_{ic} (W)	Avg. T error (%)	Convex in I
$h_{lin}(T)$	950	29.9	yes
$h_p(T)$	761.7	0.16	no
$h_c(T)$	758.9	1.68	no
$h_{cc}(T)$	759.0	1.69	yes
$h_{spi}(T)$	761.9	.07	yes

[0191] Because the $h(T_p)$ functions are piecewise-linear approximations of Γ , there will be error in the currents produced. This error can be quantified by comparing torque T_p (expected torque) to the resulting torque from $\tau_p(h(T_p))$, where $i=h(T_p)$ is the set of current references. The functions $h_c(T_p)$ and $h_{cc}(T_p)$ have minimal error at $T_p > 10$ Nm/p, and $h_p(T_p)$ has very low error throughout all torques. The spline MTPA $h_{spi}(T_p)$ and linear MTPA $h_{lin}(T_p)$ bound the PWA interpolations in torque error. This error presents itself in each of the torque plots of FIGS. 15C, 15D, and 15E as well.

[0192] Finally, the shape of the MTPA trajectory for each $h(T_p)$ is different. The function $h_p(T_p)$ is jagged, and even a small torque change produces large differences in current (as seen in FIG. 15C). The function $h_{cc}(T_p)$ is the least jagged, and has the property of being convex in I. The function $h_c(T_p)$ is a compromise between the two.

[0193] In summary, each of the PWA MTPA functions perform well in terms of memory, computation time, average copper loss, and torque error. Additionally, the function $h_p(T_p)$ has a particularly low torque error, the function $h_c(T_p)$ has a particularly low average copper loss, and the function $h_{cc}(T_p)$ has a particularly fast computation time, has particularly small memory, and is convex.

[0194] In contrast, the two reference MTPA functions tend to operate on extremes of two or more criteria. For example, the function $h_{lin}(T_p)$ has fast computation and small memory, but very high error and very high average copper loss. Additionally, the function $h_{spi}(T_p)$ has low torque error, but slow computation time.

MPC Controller for WFSM Using PWA Map(s)

[0195] In some examples, the motor system **100** implements a model predictive controller. Electric machines, particular WFS motors, can have a strong nonlinear coupling between direct (d) and rotor (r) dimensions. Some electric machines use ferromagnetic materials to maximize and channel magnetic flux. Such machines tend to operate non-linear magnetic regime in general and exhibit saturation and cross saturation. The relationship between current and flux linkage is modeled using magnetic models (MM), which may also be referred to as flux linkage maps. Such maps tend to be linearized and expressed as inductances or transfer functions for motor control. Motor controllers can use an explicit or implicit MM as part of their control scheme.

[0196] Offline MM can use one or a combination of Finite Element Analysis (FEA), analytical calculations, and experimental values to measure inductances at various operating points. Some WRS motor controllers use a linearized, offline MM, which may include in sliding mode control, maximum torque, passivity-based control, and predictive direct current control. Capturing non-linear flux is much simpler using online estimation methods. Some examples include Kalman filters, flux-linkage observers, and iterative numerical solvers. However, with online methods, estimation and advanced control may require additional microcontroller resources and/or computation time to complete closed loop control cycles.

[0197] As provided in some examples herein, PWA functions may be used to build an offline MM lookup table (LUT) to capture non-linear flux. These PWA functions simplify the state-space equations to be linear, decreasing computation time. The saved computation time can instead be spent solving a constrained finite time optimal control (CFTOC) MPC problem. Accordingly, in some examples, a motor controller is provided that implements MPC control using PWA functions that simplify the MPC state-space equations to be linear.

[0198] FIG. 16 illustrates a particular example of the motor system **100**, identified as motor system **1600**, according to some embodiments. The description of components for FIGS. 1, 2, and 9A above similarly applies to the components in FIG. 16 sharing the same element numbers or names, except as otherwise provided herein. For example, the motor controller **120** is again illustrated as a collection of functional blocks with respective inputs and outputs. Each of the functional blocks may be implemented by a dedicated hardware circuit of the electronic processor **125** of the controller **120**, by a block of software or instructions stored in the memory **130** and executed by the electronic processor **125**, or a combination thereof. The motor drive circuit **110** is further illustrated as including a stator drive circuit **205** and a rotor drive circuit **210**. The motor **115** is illustrated as a WFS motor having a three-phase stator with phases (A, B, C) and a rotor field winding (R), and the motor system **1600** is primarily described with respect to a WFS motor. However, in other examples, the motor **115** is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, or another motor type. When the motor **115** is a permanent magnet synchronous motor, the rotor field winding (R) is not included in the motor **115** and, accordingly, the rotor drive circuit **210** may not be included, the motor controller **120** may not sense or control current through the rotor field winding (R), and the control blocks

of the motor controller **120** may not receive, process, or generate rotor field components.

[0199] In contrast to FIG. 2, the motor system **1600** of FIG. 16 includes an MPC control block **1605**, as described in further detail below. Further, the current-to-flux linkage maps **1610** and **1615** may be implemented as piecewise affine maps as described above with respect to FIG. 2, or may be implemented through other mapping functions (e.g., lookup tables, real-time executed functions, etc.). Further still, in some embodiments, a function block or map **1620** that translates an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*)) to target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ may be implemented as the MPLPT function block **905** described with respect to FIG. 9A (which may be implemented as a piecewise affine map that maps an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*)) to target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$). Further, the functional blocks or maps **1610** and **1620** may be combined into a single piecewise affine map that maps an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*)) to target flux linkage values $\lambda_{r,dq}^*$.

[0200] Additionally, in some embodiments, the controller block within the controller **120** may implement current-based motor control, rather than flux linkage-based control as illustrated in FIG. 16. For example, the current-to-flux linkage maps **1610** and **1615** may not be present in the controller **120**, and the target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ and measured current values $i_{r,dq}$ may be provided to the difference calculation block of the controller **120**. The difference calculation block of the controller **120** may then provide difference values indicating the differences between the target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ and measured current values $i_{r,dq}$ to the current-based MPC controller block **1605** that is provided in place of the flux controller block shown in FIG. 16. Regardless of whether flux-based or current-based, the MPC controller block **1605** (and, thus, the motor controller **120**) may then generate a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on the received difference values and the rotational position of the motor (θ). For example, the flux controller may output voltage commands V_ϕ , V_d , and V_q (also referred to collectively as $V_{f,dq}$ or $V_{r,dq}$). The voltage commands may then be used to control the motor similar to as described above with respect to FIG. 2 (e.g., via inverse Clark-Park transform block **245**, PWM generation block **250**, and motor drive circuit **110**).

[0201] FIG. 17 illustrates a process **1700** for controlling a motor using a model predictive control technique. The process **1700** is described as being carried out by the motor system **1600** of FIG. 16. However, in some embodiments, the process **1700** may be implemented by another motor system, for example, motor system **100**, **900**, and/or **1800**. Additionally, although the blocks of the process **1700** are illustrated in a particular order, in some embodiments, one or more of the blocks may be executed partially or entirely in parallel, may be executed in a different order than illustrated in FIG. 17, or may be bypassed.

[0202] In block **1705**, the motor controller **120** determines current values for the motor **115** in a rotational reference frame, such as the RDQN reference frame or the rotor-alpha-beta ($\alpha\beta$) reference frame. Each current value is associated with a dimension (or axis) of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. For example, in the RDQN reference frame, the set of dimensions includes the R (or field (f)), D, and Q dimensions (e.g., i_ϕ , i_d , i_q , also referenced

as $i_{f,dq}$). As another example, in the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame, the set of dimensions includes the r (or field (f)), α , and β dimensions (e.g., i_r , i_α , i_β , also referenced as $i_{f,\alpha\beta}$). In some examples involving MPC control, the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame may be used instead of the RDQN reference frame because, in the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame, the state equation has no dependence on speed ω and is linear.

[0203] For example, to implement block 1705, the motor controller 120 may determine electrical operational characteristics of the motor 115 in a stationary reference frame; determine a rotational position of the motor 115 (e.g., of the rotor of the motor 115); and transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor 115 in the rotational reference frame. For example, to determine the electrical operational characteristics of the motor 115 in the stationary reference frame and the rotational position of the rotor, the controller 120 may receive current measurements from current sensors 255 configured to sense current of each phase of the stator windings (e.g., i_a , i_b , i_c , also collectively referred to as i_{abc}) and current of the rotor winding(s) (e.g., i_r , sometimes referred to as i_r) of the motor 115. The controller 120 may also receive rotational position measurements (θ) from a rotational position sensor 260 configured to measure the rotational position of the rotor. In some examples, the controller 120 may determine current and rotational motor position using other techniques. For example, the controller 120 may use a “sensorless” design to determine the rotor position, for example, by inferring rotor position by detecting zero-crossings, peaks, and/or valleys of back electromotive force (emf) signals on the stator windings. Further, the controller 120 may calculate the current values from voltage measurements on the stator windings and/or rotor winding (s) provided by voltage sensors. To transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor in the RDQN rotational reference frame, the motor controller 120 may perform, via Clark-Park transform block 215, a Clark-Park transform on the determined current i_{abc} and rotational position (θ) of the motor 115. The motor controller 120 (e.g., in the transform block 215) may further perform an inverse Park transform on the current values that are in the RDQN rotational reference frame (e.g., by multiplying the current values by the inverse Park transform matrix (P^{-1})) to obtain the current values in the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame. In some examples, the Clark-Park transform block 215 may instead be a Clarke transform block that directly transforms the determined current i_{abc} and rotational position (θ) (by applying the Clarke transform matrix) to generate the current values for the motor 115 in the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame.

[0204] In block 1710, the motor controller 120 determines, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. For example, the motor controller 120 may receive the desired control parameter in the form of an input command or reference value, which may indicate a desired motor torque value (T^*) or desired motor speed (ω). The desired control parameter may be retrieved from a memory (e.g., the memory 130) or received via an input/output device of the motor controller 120 (e.g., from a user operating a keyboard, pushbutton, level, dial, etc.).

[0205] The motor controller 120 may then, using the reference generation block 230, transform the desired con-

trol parameter to target current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame (e.g., $i_{f,dq}^*$ or $i_{f,\alpha\beta}^*$). For example, the motor controller 120 may use the reference generation block 230 in the form of a lookup table (e.g., stored in the memory 130) that maps potential values for the desired control parameter T^* to the target current values. The lookup table may be populated in advance based on experimental data. The motor controller 120 may then determine, based on the target current values, the target flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the piecewise affine (PWA) map 225. The motor controller 120 may use the PWA map 225 to determine the target flux linkage values based on the target current values in a similar manner as the PWM map 220 is used to determine the flux linkage values based on the current values. The two PWA maps 220 and 225 illustrated in FIG. 17 may be duplicate PWA maps, or the motor controller 120 may use one PWA map for both the actual values and the target values (i.e., although two PWA maps are illustrated, in some embodiments, one shared PWA map is included instead).

[0206] In some examples, the reference generation block 230 is implemented as the MPLPT function block 905 described above with respect to FIGS. 9A-9B. In such cases, the motor controller 120 may apply the MPLPT function block 905 to the desired control parameter. For example, the MPLPT function block 905 may implement a piecewise affine (PWA) map that maps an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor reference torque (T^*)) to target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ or to target flux linkage values $\lambda_{r,dq}^*$ as described above with respect to FIGS. 9A-9B.

[0207] In some examples, the output current value of the reference generation block 230 is an intermediate target motor control parameter value that is then further translated to a (final) target motor control parameter value by the current-to-flux linkage map 225. In other examples, such as where the controller 240 of FIG. 17 is a current-based controller rather than a flux-based controller, or where the reference generation block 230 is configured to map reference torque (T^*) directly to a target flux value (λ^*), the output current value of the reference generation block 230 is the (final) target motor control parameter value.

[0208] In block 1715, the motor controller 120 controls the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values by using a piecewise affine map that was defined by offline solving of a model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs. For example, in some scenarios, the MPC controller 1605 implements a model predictive control (MPC) algorithm to generate the control signals (e.g., voltage commands ($V_{r,dq}$)), based on the received difference values from difference operation block 235 (e.g., $\lambda^* - \lambda$) and the rotational position of the motor (θ). The difference values indicate a difference between the target flux values (λ^*) output by PWA map 1610 and the flux values (λ) output by PWA map 1615. The controls are based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values at least because the MPC controller 1606 generates the controls based on the flux values (λ), which was determined based on the current values (e.g., $i_{r,abc}$, $i_{r,dq}$) and based on the target flux values (λ^*) (a target motor control parameter value).

[0209] The MPC algorithm includes an MPC optimization problem or equation, as described in further detail in below. In some examples, the MPC controller 1605 implements

“explicit MPC.” In such examples, in advance of execution of the process **1700**, the MPC optimization problem is solved offline and a control law is generated therefrom and stored on the MPC controller **1605**. Then, in block **1715**, during real-time operation of the motor **115**, the control law is accessed and implemented to control the motor **115**. For example, the MPC optimization problem (e.g., described below) is solved for all or a subset of possible inputs offline, which is then used to generate a piecewise affine map (an “MPC PWA map”) that is stored on the controller **120** (e.g., as part of the MPC controller **1605**) in advance of motor operation. The MPC PWA map defines a plurality of domains, each with an associated control law. In real time during operation of the motor, the MPC controller **1605** receives measurements (e.g., the received difference values and the rotational position of the motor (θ)), which dictates which domain of the MPC PWA is active. The MPC controller **1605** thus identifies the active domain and the feedback control law associated with the active domain. The MPC controller **1605** then generates control signals (e.g., voltage commands ($V_{r,dq}$) using the identified control law. **[0210]** In some examples, the explicit MPC provides a feedback control law as a MPC PWA map of the form:

$$u(k) = -K_i x(k) + F_i, \text{ for all } x(k) \text{ in } D_i,$$

where K_i and F_i describe the affine control law applicable to all states $x(k)$ in the i -th PWA domain D_i . Typical mathematical strategies may be used to reduce the MPC statement to this PWA form, such as by using a parametric solver (e.g., the multiparametric toolbox (MPT)).

[0211] In other examples, the MPC controller **1605** solves the MPC optimization problem online (i.e., in real time during operation and control of the motor **115**) to generate the control signals. For example, the MPC controller may solve the MPC optimization problem online either analytically (e.g., using an unconstrained MPC formulation) or numerically (e.g., with a real-time numerical solver such as a gradient method or Newton solver).

[0212] As described above, the MPC controller **1605** may implement flux linkage-based control or current-based control. In some embodiments, the MPC controller **1605** may implement a hybrid current and flux linkage based-control. For example, the cost function of the MPC optimization problem or parts of the MPC may be formulated in the flux and/or current domain and include the PWA map in the optimization problem as an equality constraint.

[0213] Although the controller block of the motor controller **120** (e.g., flux controller, current-based controller, MPC controller **1605**) in the various embodiments provided herein are described and shown as receiving a difference value (e.g., a difference between target flux values $\lambda_{r,dq}^*$ and measured flux values $\lambda_{r,dq}$ or a difference between target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ and measured current values $i_{r,dq}$), in some examples, the controller blocks receive the reference and measured values and, for example, the difference calculation is integrated into the controller block. In other words, the difference calculation block shown in FIGS. 2, 9A, and 16 may be part of the controller block and its control algorithm or the algorithms may be adjusted to account for the measured and reference values without an explicit difference calculation between these two values.

MPC Algorithm

[0214] Model Predictive Control (MPC), or Receding Horizon Control (RHC), is a control technique that includes solving a constrained finite time optimal control (CFTOC) problem that finds the minimal-cost path from a start state to and end state. In this CFTOC problem, the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame form of the machine equations may be used because the state equation has no dependence on speed ω and is linear. Accordingly, in this section, unless otherwise noted, it can be assumed that fluxes λ , currents i , and terminal voltages $\bar{v}$ are in $\alpha\beta$ reference frame form. In this CFTOC problem, the (discrete time) state equation f is

$$f_{r\alpha\beta}(\bar{v}_{r\alpha\beta}) = T_s \bar{v}_{r\alpha\beta},$$

where T_s is the sampling period and $\bar{v}$ is the terminal voltage, and the (discrete time) output equation g is:

$$g_{r\alpha\beta} = P^{-1}(\theta) \phi^{-1}(P(\theta) \lambda_{r\alpha\beta})$$

where ϕ^{-1} is the flux-to-current map (e.g., an FEA-generated or PWA flux-to-current map, as previously described), λ is flux, θ is the rotational position of the motor, and P is the Park transform.

[0215] RHC provides an optimal input $\bar{v}$ to the plant by computing a set of inputs $V_{0 \rightarrow N}$ that reaches a desired state λ_N from a starting state λ_0 in N time steps, then choosing the first value of the set. N is called the horizon length. The known state variable at the present time k is denoted $\lambda(k)$, a calculated future state variable at time k is denoted λ_k , and the state predicted for time $t+k$ computed at time k is denoted $\lambda_{t+k|k}$. The same notation is valid for inputs $\bar{v}$.

[0216] An input trajectory of length N where the input starts at $\bar{v}_0$ is denoted as the set

$$V_{0 \rightarrow N} = \{\bar{v}_0, \dots, \bar{v}_{N-1}\}$$

[0217] The starting state is denoted λ_0 and the value of the input and state at the end of the trajectory are denoted $\bar{v}_N$, λ_N , respectively.

[0218] A cost J_0 for a given a trajectory can be calculated by:

$$J_0(\lambda_0, i_0) \triangleq \lambda_N, P\lambda_N + \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} \bar{v}' Q \bar{v}$$

where λ_k and $\bar{v}_k$ are the state and input at some time k in the trajectory. The cost function has two components. The first component is called the “terminal cost” and uses the matrix $P \in \mathbb{R}_{3 \times 3}^+$ to penalize the trajectory based on how close the final state λ_N is against the desired state. The second component is called “stage cost,” which uses the matrix $Q \in \mathbb{R}_{3 \times 3}^+$ to penalize the sum of change in state over all steps.

[0219] In some examples, an additional term $\bar{v}' R \bar{v}$, called the “input cost,” is used to penalize the sum of change in input over all steps. When using voltage-source inverters, we can set $R=0$ because changing the terminal voltage may not be associated with any significant drawbacks, so this term is not included.

[0220] The CFTOC problem can be defined as:

$$\begin{aligned} J_0^*(\lambda(t)) &= \min_{\mathcal{V}_{0 \rightarrow N}} J_0(\lambda(0), \mathcal{V}_{0 \rightarrow N}), \\ \text{subj. to } \lambda_{k+1} &= f(\lambda, \mathbf{v}), k = 0, \dots, N-1, \\ \lambda_k &\in \Lambda, \mathbf{v}_k \in \mathcal{V}, k = 0, \dots, N-1, \\ \lambda_N &\in \Lambda_f, \\ \lambda_0 &= \lambda(0) \end{aligned}$$

where J_0^* is the optimal cost or value function, Λ_f is the terminal region that the final flux λ_N must be in by the Nth step, and λ_0 is the defined starting state, which is the same as the known state it is currently in $\lambda(0)$. A simple definition of the terminal region Λ_f is an area within some ϵ distance from the desired state λ^* ,

$$\Lambda_f = \lambda^* + \epsilon, \epsilon \in \mathbb{R}^3.$$

[0221] There exists at least one optimum cost and trajectory if $\mathcal{V}_{0 \rightarrow N}$ is compact and $f(\lambda, \mathbf{v})$ and $\bar{\mathbf{v}}^T \mathbf{Q} \bar{\mathbf{v}}$ are continuous. The optimal output trajectory to the problem is denoted as:

$$\mathcal{V}_{0 \rightarrow N}^* = \{\bar{\mathbf{v}}_0^*, \bar{\mathbf{v}}_1^*, \dots, \bar{\mathbf{v}}_{N-1}^*\}.$$

[0222] At $t=0$, the first solution of the trajectory is the input to the system; at $t=1$, the CFTOC problem is re-solved and the first input of the new trajectory is the input to the system. This process is repeated indefinitely:

$$\begin{aligned} \bar{\mathbf{v}}(0) &= \bar{\mathbf{v}}_{0|0}^*(\lambda(0)), \\ \bar{\mathbf{v}}(1) &= \bar{\mathbf{v}}_{1|1}^*(\lambda(1)), \\ &\vdots \\ \bar{\mathbf{v}}(t) &= \bar{\mathbf{v}}_{t|t}^*(\lambda(t)). \end{aligned}$$

[0223] In each case, the horizon length is N time steps ahead of the current time. Thus, the horizon is constantly being pushed further ahead in time, or “receding” from the present viewpoint.

[0224] The RHC control law that associates an optimal input $\bar{\mathbf{v}}_{t|t}^*$ after solving the CFTOC to the state $\lambda(t)$ is denoted as $c_r: \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$, where $c_r(\lambda(t)) = \bar{\mathbf{v}}_{t|t}^*$.

[0225] By combining the control law for any arbitrary positive time k (denoted c_k), with the system plant $\mathbf{f}_{r\alpha\beta}(\bar{\mathbf{v}}_{f_{r\alpha\beta}}) = \mathbf{T}_s \bar{\mathbf{v}}_{f_{r\alpha\beta}}$, the closed-loop control equation c_{cl} is

$$c_{cl}(\lambda(k)) \triangleq \lambda(k+1) = \mathbf{T}_s c_k(\lambda(k)), k \geq 0.$$

[0226] In some examples, the CFTOC problem (i.e., the optimal cost or value function $J_0^*(\lambda(t))$ is solved using the Multi-Parametric Toolbox 3.0 (MPT3), which is uniquely designed to solve MPC with PWA system functions. As shown in FIG. 16, in some examples, the measured state flux

λ is calculated using the feedback current i and the PWA map 1615. The MPT3 solver may solve the CFTOC problem using a linear complementarity problem (LCP) solver that can solve linear problems (LP) and quadratic problems (QP). The output provided by the MPT3 solver may be the aforementioned MPC PWA function. The MPC PWA function may have a different function for each combination of active and inactive equality constraints.

[0227] Simulations of the MPC controller 1605 controlling a 65 kW WFS motor illustrated that the described MPC controller 1605 is feasible and viable for use in speed-based control and torque-based control of a WFS motor.

PWA Map for Permanent Magnet Synchronous Machines

[0228] As noted above, in some embodiments, the motor 115 is a permanent magnet (PM) synchronous motor. Among other applications, PM synchronous motors may be used in high energy density applications due to their high efficiency and mechanical simplicity. For example, PM synchronous motors have been used in the automotive space, including for electric and all-electric air propulsion drives. Controller performance for PMS motors can depend on the accuracy of the machine parameters such as the stator inductances, stator resistance, and permanent magnet (PM) flux. These parameters can change in real time and have dependencies on temperature, position, and current. For example, the stator resistance increases non-linearly with temperature, the PM flux can decrease (demagnetize) at high temperatures, and stator inductance saturates at high current. A controller can account for these variations using online parameter estimation, offline parameter look up tables (LUTs), or a combination thereof.

[0229] Online parameter estimation may use real-time feedback of the drive system to estimate parameters. Feedback can include current, voltage, speed, and position. Online parameter estimation methods include receding horizon estimation, recursive least squares, neural networks, and extended Kalman filters. Offline parameter LUTs may use the data of the machine from analytical calculations, FEA-analysis, and experimentation (or a combination thereof) to approximate the parameters given various operating points of the machine. The datapoints are interpolated in various ways to produce various desirable properties depending on the parameter and application. Generally, online parameter estimation requires more computation time than offline LUTs, but is more accurate over the lifetime of the motor (or associated vehicle) by detecting degradation and partial faults in the machine. Online parameter estimation may use more sensors or sensorless techniques than offline LUTs. Additionally, systems that use offline parameter LUTs may take up more memory (e.g., on a digital signal processor (DSP) of the motor controller) and can function with less sensors.

[0230] In some examples provided herein, a virtual-flux motor controller for controlling a PM synchronous motor is provided that relies on a flux linkage magnetic model of the PM synchronous motor. Flux linkage exhibits saturation and cross saturation at high current, introducing non-linearities into the machine model. The virtual-flux motor controller can regulate the flux of a machine by using field-oriented control such as, for example, model predictive control (MPC). As described in further detail herein, the virtual-flux motor controller may use a piecewise affine (PWA) flux linkage magnetic model, also referred to as a PWA map or

function, that locally linearizes the inductance and flux-offset of the machine. Accordingly, the magnetic model and, thus, the state-space model of the system may be linear while capturing saturation effects, enabling robust controls and efficient operation. The magnetic model of the PM synchronous motor may be built using the PWA functions. This magnetic model can allow for the use of virtual-flux model predictive control (VF-MPC) motor controller that also takes into account saturation and cross saturation effects in the MM. The model may be created using FEA-simulated data points and may be verified with experimental data-points. Additionally, in some examples, as described herein, the model may be optimized using irregularly gridded points (e.g., in maximum torque per ampere (MTPA) range, derated range, or full current range), which can result in lower average and maximum flux error. In one example, using only 40 irregularly gridded points provided an average flux error less than 1% and a maximum error less than 2%. This result represents a $\approx 5\text{-}10\%$ and $\approx 80\text{-}100\%$ reduction in average and maximum flux error compared to a regularly gridded model.

[0231] As noted above, in some embodiments, the motor 115 is a permanent magnet (PM) synchronous motor. For example, the motor 115 illustrated and described with respect to FIGS. 1, 2, 9A, and 16 may be a PM synchronous motor. In such embodiments, the rotor of the PM synchronous motor includes permanent magnets, and does not include an energizable field (in contrast to a WFS motor and in contrast to a hybrid WFS motor having a rotor with at least one permanent magnet and at least one energizable field). Accordingly, in such embodiments, the motor drive circuit 110 may not include a rotor drive circuit 210, but may still include the stator drive circuit 205. Additionally, the monitored or determined rotor field characteristics (e.g., i_r , λ_r), rotor field control-related variables (e.g., v_r , D_r), and corresponding portions of the controller 120 that operate to determine or generate these rotor field elements may be modified to not determine or generate these rotor field elements. For example, the blocks 905, 910, 915 of FIG. 9B may not receive i_r or output i_r , i_r^* , λ_r , λ_r^* , the flux controller may not receive λ_r^* , λ_r , or output v_r , and the PWM generation block may not receive v_r or output D_r . Similar modifications may also be present in the systems illustrated in FIG. 2 and FIG. 16 when implemented with a PM synchronous motor.

[0232] FIG. 18 also discloses the motor 115 in the form of a PM synchronous motor. More particularly, FIG. 18 illustrates a particular example of the motor system 100, identified as PM synchronous motor system 1800, according to some embodiments. The description of components for FIGS. 1, 2, 9A, and 16 above similarly applies to the components in FIG. 18 sharing the same element numbers or names, except as otherwise provided herein. For example, the motor controller 120 is again illustrated as a collection of functional blocks with respective inputs and outputs. Each of the functional blocks may be implemented by a dedicated hardware circuit of the electronic processor 125 of the controller 120, by a block of software or instructions stored in the memory 130 and executed by the electronic processor 125, or a combination thereof. The motor drive circuit 110 is further illustrated as including a stator drive circuit 205, but without a rotor drive circuit (as the rotor is lacking an excitable field). Additionally, in contrast to the illustrations of FIGS. 2, 9A, and 16, the motor 115 is illustrated as a PM synchronous motor having a three-phase stator with phases (A, B, C), and the motor system 1800 is

primarily described with respect to a PM synchronous motor. However, in other examples, the motor 115 is a WFS motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, or another motor type. [0233] The motor controller 120 of the motor system 1800 is similar to the motor controller 120 illustrated in FIGS. 2, 9A, and 16, but its functional blocks are adapted for a PM synchronous motor. For example, the control blocks of the motor controller 120 in the motor system 1800, may not receive, process, or generate rotor field components (as the rotor is lacking an excitable field). Otherwise, the control blocks perform generally similar functionality as similarly named components of FIGS. 2, 9A, and 16. For example, virtual flux controller 1805 may generate control signals (voltage commands) based on a motor position and on difference in a reference flux and a determined flux (similar to flux controllers 240 and 1605); the PWA maps 1810 and 1815 may translate an input current values to flux values based on PWA functions (similar to the maps 220, 225, 910, 915, 1610, and 1615); the Clark-Park transform block 1817 may perform a Clark-Park transform on the determined current i_{abc} and rotational position (θ) of the motor 115 to transform the input values to a rotational reference frame (e.g., DQ reference frame) (similar to transform block 215); the MTPA block may translate a reference torque to a reference current using a maximum torque per ampere translation function or an MPLPT translation function (similar to reference MPLPT block 905); the inverse Clark-Park transform block 1845 may transform an input voltage from a rotational reference frame (e.g., DQ reference frame) to a stationary reference frame (e.g., ABC reference frame) (similar to inverse transform block 245); and the PWM generation block 1850 may transform an input voltage command to a PWM control signal (D_{abc}), similar to PWM generation block 250.

[0234] Further, in some embodiments, a function block or map 1820 that translates an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*)) to target current values $i_{r,dq}^*$ may be implemented as a lookup table or other function that does not implement MPLPT or MTPA, such as described with respect to block 230. In the case of the motor system 1800 using a speed control command, the reference torque (T^*) may be created by a reference speed ω^* subtracted by a measured speed ω fed into a PI controller to produce the reference torque T^* . In the case of the motor system 1800 using a torque control command, the reference torque (T^*) may be input (e.g., from a memory, a pedal, knob, switch, keypad, etc.). In some examples, the functional blocks or maps 1810 and 1820 may be combined into a single piecewise affine map that maps an input desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*)) to target flux linkage values λ_{dq}^* .

PM Synchronous Motor Model

[0235] In the following section, a model for a PM synchronous motor is provided. This model is similar to the previously described WFS motor model, but is updated to account for the lack of an excitable rotor field. The PMSM is a three-phase synchronous machine that can be dynamically described by the state-space model

$$\dot{\lambda}_d = \omega \lambda_q + u_d - R_s i_d = \omega \lambda_q + u_d,$$

$$\dot{\lambda}_q = -\omega \lambda_d + u_q - R_s i_q = -\omega \lambda_d + u_q,$$

where λ_d , λ_q are the q-axis and d-axis stator flux linkages, u_d , u_q are terminal voltages, i_d , i_q are stator currents, ω is the electrical speed of the machine, R_s is the stator resistance,

and $(\bullet)$ is the dI/dt operator. This formulation makes use of the Parke-Clarke transformation, which here provides a linear transformation from three phase (three-dimensional) to direct-quadrature (two-dimensional) space. The power-invariant Clark transform is used, and the magnetic axis of the permanent magnet of the rotor is the reference angle for the d-axis in the Park transformation.

[0236] The compensated terminal voltages $\bar{u}_d$ and $\bar{u}_q$ are the terminal voltages incorporating the resistive voltage drop. The compensated terminal voltages are capable of including the inverter non-idealities such as switch on-voltage drops and dead times. The PWA formulation presented later is capable of including parameters not present such as damper windings, zero-sequence current, etc., but are omitted for simplicity. Additionally, position-dependent effects can be added to the PWA model as third, fourth, . . . nth dimensions of the existing two-dimensional dq PWA model. This formulation is compatible with any PM synchronous machines, regardless of salience ratio (IPMSM, SPMSM, etc.).

[0237] The torque of a PMSM is modelled by

$$T = p i' J \lambda,$$

where p is the number of pole pairs, $i = [i_d \ i_q] \in I$ is the current vector, $\lambda = [\lambda_d \ \lambda_q] \in \Lambda$ is the flux vector, and J is the cross-coupling matrix,

$$J = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix},$$

[0238] The sets I and Λ describe the full operating current and flux range of the machine. The relationship between current i and flux λ is nonlinear and saturates. Cross saturation makes the d-axis flux dependent on d-axis current and q-axis current. The same holds for q-axis flux. The functions $f(i)$ and $g(\lambda)$ model this relationship:

$$\lambda = f(i)$$

$$i = g(\lambda).$$

[0239] The function $f(i)$ is useful for calculating or estimating the flux of the machine λ given feedback currents, while $g(\lambda)$ is useful when estimating i using an observer instead of direct measurement. Typically, $g(\lambda)$ is more computationally difficult to obtain than $f(i)$. The map $f(\bullet)$ may be a LUT that is built using measured or finite element analysis (FEA) points that are interpolated by some method.

[0240] The compensated terminal voltages can be described by the vector $\bar{u} = [\bar{u}_d \ \bar{u}_q] \in U$, where U is voltage operating range of the machine. Thus, the machine can be described as a standard linear state-space system in the form

$$\dot{\lambda} = A\lambda + B\bar{u},$$

$$\dot{i} = g(\lambda),$$

where the A and B matrices are

$$= \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \omega \\ -\omega & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B = I = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

[0241] The input is the compensated voltage u , the state is the flux λ , and the output is the current i . This state space model can be used in an MPC controller, such as may be implemented the flux controller block 1805. The state λ will be linearized using a piecewise affine map $f_{PWA}(i)$ according to the machine operating point.

Piecewise Affine (PWA) Magnetic Model for PM Synchronous Motor

[0242] As noted, the motor 115 implemented as a PM synchronous motor may have its magnetic model expressed as a PWA map. As previously discussed (e.g., with respect to WFS motors above), PWA maps divide a nonlinear map into M domains over which the function is linearized. Hence, the PWA current to flux map may be expressed as:

$$\lambda = f(i) \approx f_{PWA}(i) = \begin{cases} L_1 i + \psi_1, & i \in J_1, \\ L_2 i + \psi_2, & i \in J_2, \\ \dots \\ L_M i + \psi_M, & i \in J_M, \end{cases}$$

where $\lambda = L_j i + \psi_j$ is the affine equation that maps currents $i \in I_j$ onto fluxes $\lambda \in \Lambda_j$ and Λ_j is the image of the domain I_j . The affine map is defined by the inductance matrix L_j and a flux offset ψ_j .

[0243] The inverse of $f(\bullet)$ is

$$i = g(\lambda) \approx g_{PWA}(\lambda) = \begin{cases} L_1^{-1}(\lambda - \psi_1), & \lambda \in \Lambda_1, \\ L_2^{-1}(\lambda - \psi_2), & \lambda \in \Lambda_2, \\ \dots \\ L_M^{-1}(\lambda - \psi_M), & \lambda \in \Lambda_M, \end{cases}$$

such that $i = g \circ f(i)$.

[0244] The process to create this PWA map can be divided into four steps: 1) choose I_p ; 2) domain decomposition (e.g., Delaunay Triangulation) of I_p ; 3) compute all L_j and ψ_j ; and 4) assign all L_j and ψ_j to I_j . In step one of the process to create the PWA map (choosing I_p), $I_p \subseteq I$ is the set of measured, simulated, or estimated current points that will be used to create the PWA map. The corresponding flux set Λ_p is also identified. In general, as least in some examples, a set of all current-flux point pairs for a motor may be too large to create a corresponding PWA map because the resulting PWA map may be too large for a DSP of the motor controller 120 with finite memory. Accordingly, a subset of current-flux point pairs (I_p and corresponding flux points Λ_p) selected from the current-flux point pairs I and Λ for the motor 115 may be identified or chosen.

[0245] In some examples, I_p can be regularly gridded, where i_d and i_q datapoints of I_p are evenly separated. The corresponding flux points Λ_p will not necessarily be regularly-gridded.

[0246] In other examples, I_p can be irregularly gridded. An irregularly-gridded I_p can yield higher accuracy PWA map for the same number of points as the regularly-gridded, because flux error is not evenly distributed. Irregularly-gridded current points can also target areas in I and Λ that may be more frequently used, such as derated operation and MTPA.

[0247] Techniques for selecting the subset of current-flux point pairs for use in the PWA map generation, including to

optimize the PWA map, are described further below. Similar strategies may be used as described with respect to the process 600 of FIG. 6 and WFS motors.

[0248] In step two of creating a PWA map, (domain decomposition of I_p), the domain decomposition algorithm (e.g., Delaunay Triangulation) is applied to the current-flux pairs to obtain M subdomains of the PWA function. That is, constructing the PWA map or functions implies splitting the domain I and image A into M subdomains I_j and subimages Λ_j . These M subdomains are connected and that the resulting maps are non-conflicting. In other words, a point $i \in I$ can be in one or more subdomains if and only if they map to the same point $\lambda \in \Lambda$. Hence, the domain can be split into simplices that do not overlap except for at the border. Any point on the border $i \in \partial \Lambda_j$ is expected to be part of two or more subdomains to ensure continuity. The points all map onto the same $\lambda \in \partial \Lambda_j$ that is also part of two or more subdomains. In contrast, all points in the interior of the subdomains are part of only one subdomain.

[0249] The M subdomains may be obtained by identifying unique and connected simplices using the Delaunay triangulation $DT(I_p)$ (or another domain decomposition algorithm). To calculate the Delaunay triangulation for I_p , a Voronoi diagram may be constructed using I_p . The Voronoi diagram of I_p splits the I space into $|I_p|$ Voronoi cells, where all points in a Voronoi cell are closer to a single point in I_p than any other. To obtain the Delaunay triangulation, the dual of the Voronoi diagram is found.

[0250] The Delaunay triangulation $DT(I_p)$ of the Euclidean space I guarantees that no point $i \in I$ is inside two simplices in $DT(I_p)$. In general, $DT(I_p)$ is unique and there exists no set of D+2 points wherein one of the points lies strictly inside the minimally enclosing hypersphere of the point set. Each subset is defined to be a simplex, which is the simplest possible polytope in any D-dimensional space, which is a triangle in the two dimensions of the given problem.

[0251] A D-dimensional simplex can be defined as the convex hull of its D+1 vertices (called the V-notation); alternatively, a simplex can be defined by its faces defined as affine inequalities (called the H-notation):

$$J_j = \mathcal{H}(\{i_{j0}, i_{j1}, \dots, i_{jD}\}).$$

where $i_{j0}, \dots, i_{jD} \in I_p$. Each current simplex I_j forms a domain of an affine map that maps into the flux simplex

$$\Lambda_j = \mathcal{H}(\{\lambda_{j0}, \lambda_{j1}, \dots, \lambda_{jD}\}).$$

where $\lambda_{j0}, \dots, \lambda_{jD} \in \Lambda_p$. The general position of the defining set of measurement points implies that the vertices of each simplex are linearly independent and full dimension (not degenerate).

[0252] In step three of creating a PWA map, subdomain coefficients (L_j and ψ_j) are computed. Each simplex I_j is defined by three vertices. One vertex i_{j0} may be the support vector such that the origin may be moved $\bar{i} = i - i_{j0}$. In the shifted dimension, the simplex is defined by

$$I_j = H(0, \bar{i}_{j1}, \dots, \bar{i}_{jD})$$

where $\bar{i}_{jk} = i_{jk} - i_{j0}$ ($k = \{1, \dots, D\}$) span the simplex. Furthermore, the flux space is shifted by the corresponding flux vector $\bar{\lambda} = \lambda - \lambda_{j0}$, which results in the simplex defined by

$$\bar{\Lambda}_j = \mathcal{H}(0, \bar{\lambda}_{j1}, \dots, \bar{\lambda}_{jD}),$$

where $\bar{\lambda}_{jk} = \lambda_{jk} - \lambda_{j0}$ ($k = \{1, \dots, D\}$) span the simplex.

[0253] The nonzero vertices can be interpreted as a basis and since an affine map is an isomorphism, the relative position of a vector in the current and flux simplex is the same

$$\bar{i} = a_1 \bar{i}_{j1} + \dots + a_D \bar{i}_{jD}.$$

[0254] The α coefficients can be obtained similar to how space vector modulation (SVM) computes relative on-times. Then, $\bar{i}$ can be projected onto the basis of I_j

$$p_{jk} = \text{proj}_{\bar{i}_{jk}} \bar{i} = \frac{\bar{i}_{jk} \cdot \bar{i}}{\|\bar{i}_{jk}\|^2} \bar{i}_{jk},$$

[0255] and the relative length of the vector can be obtained by dividing the magnitude of the projections with the magnitude of the basis vectors

$$a_{jk} = \frac{\|p_{jk}\|}{\|\bar{i}_{jk}\|}$$

[0256] To find the flux vector $\bar{\lambda}$, we multiply a_k with the basis vectors of $\bar{\Lambda}_j$

$$\bar{\lambda} = a_1 \bar{\lambda}_{j1} + \dots + a_D \bar{\lambda}_{jD}.$$

[0257] Then, the motor flux results from shifting the origin.

[0258] This computation can be simplified using vector notation, where the bases I_j and $\bar{\Lambda}_j$ are the respective matrices

$$M_{I_j} = [\bar{i}_{j1}, \dots, \bar{i}_{jD}],$$

$$M_{\bar{\Lambda}_j} = [\bar{\lambda}_{j1}, \dots, \bar{\lambda}_{jD}]$$

and $a = [a_1, \dots, a_D]^T$. Then, $\bar{i} = M_{I_j} a$ and $\bar{\lambda} = M_{\bar{\Lambda}_j} a$ and, because the simplices are not degenerate, the bases are nonsingular, providing the linear relationship

$$M_{\bar{\Lambda}_j}^{-1} \bar{\lambda} = M_{I_j}^{-1} \bar{i},$$

which can be used to map current to flux and vice versa.

[0259] Substituting the original coordinates provides

$$M_{\bar{\Lambda}_j}^{-1} (\lambda - \lambda_{j0}) = M_{I_j}^{-1} (i - i_{j0}),$$

which results in the affine map

$$\lambda = L_j i + \psi_j$$

where $L_j = M_{\bar{\Lambda}_j} M_{I_j}^{-1}$ and $\psi_j = \lambda_{j0} - L_j i_{j0}$.

[0260] In step four of creating a PWA map (assigning coefficients to simplices), the coefficients I_j and ψ_j are assigned to their simplex I_j . Grouping all such functions produces the PWA map (magnetic model) for the motor 115 as a PM synchronous motor. Examples of differently sized regularly-gridded PWA map functions are shown in FIGS. 19A and 19B.

Magnetic Model Optimization

[0261] As noted above, while a regularly gridded set of current points may be used in step one of creating a PWA map, in some examples, an irregularly gridded set current points is used. An irregularly gridded set of current points can be selected to optimize the PWA map. For example, the irregularly gridded set of current points can be selected to minimize flux error in the PWA map (f_{PWA}) for a certain number of points. Choosing the areas to minimize the flux error in f_{PWA} , by selectively choosing current points to use (I_P), may depend on the application. The 2-Norm flux error is a metric available to measure the flux error of a PWA map to a reference magnetic model (e.g., FEA spline) at any given point. An example of the 2-Norm flux error distribution using a 13x13 regularly gridded I_P to create f_{PWA} is shown in FIG. 20. The flux error may be the highest where the flux linkage is the most non-linear.

[0262] In some examples, a similar algorithm as described above with respect to FIG. 6 is employed by the electronic controller 400 (of FIG. 4) to identify an N-point optimized irregular gridded set of current points I_P for use in generating the PWA map for the PM synchronous motor. This algorithm may select the current points I_P to reduce or minimize the maximum 2-Norm flux error. In some examples, contrast to the algorithm in FIG. 4, the first set of current points in block 605 is chosen to be four (4) current points, corresponding to four (4) flux points, to provide the minimum number of points (I_P , Δ_P) to cover the full current domain I . This minimum number of current points (four) provides a square in the dq current space). Otherwise, the process 600 may be implemented in a similar manner to generate the PWA map from the N-point optimized irregular grid.

[0263] Three areas of interest are evaluated and explored using this technique: the full current range (I), the approximate MTPA trajectory region (I_{MTPA}), and the approximate derated current region ($I_{derated}$). I represents the absolute maximum current limits. $I_{derated}$ represents the typical rated or continuous current limit, where the $\|idq\| \leq i_{rated}$ where in this case $i_{rated} = 0.75$ pu. I_{MTPA} is an area instead of a region to account for temperature variations in the PM synchronous motor parameters.

[0264] The PWA method of building a magnetic model may be evaluated by the flux error. In the following section, a PWA map (f_{PWA}) created using irregular optimized grids are evaluated. The current points used to construct the model are taken from a large pool of experimental data points, and the corresponding flux points were estimated using least squares approximation. For reference, an f_{PWA} using a regularly-gridded full current space ($I_P = I$) is also used, denoted by I^* . I^* is constructed using square grids, i.e. 2x2, 3x3, . . . 6x6, so $N=4, 9, \dots 36$. The data for this section comes from an interior PM synchronous motor IPMSM. The magnetic model is compared against a high-fidelity, spline-interpolated magnetic model, denoted as f_s , and built using many FEA data points.

[0265] The flux error in a magnetic model corresponds to an error to the state space model of the system and the torque. The 2-Norm flux error between f_{PWA} using irregular optimization algorithm, described above and with respect to FIG. 6, and f_s can be evaluated by sampling many random current points $i \in I$. The average and maximum of this error within the optimized regions for various values of N is shown in FIG. 21. Among the irregular optimized functions: the error is the smallest for the MTPA region, as this is the smallest region by area, and the error is the largest for I , as this is the largest area. It can be seen that the average and maximum error of I^* (regularly-gridded) is significantly worse, by margins of $\approx 5\text{-}10\%$ and $\approx 80\text{-}100\%$ respectively.

[0266] The error distribution in these magnetic models is not even. As an example, functions using 36-point (6x6) regularly-gridded current points (I^*) and 40-point irregularly-gridded functions (I , I_{MTPA} , $I_{derated}$) are shown in FIG. 21. The simplicial mesh I_M comprised of all simplices I_j is shown in the top row, the placement of points in I_P by the above-noted optimization algorithm for each of these functions is shown in the middle row, and the 2-Norm flux error distribution is shown in the bottom row. The 2-Norm flux error is minimized in the region of interest, which is apparent in the low flux error, especially for I_{MTPA} and $I_{derated}$.

[0267] FIG. 22 illustrates information about the three irregularly-gridded magnetic models and the regularly gridded magnetic model, each in a respective column. More particularly, in the top row, a simplicial mesh I_M comprised of all simplices I_j is illustrated for each magnetic model. The middle row illustrates placement of points in I_P by the optimization algorithm for each magnetic model. The bottom row illustrates the determined 2-Norm flux error distribution for each magnetic model. The first column is directed to the PWA map generated using regularly-gridded current points covering I ; the second column is directed to the PWA map generated using irregularly-gridded current points optimizing I ; the third column is directed to the PWA map generated using irregularly-gridded current points optimizing I_{MTPA} ; and the fourth column is directed to the PWA map generated using irregularly-gridded current points optimizing $I_{derated}$.

[0268] Accordingly, using one or more of the various techniques described herein to generate a PWA map for a PM synchronous motor, the PM synchronous motor system 1800 of FIG. 18 provides a motor controller 120 that uses a current-to-flux linkage PWA map (e.g., PWA map 1810 and/or PWA map 1815) to control the motor 115. As described, these PWA map(s) may be generated based on regularly gridded current space or based on an irregularly gridded current space. Further, these PWA map(s) generated based on irregularly gridded current space may have higher current point density in areas with nonlinear behavior, which may increase the accuracy of the map, and/or lower current point density in areas of linear behavior, which may decrease the overall size of the map (reducing memory space used to store the map on the motor controller 120 or elsewhere). These PWA map(s) also enable a more precise or accurate translation between current and flux domains, and the inversion of the related matrices. Further, the PWA map(s) also allow not just for a more accurate motor model with less points, but also the ability to optimize the—in some embodiments, irregular—points required to describe or represent a given machine for a desired accuracy or operation.

[0269] As noted above, the motor system 1800 may be used to implement one or more of the methods 300, 950, and 1700. In other words, as noted above, a PM synchronous motor may be used in conjunction with these methods 300, 950, and 1700.

[0270] For example, with reference back to the method 300 of FIG. 3 in conjunction with the system 1800 of FIG. 18, in block 305, the motor controller 120 of the system 1800 determines current values for the PM synchronous motor 115 in a rotational reference frame, such as the DQ reference frame. Each current value is associated with a dimension (or axis) of a set of dimensions of the DQ reference frame. For example, as described with respect to system 100 of FIG. 2, the motor controller 120 of the system 1800 may determine electrical operational characteristics of the motor 115 in a stationary reference frame; determine a rotational position of the motor 115 (e.g., of the rotor of the motor 115); and transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor 115 in the rotational reference frame via Clark-Park transform block 1817.

[0271] In block 310, the motor controller 120 of the system 1800 is configured to determine, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a piecewise affine map. For example, the motor controller 120 is configured to determine flux linkage values λ_{dq} using the PWA current-to-flux linkage map 1815. In some examples, as described above with respect to the system 100 of FIG. 2, the motor controller 120 of FIG. 18 may first identify on which simplex (or domain) of the PWA map 1815 the current value resides, and then use the particular affine function associated with the identified simplex to calculate the flux linkage.

[0272] In block 315, the motor controller 120 is configured to determine a target flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. For example, the motor controller 120 is configured to determine target flux linkage values λ_{dq}^* . To determine the target flux linkage values, the motor controller 120 may determine a desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*) or motor speed (not shown)) for the motor 115. The desired control parameter (e.g., motor torque (T^*) or speed) may also be referred to as a motor command, and may be provided by an input device as described above. The motor controller 120 may then, using the reference generation block 1820, transform the desired control parameter to target current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame (e.g., i_{dq}^*). For example, the motor controller 120 may use the reference generation block 1820 in the form of a lookup table (e.g., stored in the memory 130) that maps potential values for the desired control parameter T^* to the target current values. The lookup table may be populated in advance based on experimental data. The motor controller 120 may then determine, based on the target current values, the target flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the piecewise affine (PWA) map 1810. The motor controller 120 may use the PWA map 1810 to determine the target flux linkage values based on the target current values in a similar manner as the PWM map 1815 is used to determine the flux linkage values based on the current values. The two PWA maps 1810 and 1815 illustrated in FIG. 18 may be duplicate PWA maps, or the motor controller 120 may use one PWA

map for both the actual values and the target values (i.e., although two PWA maps are illustrated, in some embodiments, one shared PWA map is included instead).

[0273] In block 320, the motor controller 120 is configured to control the power switching network based on the flux linkage values and the target flux linkage values. In some embodiments, the motor controller 120 may generate control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor 115 based on a difference between the target flux linkage value and the flux linkage value for the dimension. For example, the virtual flux controller 1805 may compute the difference value, or the motor controller 120 may include a difference block, similar to the difference block 235 of FIG. 2, to determine a difference between each flux linkage value and target flux linkage value for each respective dimension of the set of dimensions of rotational reference frame (e.g., D and Q dimensions, optionally Null dimension). The motor controller 120 (e.g., via the virtual flux controller 1805) may then generate a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on the difference value and the rotational position. For example, the flux controller 240 may output voltage commands V_d and V_q (also referred to collectively as V_{dq} or u_{dq}^*).

[0274] The motor controller 120 may then transform the voltage commands from the rotational reference frame to the stationary reference frame. For example, the motor controller 120, using the inverse Clark-Park transform block 1845, may perform an inverse Clark-Park transform on the voltage commands V_{dq} to generate voltage commands V_a , V_b , and V_c (also referred to collectively as V_{abc}) in the stationary reference frame. The motor controller 120 may then, using PWM generation block 1850, in a similar manner as the PWM generation block 250 of FIG. 2, to generate a pulse width modulated control signal for each dimension of the stationary reference frame to control the power switching network 205 to drive a stator of the motor.

[0275] When in a motor operational mode, based on the control signals, the motor drive circuit 110 is controlled to apply power from the power supply 105 to the motor 115 to drive rotation of the motor 115. Similarly, when in a generator operational mode, based on the control signals, the motor drive circuit 110 is controlled to apply electric power from the motor 115 to the power supply 105 (e.g., to charge the power supply) and/or to another electrical load.

[0276] As noted above, the motor system 1800 may also be used to implement the method 950. With respect to the method 950 of FIG. 9B, in conjunction with FIG. 18, in block 955, the motor controller 120 of the system 1800 determines current values for the PM synchronous motor 115 in a rotational reference frame, such as the DQ reference frame. The motor controller 120 of FIG. 18 may perform this block 955 in a similar manner as the motor controller 120 of FIG. 18 performs block 305 of FIG. 3.

[0277] In block 960, the motor controller 120 of FIG. 18 determines, based on a desired control parameter (e.g., a desired motor torque value (T^*)), a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map. The motor controller 120 may then apply the MTPA function block 1820, implementing a PWA map, to the desired control parameter. In some examples of the system 1800 of FIG. 18 implementing the process 950, the MPLPT function block 905 of FIG. 9A (described above)

may serve in place of the MTPA function block **1820**, albeit modified to output target current values in the DQ reference frame (i_{dq}^*), without a rotor field target current i_r^* . As described above, the MPLPT function block **905** may implement a PWA map, and translating an input desired control parameter to target motor control parameter value using the PWA map may be performed in a similar manner as described above with respect to FIGS. 9A-9B. In some examples, the output current value of the MPLPT function block **905** or MTPA function block **1820**, as the case may be, is an intermediate target motor control parameter value that is then further translated to a (final) target motor control parameter value by the current-to-flux linkage map **1810**. In other examples, such as where the controller **1805** of FIG. **18** is a current-based controller rather than a flux-based controller, or where the MPLPT function block **905** or MTPA function block **1820** is configured to map reference torque (T^*) directly to a target flux value (λ^*), the output current value of the MPLPT function block **905** or MTPA function block **1820** is the (final) target motor control parameter value.

[0278] In block **965**, the motor controller **120** of the system **1800** controls the power switching network based on the current values (e.g., received directly or after translation to flux values via flux linkage map **1815**) and the target motor control parameter values (e.g., received directly or after translation to target flux values via flux linkage map **1820**). The motor controller **120** of FIG. **18** may then perform this block **965** in a similar manner as the motor controller **120** of FIG. **18** performs block **320** of FIG. **3**, based on the received values (e.g., λ_{dq} , λ_{dq}^* , θ or $\lambda_{dq}-\lambda_{dq}^*$ and θ), and outputting voltage commands to inverse Clark-Park transform block **1845**.

[0279] As noted above, the motor system **1800** may also be used to implement the method **170**. With respect to the method **1700** of FIG. **17**, in conjunction with FIG. **18**, in block **1705**, the motor controller **120** of the system **1800** determines current values for the PM synchronous motor **115** in a rotational reference frame, such as the DQ reference frame. The motor controller **120** of FIG. **18** may perform this block **1705** in a similar manner as the motor controller **120** of FIG. **16** performs block **1710** of FIG. **17** performs block **305** of FIG. **3**.

[0280] In block **1710**, the motor controller **120** determines, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame. The motor controller **120** of FIG. **18** may perform this block **1710** in a similar manner as the motor controller **120** of FIG. **16** performs block **1710** of FIG. **17**. For example, the motor controller **120** of FIG. **18** may receive the desired control parameter (e.g., T^*) and translate the desired control parameter to target motor control parameter values (e.g., λ_{dq}^*) via blocks **1810** and **1820**.

[0281] In block **1715**, the motor controller **120** controls the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values by using a piecewise affine map that was defined by offline solving of a model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs. For example, in some scenarios, the virtual flux controller **1805** implements a model predictive control (MPC) algorithm to generate the control signals (e.g., voltage commands (V_{dq})), based on the received or determined difference values (e.g., $\lambda^*-\lambda$) and the rotational position of the motor (θ). The controls are based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values at least because the

MPC controller **1805** generates the controls based on the flux values (λ), which was determined based on the current values (e.g., i_{abc} , i_{dq}) and based on the target flux values (λ^*) (a target motor control parameter value).

[0282] The MPC algorithm includes an MPC optimization problem or equation, as described in further detail in below with respect to PM synchronous motor implementation. In some examples, the MPC controller **1605** implements “explicit MPC.” In such examples, in advance of execution of the process **1700**, the MPC optimization problem is solved offline and a control law is generated therefrom and stored on the MPC controller **1805**. Then, in block **1715**, during real-time operation of the motor **115**, the control law is accessed and implemented to control the motor **115**. For example, the MPC optimization problem (e.g., described below) is solved for all or a subset of possible inputs offline, which is then used to generate a piecewise affine map (an “MPC PWA map”) that is stored on the controller **120** (e.g., as part of the MPC controller **1805**) in advance of motor operation. The MPC PWA map defines a plurality of domains, each with an associated control law. In real time during operation of the motor, the MPC controller **1805** receives measurements (e.g., the received difference values and the rotational position of the motor (θ)), which dictates which domain of the MPC PWA is active. The MPC controller **1805** thus identifies the active domain and the feedback control law associated with the active domain. The MPC controller **1805** then generates control signals (e.g., voltage commands (V_{dq})) using the identified control law.

MPC Controller for PM Synchronous Motor Using PWA Map(s)

[0283] In some examples of the PM synchronous motor system **1800**, which may use one or more current-to-flux linkage PWA maps generated for the PM synchronous motor as described above, the virtual flux controller **1805** is implemented as an MPC controller. In such cases, the virtual flux controller **1805** may be referred to as the virtual flux MPC (VF-MPC) controller **1805**. The VF-MPC controller **1805** may use the outputs of one or both of the above-described current-to-flux linkage PWA maps **1810**, **1815**, and may implement model predictive control (MPC) to these outputs to ultimately generate control signals for controlling the motor **115**. At least in some examples, use of MPC-based control by the VF-MPC controller **1805** to control a PM synchronous motor (e.g., motor **115**) and using current-to-flux PWA maps results in a reduction of flux and torque error (e.g., by an order of magnitude) throughout full machine operation.

[0284] In general, MPC is a control method for PM synchronous motors that provides multi-input and multi-output capabilities, an ability to handle nonlinear systems, desired stability properties, and capability for real-time application in microcontrollers (MCUs). As discussed above with respect to WFS motors, MPC solves a constrained finite time optimal control (CFTOC) problem at every control step. In electric motors, MPC implementations may be direct-torque control (MP-DTC), and direct-speed control (MP-DSC), current control, and voltage control.

[0285] The CFTOC problem can be solved and an actuation action applied every control cycle via a modulation scheme such as Space Vector Modulation (SVM) or Pulse Width Modulation (PWM). This technique is called Convex Control Set MPC (CCS-MPC). Conversely, an actuation

step may be applied only when certain criteria are met, i.e., the error exceeds a certain amount. This technique is called Finite Control Set MPC (FCS-MPC). CCS-MPC is asymptotically stable while FCS-MPC can be shown to be set stable (error bounded).

[0286] Non-linear flux-linkage that arises from saturation and cross-saturation effects, due to a state space model becoming nonlinear, can lead to an MPC controller with inefficient operation of a PM synchronous motor at full-power. Virtual flux MPC (VF-MPC) of PM synchronous motors is a control method that uses the flux of the motor as the state variable, utilizing a current-to-flux transform and the $\alpha\beta$ transform on flux to create a sinusoidal tracking MPC problem, or flux error to create an MPC regulation problem. The separation of the magnetic model $f(i)$ from the control allows for more advanced and accurate magnetic models to be used, such as piecewise affine (PWA) magnetic models as described above. PWA magnetic models (MMs) share many of the same advantageous properties as linearized maps, including linearity, bidirectionality, and continuity, and additionally can capture saturation and cross saturation effects. These advantages translate to efficiency gains, as the controller is able to more accurately bring the motor to the desired reference point (by MTPA or flux weakening), otherwise having a steady-state offset. Offline MMs may be built using machine datapoints from analytical calculations, FEA analysis, and experimentation (or a combination thereof), and may be interpolated via linear interpolation, Hermite spline interpolation, polynomials, and/or piecewise nonlinear. Relative to online parameter estimation methods, use of offline PWA MMs can reduce the computation load for an MPC controller.

[0287] In some examples of the system **1800** provided herein, the MPC controller **1805** is a VF-MP-DTC controller that uses an offline PWA MM to control a PM synchronous motor (e.g., the motor **115**). Generation of offline PWA MM models for a PM synchronous motor, including regularly gridded and irregularly gridded PWA maps, is described above in further detail. In other examples, the MM may be a linear model, which may be less accurate than a PWA MM model as described. The linear model, such as nameplate magnetic models or optimized linear magnetic models, may have the form

$$\lambda_{dq} = L i_{dq} + \psi_{PM}$$

where

$$L = \begin{bmatrix} L_d & 0 \\ 0 & L_q \end{bmatrix}, \psi_{PM} = \begin{bmatrix} \psi_d \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

[0288] By this definition, the mutual flux of the machine is neglected (non-diagonal terms of L) and the small but non-negligible (in saturation) ψ_q is also neglected. The map $f(i)$ is approximated as a plane, i.e., convex, when in reality $f(i)$ is non-convex and L and ψ_{PM} can change by large margins throughout $i \in I_P$.

[0289] In some examples involving MPC control, the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame may be used instead of the dq reference frame because, in the $\alpha\beta$ reference frame, the state equation has no dependence on speed ω and is linear. Accordingly, while the PM synchronous motor model described above

still applies, an $\alpha\beta$ dynamic model for the PM synchronous motor may be modeled by the discrete first order ordinary differential equation

$$\lambda_{\alpha\beta}^+ = \lambda_{\alpha\beta} + T_s v_{\alpha\beta}$$

where $v_{\alpha\beta}$ is the compensated voltage $v_{\alpha\beta} = v_{\alpha\beta,terminal} - R_s i_{\alpha\beta}$, and the $^+$ superscript indicates next step. All terms can be normalized by the constant $\Lambda_{const} = T_s V_c$ to be

$$\bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta}^+ = \bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta} + \bar{v}_{\alpha\beta}$$

where the “-” superscript indicates compensated (voltage) or normalized (flux).

[0290] The torque of the a PMSM is the cross product of the current and the flux multiplied by pole pairs and a constant

$$T = \frac{3}{2} p i_{dq}' J \lambda_{dq}$$

where J is the cross-coupling matrix

$$J = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

[0291] The state space system for the PM synchronous motor system **1800** may be modelled as a regulation problem instead of a sinusoidal tracking problem by using the state vector

$$x = \bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta} - \bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta}^*$$

and the input can be the voltage

$$u = \bar{v}_{\alpha\beta} - \bar{u}$$

where

$$\bar{u} = -(\bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta} - \bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta}^*)$$

[0292] In this way, the state space equation becomes

$$x^+ = x + \bar{u},$$

and $\bar{v}_{\alpha\beta}$ is the sum of u (feedback controller) and $\bar{u}$ (feed-forward controller).

[0293] Turning to constraints, the current limits of a machine may be defined by a continuous current and maximum current. The continuous current represents the current that the machine can run at steady state for a prolonged period of time and is limited by the thermal effects of copper loss $i^2 R_s$,

$$\mathcal{J}_{\text{cont}} = \{i_{dq} \in \mathbb{R}^2 | i_{dq} \leq \|i_{dqr}\|\},$$

and traces a circle or ellipse in the dq current plane. i_{dqr} is the rated current value in the dq plane. The maximum current is the maximum current that the machine can handle in transient operation, i.e., for short periods of time,

$$\mathcal{J}_{\text{max}} = \{i_{dq} \in \mathbb{R}^2 | i_{dq} = i_{dqr}\},$$

and traces a square or rectangle in the dq current plane. The rated current may be set to the maximum current ($\mathcal{J}_r = \mathcal{J}_{\text{max}}$).

[0294] The rated flux set Λ_r is any flux that when mapped back to current using the inverted magnetic model $i_{dq} = g(\lambda_{dq})$ is in the rated current set:

$$\Lambda_r = \{\lambda_{dq} \in \mathbb{R}^2 | g(\lambda_{dq}) \in \mathcal{J}_r\}.$$

[0295] If $f(i_{dq})$ is fully linear, Λ_r may be a rectangle, but with saturation effects included, Λ_r may be a bulged rectangle in the dq current plane. The rated flux value, λ_{dqr} , may be defined to be the flux at the intersection point of the MTPA trajectory with the rated current set.

[0296] The voltage constraint in this problem can either be CCS constrained by V_s or FCS constrained by V_d depending on the MPC implementation. The FCS voltage constraint V_s is limited to the six discrete states of the voltage source inverter (VSI) in the $\alpha\beta$ frame

$$\mathcal{V}_s = C \circ \{0, 1\}^3 = \{v_{000}, v_{100}, \dots, v_{111}\},$$

[0297] While the CS voltage constraint V_d can be any interior point of the six states in the $\alpha\beta$ frame, or convex hull H of $\mathcal{V}_s$, where $V_d = H(\mathcal{V}_s)$.

Model Predictive Control for PM Synchronous Motor

[0298] Model Predictive Control (MPC) or Receding Horizon Control (RHC) is a control method that solves a constrained finite time optimal control (CFTOC) problem to compute an optimal trajectory of states and inputs length N (prediction horizon) control cycles in the future, and then implements the first input. In this problem, the state is the flux error $x = \bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta} - \bar{\lambda}_{\alpha\beta}^*$, the input is the compensated voltage $u = \bar{v}_{\alpha\beta} - \bar{u}$, and the state space model is $x^+ = x + \bar{u}$. The state being measured or estimated is x_0 and the desired state is x_N , the CFTOC output is a set of control inputs of length N denoted $U_{0 \rightarrow N}$, and the corresponding set of states is denoted $X_{0 \rightarrow N}$,

$$\mathcal{U}_{0 \rightarrow N} = \{u_0, \dots, u_{N-1}\}, \mathcal{X}_{0 \rightarrow N} = \{x_0, \dots, x_{N-1}\},$$

which, when implemented, will bring the state to a terminal region $x \in X_f$ defined by

$$X_f = x^* + \epsilon, \epsilon \in \mathbb{R}^2$$

[0299] This is a regulation problem, so the desired state is $x^* = 0$.

[0300] A cost function $J_0(x_0, u_0)$ assigns a cost to a trajectory of states and inputs beginning at (x_0, u_0) with length N by

$$J_0(x_0, u_0) \triangleq x_N, P x_N + \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} (x' Q x + u' R$$

where P defines the terminal cost quantity and penalizes how close the final state is to 0, Q defines the stage cost quantity and penalizes the sum of change in state, and R penalizes the sum of change in voltage (minimizing switching losses in FCS-MPC). The a and B components of x and u should be penalized equally, thus $P=Q=R \triangleq I$.

[0301] The optimization problem is

$$J_0^*(x) = \min_{\mathcal{U}_{0 \rightarrow N}} J_0(x_0, \mathcal{U}_{0 \rightarrow N}),$$

$$\text{subj. to } x_{k+1} = x_k + u_k$$

$$\lambda_k \in \Lambda_r, \bar{v}_k \in \mathcal{V}_s$$

$$x_N \in X_f,$$

[0302] where $k=\{0, \dots, N-1\}$, where the cost $J_0^*(x)$ minimization is subject to the three listed constraints. The first constraint constrains the states to obey the state equation, the second constraint constrains the flux to machine rated flux and the compensated voltage to the CCS voltage constraint (replace with V_d when using FCS-MPC), and the third constraint constrains the final state to the terminal region. The solution to the optimization problem is a set of optimal inputs $U_{0 \rightarrow N}^*$, and states $X_{0 \rightarrow N}^*$ with cost $J_0^*(x)$. The first solution of the trajectory is the input to the system, and at the next sampling period, the CFOTC problem is re-solved and first input of the new trajectory is the input to the system.

[0303] In testing, four magnetic models, two linear and two PWA, were evaluated offline to estimate the flux error of each model with MPC based control, such as may be implemented by the MPC controller **1805**. The MPC regulation controller, such as described herein, was formulated utilizing a cost function and prediction horizon in the $\alpha\beta$ frame. The PWA magnetic models proved to decrease flux and torque error in steady state experiments ($T=0.8$ p.u., $\omega=1.3$ p.u.) and transient experiments ($\omega=3$ p.u. speed step, $T=1$ p.u. torque step) by an order of magnitude consistently compared to the linear MMs.

Additional Dimensions

[0304] In several examples discussed herein, a PWA map, such as the PWA maps **220** or **225**, maps motor current to flux. In some further examples, such PWA maps incorporate additional dimensions corresponding to additional motor characteristics, for example, rotor rotational speed (ω), rotor rotational acceleration, motor temperature, or the like. For example, the PWA map **220** (and/or another of the disclosed current-to-flux PWA maps) may receive as input a motor current (e.g., $i_{f,dq}$) as well as one or more other motor characteristics (e.g., rotor rotational speed, position, or acceleration, motor temperature, or the like) as additional dimensions. The one or more other motor characteristics may be determined by the motor controller **120**, for example, by direct sensing via an associated sensor, or indirectly by calculating or inferring based on another sensed motor characteristics. The PWA map may map or

correspond the inputs to a flux (e.g., $\lambda_{f,dq}$) that is output by the PWA map. That is, the PWA map may map a set of input values to an output flux linkage value for each dimension of a rotational reference frame, where the set of input values includes the current values (e.g., $i_{f,dq}$) and at least one additional motor characteristic (e.g., rotor rotational speed, rotor rotational acceleration, motor temperature, or the like).

[0305] More specifically, as previously discussed above, the PWA map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains. To obtain a flux linkage from a set of inputs to the PWA map, a controller (e.g., the motor controller **120**) may identify a first domain corresponding to the set of inputs and selected from the plurality of domains. The first domain is associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions. Then, the controller may apply the set of inputs (i.e., the current values and one or more additional motor characteristics) to the first affine function to determine the flux linkage value for each dimension of the rotational reference frame. In some examples, each of the plurality of domains associated with respective affine functions corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of input-output pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor. Here, the input of each input-output pair includes, for an operational point of the motor, current values and the one or more additional motor characteristics, and the output includes the corresponding flux linkage value.

[0306] As another example, rotor position (θ) may be an additional motor characteristic corresponding to an additional dimension of the PWA map. For example, the relationship between flux linkage, inductance, current, and/or torque may be relevant for a desired motor operating characteristic, e.g., slot-passing effects, which introduce torque ripple and variations in BEMF when in motion. In a PMSM, there may be two degrees of freedom for a given datapoint of five variables: i_d , i_q , λ_d , λ_q , and torque. By specifying any two variables, the other three variables may be uniquely determined by the physics-based relationship, commonly modeled through FEA. To incorporate position, each datapoint now has six variables, θ , i_d , i_q , λ_d , λ_q , and torque, where three independent parameters are known or specified, with the remaining three variables uniquely determined by the physics-based relationship. Other quantities can be included in the dataset, for example efficiency, conduction loss, etc., but these other quantities may either derived from these existing quantities, or deemed negligible for the controls or modeling problem statement.

[0307] In some examples, motor speed (ω) may be beneficial as an additional motor characteristic corresponding to an additional dimension because other system losses may be a function of speed (ω) and may influence which combination of winding currents and flux linkages result in the most desirable operating state, e.g., efficiency. In such a case, the complete operating point may be specified by the eight-dimensional point ω , i_d , i_q , λ_d , λ_q , torque, $p_{loss\ core}$, $p_{loss\ conduction}$, but the operating point is uniquely identified or specified by any three variables, with the other five variables being constrained by the physics-based relationship and/or synthetic metric that forms the desired figure-of-merit.

[0308] In some examples involving a wound-field machine with a single-phase rotor, relative to the above

PMSM examples, one additional degree of freedom is introduced, but two additional parameters come with that degree of freedom: i_r and λ_r .

[0309] By including the additional dimensions in the PWA map, in addition to current, the PWA map may have an improved accuracy. In other words, in this example, the flux output by the PWA map may be a more accurate representation of the actual flux of the motor **115**. In contrast to other techniques, additional dimensions can be added to the PWA map technique without increasing the computational complexity to the point of being impractical. That is, the PWA map may incorporate additional dimensions and still be practicably implemented on a motor controller having typical processing and memory resources. Additionally, in some further examples, the disclosed PWA maps that map motor flux to current are modified to similarly include one or more additional dimensions (e.g., one or more additional motor characteristics) to increase the accuracy of the current output by the PWA maps.

[0310] As should be understood from the discussion throughout the present disclosure, although some embodiments include an MPC controller (e.g., MPC controller **1605**) implementing model predictive control, some embodiments use other flux, current, or model-based controllers as part of the motor controller **120**. That is, the PWA maps described herein may be used with any flux, current, or model-based controller (or control method). Use of the PWA maps may, for example, reduce space, increase accuracy of the motor or plant model, and/or increase performance of the controller (e.g., better dynamics, reduced error, better reference generation, etc.). Examples of such flux, current, or model-based controllers include the MPC controller, PID controller, any model-based controllers that use a lookup table of currents, and the like. The related calculations for the PWA maps may be performed online or offline.

[0311] As also should be understood from the discussion throughout the present disclosure, various features from any of the disclosed motor systems and methods may be included in other ones of the disclosed motor systems and methods. For example, the motor system **100** of FIG. 1 may include the motor **115** in the form of any of a WFS motor, PM synchronous motor, hybrid synchronous motor, universal motor, induction motor, reluctance motor (synchronous or switched), or another motor type, and the motor controller **120** may further include or implement any combination of current-to-flux PWA maps (e.g., similar to maps **220**, **225**, **1610**, **1615**, **1810**, or **1815**), current-to-inductance PWA maps (e.g., similar to map **2320**), MPLPT or MTPA reference generation (e.g., similar to blocks **905** or **1820**), and/or MPC flux controllers (e.g., similar to MPC flux controller **1605** or **1805**).

[0312] The underlying models for WFS motors and PM synchronous motors were described above, and the WFS motor model may also apply to the hybrid synchronous motor. Similar models may be used to describe or define other types of motors (e.g., universal motors, induction motors, reluctance motors (synchronous and switched), etc.), updated for the particulars of each motor type. These models may be used to generate, in similar ways as described above, one or more of: the current-to-flux PWA maps (e.g., similar to maps **220**, **225**, **1610**, **1615**, **1810**, or **1815**), MPLPT or MTPA reference generation maps (e.g., similar to blocks **905** or **1820**), and/or MPC flux controllers

(e.g., similar to MPC flux controller **1605** or **1805**) for use in operation with such other types of motors. For example, a universal motor model can include: stator d-axis current, stator q-axis current, stator z-axis current (in the case of a star connection), rotor d-axis winding current (in the case of wound rotor machines and externally fed induction machines), rotor q-axis winding current (in the case of externally fed induction machines), rotor d-axis damper winding (in the case of squirrel cage induction machines and line start machines), rotor q-axis damper winding (in the case of squirrel cage induction machines and line start machines), and stator x-y-axis (in the case of multiphase machines, the machines have may have additional x-y axes depending on number of phases). Additionally, every current dimension can have a related flux and voltage. In general, the d-axis is aligned with the magnetic axis of the magnetic field. Stated another way, a universal motor model may include a D-axis, Q-axis, and Null-axis for all independent bodies within the system, each in electromagnetic communication through the D-axis, and the capability to contribute to torque via the Q-axis. Changes to the D-axis on one component results (A) in a change in stored electromagnetic energy that can be sensed/influenced on the D-axis of another component and (B) influences the torque that can be generated in the system. Changes to the Q-axis on one component results in a torque, but does not result to a change in magnetic field energy that can be detected/influenced by the other system components. Changes in the Null-axis are in the “null space” of the DQnull system: they do not influence common magnetic field energy or torque resulting from that field. Within this “null space”, one or more other DQnull systems may exist. Damper bars are one such example: they have a current, and resulting magnetic field, that is not directly sensed by the main rotor or stator winding system, but which results in a counter-torque to eliminate ripple in the net torque that arises from slot-passing effects of the main RDQ currents/field.

[0313] In some examples, the motor controller **120**, in any of its various configurations described herein (see, e.g., FIG. 2, 9A, 16, 18, or 23) is implemented as a set of instructions stored on a nontransitory computer readable medium, where the instructions are for execution by a processor. Further, the processor may be configured to (or may be connected to another device configured to) simulate a motor, power supply, and power switching network (simulating an arrangement similar to, for example, the arrangement in FIG. 2, 9A, 16, 18, or 23). Accordingly, the processor, through execution of the set of instructions, may be configured to monitor and control a motor where the motor is a simulated motor coupled to a simulated power supply via a simulated power switching network.

[0314] Although particular embodiments have been disclosed herein in detail, this has been done by way of example for purposes of illustration only, and is not intended to be limiting with respect to the scope of the appended claims, which follow. Features of the disclosed embodiments can be combined, rearranged, etc., within the scope of the invention to produce more embodiments. Some other aspects, advantages, and modifications are considered to be within the scope of the claims provided below. The claims presented are representative of at least some of the embodiments and features disclosed herein. Other unclaimed embodiments and features are also contemplated.

Further Examples Having a Variety of Features:

[0315] The disclosure may be further understood by way of the following examples:

[0316] Example 1: A method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium for motor control comprises: determining, by an electronic controller, current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage or inductance value for each of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a piecewise affine map; determining, by the electronic controller, a target value for each of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and controlling, by the electronic controller, a power switching network coupled between a power supply and the motor based on the flux linkage or inductance values and the target values.

[0317] Example 2: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 1, wherein determining current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame includes: determining electrical operational characteristics of the motor in a stationary reference frame; determining a rotational position of the motor; and transforming the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame.

[0318] Example 3: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 2, wherein the piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains, and wherein determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage or inductance value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a piecewise affine map includes: identifying a first domain corresponding to the current values and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions; and applying the current values to the first affine function to determine the flux linkage or inductance value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

[0319] Example 4: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 3, wherein each of the plurality of domains corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of current and flux-linkage pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor, or each of the plurality of domains corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of current and inductance pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor.

[0320] Example 5: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 4, wherein determining a target value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame includes: determining a desired control parameter for the motor; transforming the desired control parameter to target current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame; and determining, based on the target current values, the target value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the piecewise affine map.

[0321] Example 6: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 5, wherein transforming the desired control parameter to the target current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame includes: determining, based on the desired control parameter, a target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a control parameter-to-current piecewise affine map.

[0322] Example 7: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 6, wherein the control parameter-to-current piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains, and wherein determining, based on the desired control parameter, a target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a control parameter-to-current piecewise affine map includes: identifying a first domain corresponding to the desired control parameter and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions; and applying the desired control parameter to the first affine function to determine the target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

[0323] Example 8: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 5 to 7, wherein the desired control parameter is a target torque value for the motor.

[0324] Example 9: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 8, wherein determining a target value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame includes: determining a desired control parameter for the motor; transforming the desired control parameter to target current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame using a control parameter-to-current piecewise affine map, the target current values including a target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and determining, based on the target current values, the target value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

[0325] Example 10: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 9, wherein determining a target value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame includes: determining a desired control parameter for the motor; and transforming the desired control parameter to target values for the motor in the rotational reference frame using a control parameter-to-flux linkage piecewise affine map, the target values including a target flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

[0326] Example 11: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 10, wherein the determining, based on the current values, the flux linkage or inductance value for each dimension of the set of dimensions includes determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions; wherein the target values are target flux linkage values; and wherein controlling the power switching network based on the flux linkage values and the target flux linkage values includes: generating a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions

of the rotational reference frame based on a difference between the target flux linkage value and the flux linkage value for the dimension; transforming the voltage commands in the rotational reference frame to the stationary reference frame; generating a pulse width modulated control signal for each dimension of the stationary reference frame to control the power switching network to drive a stator of the motor; and generating a rotor control signal to control driving of a rotor field winding.

[0327] Example 12: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 11, wherein the determining, based on the current values, the flux linkage or inductance value for each dimension of the set of dimensions includes determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions; wherein the target values are target flux linkage values; and wherein controlling the power switching network based on the flux linkage values and the target flux linkage values includes: generating control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor based on a difference between the target flux linkage value and the flux linkage value for the dimension.

[0328] Example 13: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 12, wherein controlling the power switching network based on the flux linkage or inductance values and the target flux linkage values includes: generating, based on a model predictive control algorithm, control signals to drive the motor based on the target values and the flux linkage or inductance values.

[0329] Example 14: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 13, wherein generating the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm includes solving linear state-space equations over a receding time window to select a next control parameter.

[0330] Example 15: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 14, wherein generating the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm includes accessing a second piecewise affine map defined by offline solving of the model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs.

[0331] Example 16: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 15, wherein the motor is a wound field synchronous motor comprising at least three stator phases and at least one rotor field winding.

[0332] Example 17: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 16, wherein the power switching network includes an inverter switch bridge including a plurality of power switching elements, the inverter switch bridge receiving DC power and outputting AC power to windings of the stator based on pulse width modulated control signals from the electronic controller.

[0333] Example 18: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 17, further comprising: receiving, by a DC/DC converter, input DC power; and providing, by the DC/DC converter, output DC power to at least one rotor field winding in accordance with a pulse width modulated rotor control signal from the electronic controller.

[0334] Example 19: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 18, wherein the piecewise affine map maps a set of input values to an output flux linkage or inductance value for each dimension of the set of dimensions, the set of input values including the current values and at least one additional motor characteristic.

[0335] Example 20: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 19, wherein the motor is at least one selected from the group of a wound field synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, a permanent magnet synchronous motor, an induction motor, a universal motor, or a reluctance motor.

[0336] Example 21: A method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium comprises: obtaining, by an electronic controller, a data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of an electric motor; applying, by the electronic controller, a domain decomposition algorithm to the data set to generate current simplices and flux linkage simplices; and storing, by the electronic controller, the current simplices and flux linkage simplices in a memory.

[0337] Example 22: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 21, further comprising: generating a current-to-flux linkage map, using the current simplices and the flux linkage simplices, to map current values of the current simplices to respective flux linkage values of the flux linkage simplices to provide a one-to-one relationship between the current values and the flux linkage values.

[0338] Example 23: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 22, further comprising: transmitting the current-to-flux linkage map to a motor controller including an electronic processor and an electronic memory.

[0339] Example 24: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 22 to 23, wherein the current-to-flux linkage map is at least one selected from the group of: a piecewise affine map including a plurality of linear functions, each linear function corresponding to respective current simplices of the current simplices, and a quadratic map including at least one quadratic function.

[0340] Example 25: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 22 to 24, further comprising: generating a flux linkage-to-current map, using the current simplices and the flux linkage simplices, to map flux linkage values of the flux linkage simplices to respective current values of the current simplices to provide a one-to-one relationship between the flux linkage values and the current values, wherein the flux linkage-to-current map is an inverse of the current-to-flux linkage map.

[0341] Example 27: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 22 to 26, further comprising: determining an error value for each of a plurality of points of the current-to-flux linkage map; selecting a point from the plurality of points based on the determined error values; adding the point to the data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of the electric motor to generate an updated data set; applying the domain decomposition algorithm to the updated data set to generate an updated set of current simplices and an updated set of flux linkage simplices; and generating an

updated current-to-flux linkage map, using the updated set of current simplices and the updated set of flux linkage simplices, to map current values of the updated set of current simplices to respective flux linkage values of the updated set of flux linkage simplices to provide a one-to-one relationship between the current values and the flux linkage values.

[0342] Example 28: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 22 to 27, further comprising: determining an error value for each of a plurality of points of the current-to-flux linkage map; selecting a point from the plurality of points based on the determined error values; removing the point to the data set of current-flux linkage pairs for operational points of the electric motor to generate an updated data set; applying the domain decomposition algorithm to the updated data set to generate an updated set of current simplices and an updated set of flux linkage simplices; and generating an updated current-to-flux linkage map, using the updated set of current simplices and the updated set of flux linkage simplices, to map current values of the updated set of current simplices to respective flux linkage values of the updated set of flux linkage simplices to provide a one-to-one relationship between the current values and the flux linkage values.

[0343] Example 29: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 22 to 28, wherein the electric motor is at least one selected from the group of a wound field synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, a permanent magnet synchronous motor, an induction motor, a universal motor, or a reluctance motor.

[0344] Example 30: A method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium for motor control comprises: determining, by an electronic controller, current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determining, by the electronic controller and based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map; and controlling, by the electronic controller, a power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values.

[0345] Example 31: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 30, wherein determining current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame includes: determining electrical operational characteristics of the motor in a stationary reference frame; determining a rotational position of the motor; and transforming the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame.

[0346] Example 32: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 32, further comprising: determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a second piecewise affine map, wherein the second piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains; wherein determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the

rotational reference frame using a second piecewise affine map includes: identifying a first domain corresponding to the current values and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions, and applying the current values to the first affine function to determine the flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values includes controlling the power switching network based on the flux linkage values determined from the current values using the second piecewise affine map.

[0347] Example 33: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 32, wherein each of the plurality of domains corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of current and flux-linkage pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor.

[0348] Example 34: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 33, wherein the first piecewise affine map is a control parameter-to-target motor control parameter piecewise affine map.

[0349] Example 35: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Example 34, wherein the target motor control parameter values are current values or flux linkage values.

[0350] Example 36: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Example 35, wherein the first piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains, and wherein determining, based on the desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map includes: identifying a first domain corresponding to the desired control parameter and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions; and applying the desired control parameter to the first affine function to determine the target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

[0351] Example 37: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Example 35, wherein the desired control parameter is a target torque value for the motor.

[0352] Example 38: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 37, wherein the first piecewise affine map is generated based on: a subset of pareto-optimal frontier points defining a convex pareto frontier, the pareto-optimal frontier points being a subset of datapoints including a current component, a flux component, a torque component, and a power loss component.

[0353] Example 39: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 38, wherein the first piecewise affine map is a torque-to-current linkage piecewise affine map, and wherein determining, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the first piecewise affine map includes: using the torque-to-

current piecewise affine map to translate a desired torque to a target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and using a current-to-flux linkage piecewise affine map to translate the target current values to the target motor control parameter values, where the target motor control parameter values are flux linkage values.

[0354] Example 40: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 39, wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values includes: generating a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on a difference between the target motor control parameter value and a motor parameter indicated by the current value for the dimension; transforming the voltage commands in the rotational reference frame to the stationary reference frame; generating a pulse width modulated control signal for each dimension of the stationary reference frame to control the power switching network to drive a stator of the motor; and generating a rotor control signal to control driving of a rotor field winding.

[0355] Example 41: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 40, wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values includes: generating control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor based on a difference between the target motor control parameter value and a motor parameter indicated by the current value for the dimension.

[0356] Example 42: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 41, wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values includes: generating, based on a model predictive control algorithm, control signals to drive the motor based on the target motor control parameter values and the current values.

[0357] Example 43: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 42, wherein generating the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm includes solving linear state-space equations over a receding time window to select a next control parameter.

[0358] Example 44: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 42, wherein generating the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm includes accessing a second piecewise affine map defined by offline solving of the model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs.

[0359] Example 45: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 44, wherein the motor is a wound field synchronous motor comprising at least three stator phases and at least one rotor field winding.

[0360] Example 46: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 45, wherein the power switching network includes an inverter switch bridge including a plurality of power switching elements, the inverter switch bridge configured to receive DC power and output AC power to windings of the stator based on pulse width modulated control signals from the electronic controller.

[0361] Example 47: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 46, further comprising: receiving, by a DC/DC converter, input DC power; and providing, by the DC/DC converter, output DC power to at least one rotor field winding in accordance with a pulse width modulated rotor control signal from the electronic controller.

[0362] Example 48: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 30 to 47, wherein the motor is at least one selected from the group of a wound field synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, a permanent magnet synchronous motor, an induction motor, a universal motor, or a reluctance motor.

[0363] Example 49: A method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium for motor control comprises: determining, by an electronic controller, current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; determining, by the electronic controller and based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and controlling, by the electronic controller, a power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values by using a piecewise affine map that was defined by offline solving of a model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs.

[0364] Example 50: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 43, further comprising determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a flux linkage piecewise affine map, wherein the controlling, by the electronic controller, the power switching network is further based on the flux linkage values.

[0365] Example 51: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 49 to 50, wherein the piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains, and wherein controlling, by the electronic controller, the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values by using a piecewise affine map, includes: identifying a first domain corresponding to flux values identified based on the current values and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions; and applying the flux values to the first affine function to determine a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

[0366] Example 52: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 49 to 51, wherein the flux linkage piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains, and wherein determining, by the electronic controller and based on the current values, the flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the flux linkage piecewise affine map, includes: identifying a first domain corresponding to the current values and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated

with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions; and applying the current values to the first affine function to determine the flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

[0367] Example 53: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 52, wherein each of the plurality of domains corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of current and flux-linkage pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor.

[0368] Example 54: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 49 to 53, wherein determining, based on the desired control parameter, the target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame, includes using a control parameter-to-current piecewise affine map or a control parameter-to-flux linkage piecewise affine map.

[0369] Example 55: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to Example 54, wherein the control parameter-to-current piecewise affine map or the control parameter-to-flux linkage piecewise affine map defines a minimum power loss per torque (MPLPT) function.

[0370] Example 56: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 49 to 55, wherein the constrained finite time optimal control is a model predictive control algorithm that, for each of a plurality of sampling time periods, provides a minimal-cost path from a start state to an end state.

[0371] Example 57: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 49 to 56, wherein the motor is at least one selected from the group of a wound field synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, a permanent magnet synchronous motor, an induction motor, a universal motor, or a reluctance motor.

[0372] Example 58: The method, apparatus, and non-transitory computer-readable medium according to any of Examples 1 to 10 and 13 to 20, wherein the electronic controller is configured to determine, based on the current values, the inductance value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the piecewise affine map; wherein the target values are current values; and wherein, to control the power switching network based on the inductance values and the target current values, the electronic controller is configured to: generate control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor based on a difference between the current value and the target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions and on an inverse of the inductance values.

1.-64. (canceled)

65. A motor system comprising:

a power switching network configured to be coupled to a power supply and to a motor;

an electronic controller configured to:

determine current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame;

determine, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational refer-

ence frame using a first piecewise affine map defining a minimum power loss per torque (MPLPT) function; and
control the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values.

66. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein, to determine current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame, the electronic controller is configured to:

determine electrical operational characteristics of the motor in a stationary reference frame;
determine a rotational position of the motor; and
transform the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame.

67. The motor system of claim **65**, the electronic controller further configured to:

determine, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a second piecewise affine map, wherein the second piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains;

wherein, to determine, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a second piecewise affine map, the electronic controller is configured to:

identify a first domain corresponding to the current values and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions, and

apply the current values to the first affine function to determine the flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and

wherein, to control the power switching network based on the current values, the electronic controller is configured to control the power switching network based on the flux linkage values determined from the current values using the second piecewise affine map.

68. The motor system of claim **67**, wherein each of the plurality of domains corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of current and flux-linkage pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor.

69. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein the first piecewise affine map is a control parameter-to-target motor control parameter piecewise affine map.

70. The motor system of claim **69**, wherein the target motor control parameter values are current values or flux linkage values.

71. The motor system of claim **70**,

wherein the first piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains, and

wherein, to determine, based on the desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map, the electronic controller is configured to:

identify a first domain corresponding to the desired control parameter and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions; and

apply the desired control parameter to the first affine function to determine the target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

72. The motor system of claim **70**, wherein the desired control parameter is a target torque value for the motor.

73. The motor system of claim **65**, where the first piecewise affine map is generated based on:

a subset of pareto-optimal frontier points defining a convex pareto frontier, the pareto-optimal frontier points being a subset of datapoints including a current component, a flux component, a torque component, and a power loss component.

74. The motor system of claim **57**, wherein the first piecewise affine map is a torque-to-current piecewise affine map, and wherein, to determine, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the first piecewise affine map, the electronic controller is configured to:

use the torque-to-current piecewise affine map to translate a desired torque to a target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and

use a current-to-flux linkage piecewise affine map to translate the target current values to the target motor control parameter values, where the target motor control parameter values are flux linkage values.

75. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein, to control the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values, the electronic controller is configured to:

generate a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on a difference between the target motor control parameter value and a motor parameter indicated by the current value for the dimension;

transform the voltage commands in the rotational reference frame to the stationary reference frame;

generate a pulse width modulated control signal for each dimension of the stationary reference frame to control the power switching network to drive a stator of the motor; and

generate a rotor control signal to control driving of a rotor field winding.

76. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein, to control the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values, the electronic controller is configured to:

generate control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor based on a difference between the target motor control parameter value and a motor parameter indicated by the current value for the dimension.

77. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein, to control the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values, the electronic controller is configured to:

generate, based on a model predictive control algorithm, control signals to drive the motor based on the target motor control parameter values and the current values.

78. The motor system of claim **77**, wherein, to generate the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm, the electronic controller is configured to solve linear state-space equations over a receding time window to select a next control parameter.

79. The motor system of claim **77**, wherein, to generate the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm, the electronic controller is configured to access a second piecewise affine map defined by offline solving of the model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs.

80. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein the motor is a wound field synchronous motor comprising at least three stator phases and at least one rotor field winding.

81. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein the power switching network includes an inverter switch bridge including a plurality of power switching elements, the inverter switch bridge configured to receive DC power and output AC power to windings of the stator based on pulse width modulated control signals from the electronic controller.

82. The motor system of claim **65**, further comprising a DC/DC converter configured to receive input DC power and to provide output DC power to at least one rotor field winding in accordance with a pulse width modulated rotor control signal from the electronic controller.

83. The motor system of claim **65**, wherein the motor is at least one selected from the group of a wound field synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, a permanent magnet synchronous motor, an induction motor, a universal motor, or a reluctance motor.

84. A method of controlling a motor, the method comprising:

determining, by an electronic controller, current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame;

determining, by the electronic controller and based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map; and

controlling, by the electronic controller, a power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values.

85. The method of claim **84**, wherein determining current values for the motor in a rotational reference frame includes:

determining electrical operational characteristics of the motor in a stationary reference frame;

determining a rotational position of the motor; and transforming the electrical operational characteristics and the rotational position to the current values for the motor in the rotational reference frame.

86. The method of claim **84**, the method further comprising:

determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a second piecewise affine map, wherein the second piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains;

wherein determining, based on the current values, a flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a second piecewise affine map includes:

identifying a first domain corresponding to the current values and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions, and

applying the current values to the first affine function to determine the flux linkage value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and

wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values includes controlling the power switching network based on the flux linkage values determined from the current values using the second piecewise affine map.

87. The method of claim **86**, wherein each of the plurality of domains corresponds to a simplex that was provided by executing a domain decomposition algorithm on a data set of current and flux-linkage pairs for a plurality of operational points of the motor.

88. The method of claim **86**, wherein the first piecewise affine map is a control parameter-to-target motor control parameter piecewise affine map.

89. The method of claim **88**, wherein the target motor control parameter values are current values or flux linkage values.

90. The method of claim **89**,

wherein the first piecewise affine map includes a plurality of affine functions, each of the plurality of affine functions associated with a respective domain of a plurality of domains, and

wherein determining, based on the desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map includes:

identifying a first domain corresponding to the desired control parameter and selected from the plurality of domains, the first domain associated with a first affine function of the plurality of affine functions; and

applying the desired control parameter to the first affine function to determine the target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame.

91. The method of claim **90**, wherein the desired control parameter is a target torque value for the motor.

92. The method of claim **84**, wherein the first piecewise affine map is generated based on:

a subset of pareto-optimal frontier points defining a convex pareto frontier, the pareto-optimal frontier points being a subset of datapoints including a current component, a flux component, a torque component, and a power loss component.

93. The method of claim **84**, wherein the first piecewise affine map is a torque-to-current linkage piecewise affine map, and wherein determining, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using the first piecewise affine map includes:

using the torque-to-current piecewise affine map to translate a desired torque to a target current value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame; and

using a current-to-flux linkage piecewise affine map to translate the target current values to the target motor control parameter values, where the target motor control parameter values are flux linkage values.

94. The method of claim **84**, wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values includes:

generating a voltage command for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame based on a difference between the target motor control parameter value and a motor parameter indicated by the current value for the dimension;

transforming the voltage commands in the rotational reference frame to the stationary reference frame;

generating a pulse width modulated control signal for each dimension of the stationary reference frame to control the power switching network to drive a stator of the motor; and

generating a rotor control signal to control driving of a rotor field winding.

95. The method of claim **84**, wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values includes:

generating control signals in the stationary reference frame to drive the motor based on a difference between the target motor control parameter value and a motor parameter indicated by the current value for the dimension.

96. The method of claim **84**, wherein controlling the power switching network based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values includes:

generating, based on a model predictive control algorithm, control signals to drive the motor based on the target motor control parameter values and the current values.

97. The method of claim **96**, wherein generating the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm includes solving linear state-space equations over a receding time window to select a next control parameter.

98. The method of claim **96**, wherein generating the control signals based on the model predictive control algorithm includes accessing a second piecewise affine map defined by offline solving of the model predictive control algorithm using sample inputs.

99. The method of claim **84**, wherein the motor is a wound field synchronous motor comprising at least three stator phases and at least one rotor field winding.

100. The method of claim **84**, wherein the power switching network includes an inverter switch bridge including a plurality of power switching elements, the inverter switch bridge configured to receive DC power and output AC power to windings of the stator based on pulse width modulated control signals from the electronic controller.

101. The method of claim **84**, further comprising:

receiving, by a DC/DC converter, input DC power; and providing, by the DC/DC converter, output DC power to at least one rotor field winding in accordance with a pulse width modulated rotor control signal from the electronic controller.

102. The method of claim **84**, wherein the motor is at least one selected from the group of a wound field synchronous motor, a hybrid synchronous motor, a permanent magnet synchronous motor, an induction motor, a universal motor, or a reluctance motor.

103. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing computer-executable instructions, the instructions for causing a processor to:

determine current values for a motor in a rotational reference frame, each current value associated with a dimension of a set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame;

determine, based on a desired control parameter, a target motor control parameter value for each dimension of the set of dimensions of the rotational reference frame using a first piecewise affine map defining a minimum power loss per torque (MPLPT) function; and

control a power switching network coupled to the motor based on the current values and the target motor control parameter values.

104.-122. (canceled)

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